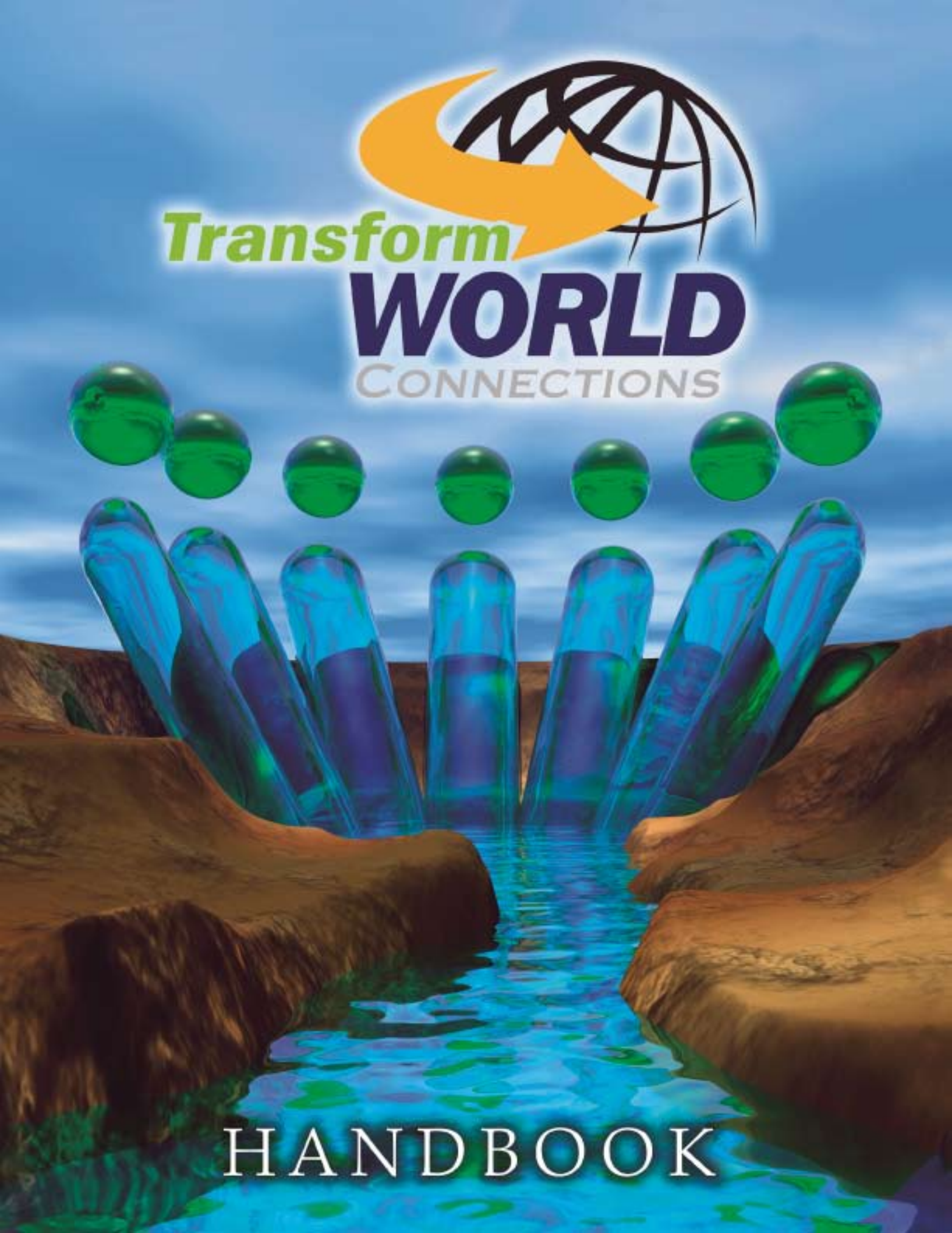
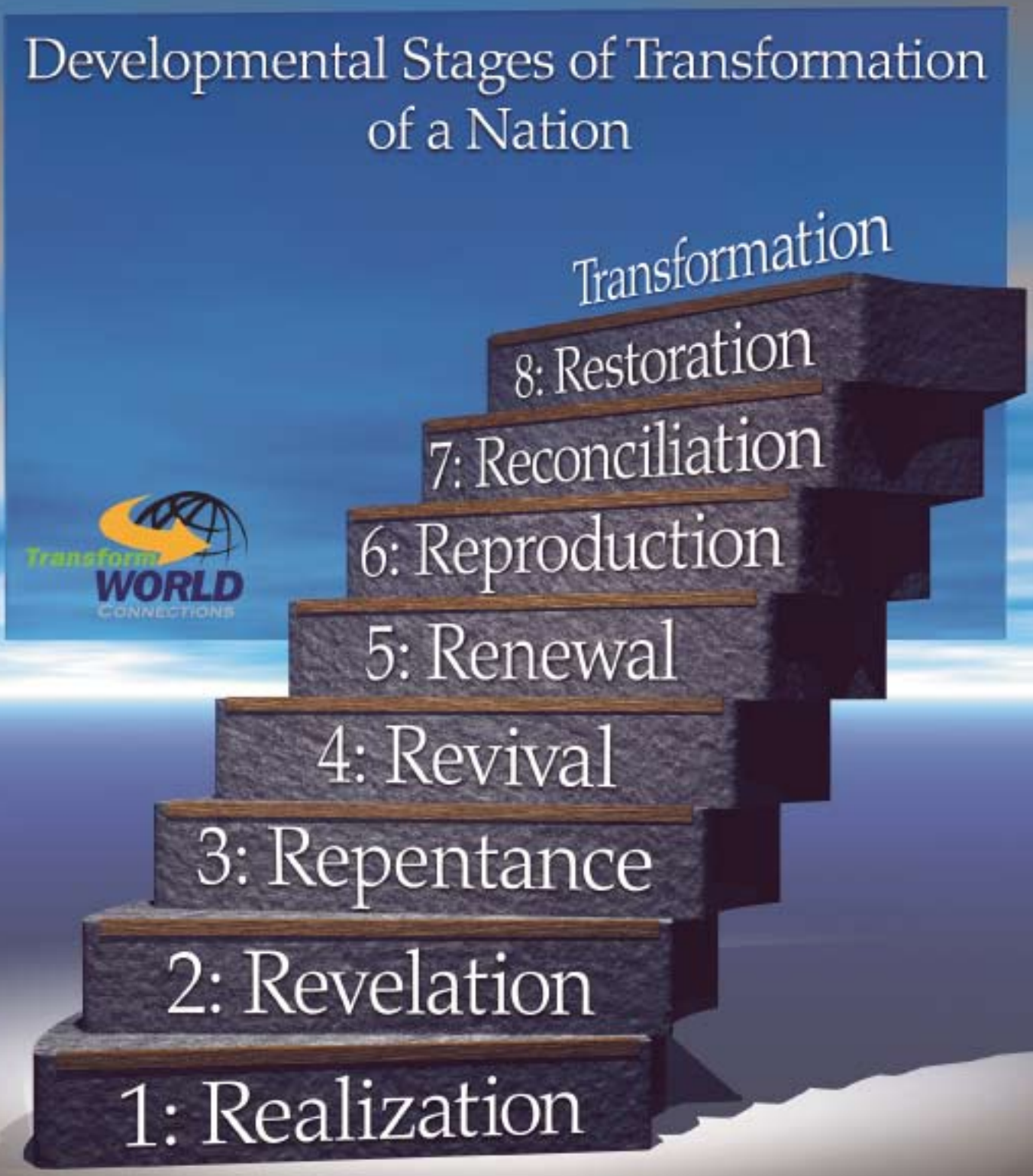

Transform
WORLD
CONNECTIONS
HANDBOOK



Transform World: MISSION

Transform World Connections exists to serve communities of servant-catalysts engaged in God's mission of transformation by catalyzing and connecting them together in consultation with people and communication resources, to equip the body of Christ in motivating the whole Church to bless the nations through prayer and collaborative action to see all nations redeemed, restored, and transformed, as cultures increasingly reflect the value system of the Kingdom of God.

Developmental Stages of Transformation of a Nation



Stage One:
Realization of crisis/need/deficit.

Stage Two:
Revelation from God to His servant.

Stage Three:
Repentance.

Stage Four:
Revival/Refreshing of the spirit.

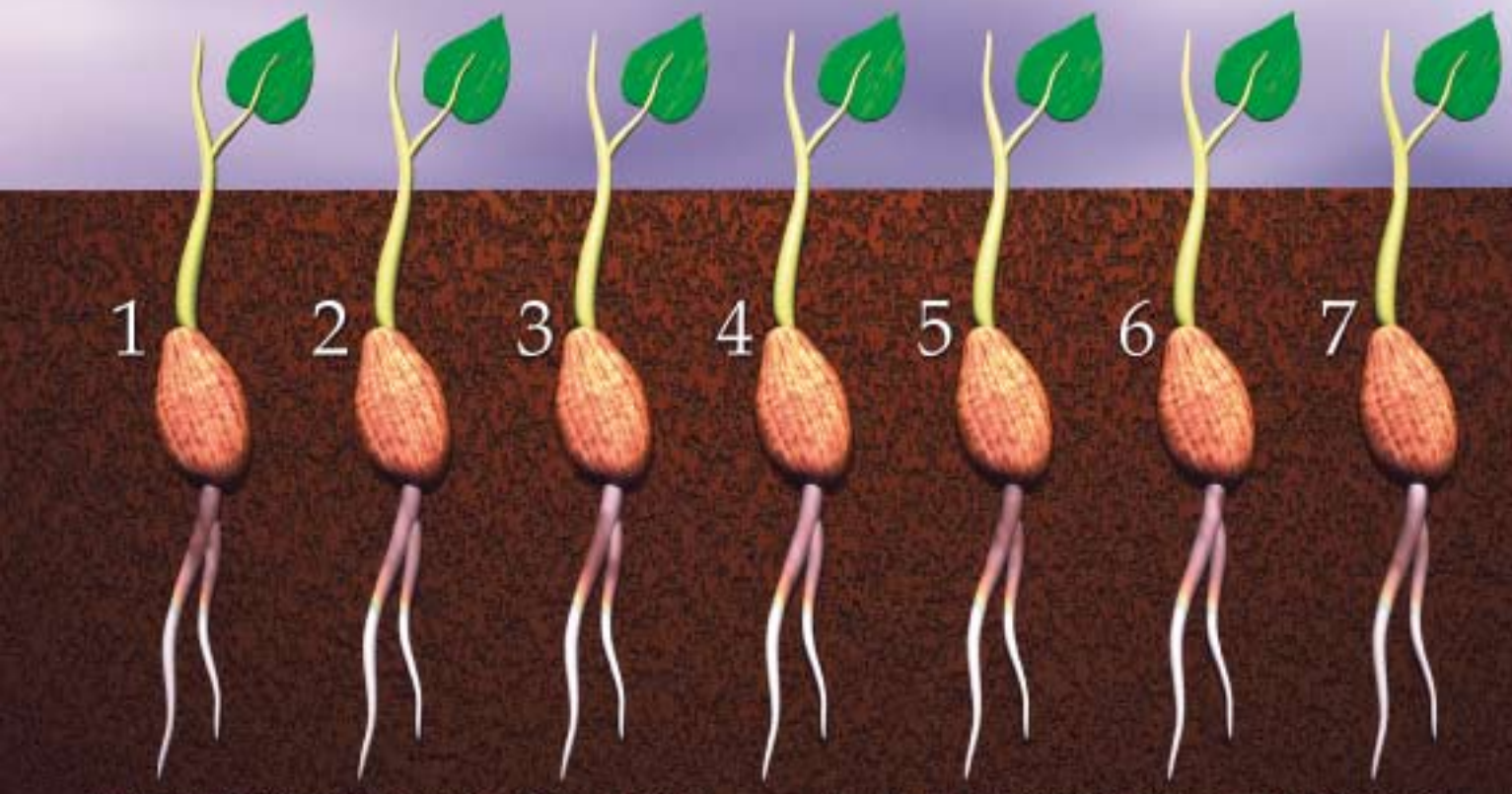
Stage Five:
Renewal of the mind.

Stage Six:
Reproduction of transformational leaders.

Stage Seven:
Reconciliation of all things to God.

Stage Eight:
Restoration/Transformation.

Seven Ideas that have Transformed the World



1. The Christian Idea of God and Theology
The most important thing about a person is his view of God.

2. The Christian Idea of Man
Man is not an accident of nature, merely a material being. Man is created in the image of God, having great value and a right to life, liberty, and property.

3. The Christian Idea of the Family
The family is the basic building block of society. As the family goes, so goes the nation. The state of the family determines the state of the church, education, business, arts, civil government, and life. The home is the first sphere of society.

4. The Christian Idea of Truth (Law)
A Christian worldview proclaims that there is truth, there is right and wrong, there are absolutes that we can know. The Bible is God's Word and the source of truth to all men.

5. The Christian Idea of Creation and History
God created all things and He has a purpose for His creation. His creation functions upon a set of laws, physical and moral, that He built into the fabric of His universe.

6. The Christian Idea of Government
All government begins in the heart of man with his ability (or inability) to direct, regulate, manage, and control his life. There are two spheres of government — internal and external. Internal government is self-government.

7. The Christian Idea of Education
Biblical education is the means of sanctifying men and extending God's kingdom.

Based on *The American Dream* by Stephen McDowell & Mark Beliles

Transform WORLD CONNECTIONS

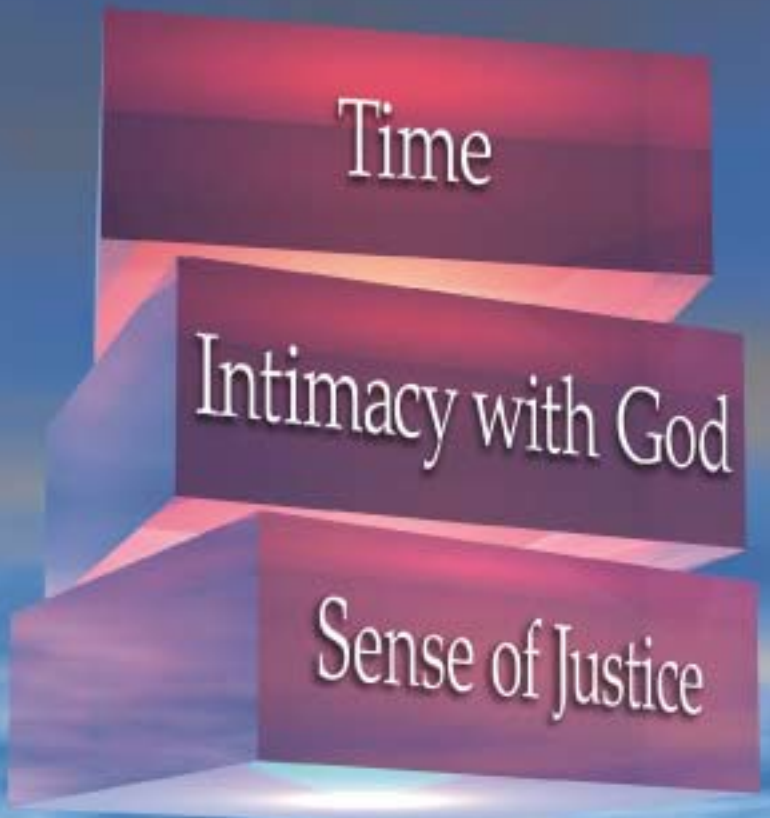
The Power and Form of Free Governments



By permission of Stephen McDowell

Transform WORLD CONNECTIONS

Transformation as Restoration



The Restoration of:

1. The Lost Sense of Justice
God promises to restore His people so their lives can be based on justice, which makes life available as it was intended to be lived.

2. Lost Intimacy with God
God wants to heal the broken relationship and restore your heart to Himself.

3. Lost Time
Sin and its consequences rob man of his most valuable possession: time.
But when the heart returns to God, restoration takes place.
Your years…can be restored!

Transform WORLD CONNECTIONS

Transform WORLD CONNECTIONS

A Call to Transformation:
Transformational Streams are Becoming one Fast-flowing River
for the Healing of the Nations

HANDBOOK

July 2007

First Draft

www.transform-world.net

Edited by Luis K. Bush and a team of volunteer editors. We have attributed selected portions to as many authors as are known to us. The contribution of countless others, anonymous servants, is known to God and gratefully received by all of us.

What you have in your hands is a "living document" for a living movement. As a living document there are resemblances to a human being. Like a human being it is part of a fallen world with many frailties. Like a human being it is complex.

This is an envisioning document which explains the number of full pages dedicated to painting a picture of the nature and implications of mission as transformation. Because this is a living movement and involving many people it incorporates the views and ideas of others as much as possible. Consequently you will find some inconsistencies of perspective and understanding.

The interpretation of God's mission of transformation in the Handbook reflects more of a non-western perspective because most of the people engaging in this living movement are from the Majority World.

The potential is for you to grab onto snippets of the whole and run with those that you do get. Some will work and some will not. The greater the complexity, the greater the chance of finding some snippets. It's almost like overhearing a conversation in a foreign language and suddenly hearing a word you recognize.

Use this as a reference book. The Table of Contents is the key to getting around the document. Don't be surprised that the handbook conclusion comes after the End Notes so that it faces and helps explain the graphic on the inside of the back cover titled: *Transformational Momentum*.

Help improve the usability of this handbook. As you read this handbook consider emailing your comments to consider incorporating into the next generation of the document to CBKLAY@gmail.com.

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Preface

A Prayer On God's Mission For The Healing Of The Nations

"*Our Father in heaven, hallowed be your name, your kingdom come, your will be done on earth as it is in heaven*" (Matt. 6:9-10).

We give you praise, adoration and thanksgiving for your **call to transformation** unto your faithful servants scattered around the globe!

You have mightily blessed the prayers and outreach efforts of your people in many parts of the world—now increasingly the width, depth and global extent of your transforming power reveals itself in every place your Spirit falls on earth. We have heard you say: "See, I am doing a new thing!" (Isa. 43:19a). We see it springing up. Yes, we are perceiving it (Isa. 43:19b). We have seen that indeed you are making a way in the desert and streams in the wastelands of this world (Isa. 43:19c). Thank you Lord for what you are doing in our barren and fallen world!

We sense the presence, power and peace as an expression of your glory filling the earth as the waters cover the sea. We have learned so much, sensing the presence of your transforming power demonstrated in many ways. Some of these revelations are:

- Divine appointments—*Kairos* moments in the nations are being realized! Seeing where you are working—often times where you are moving mightily through a minority of Christians in a nation.
- Spiritual movements enabled through **grass-roots** initiatives in many places!
- Transformational-type movements in nature, both geographical and functional, along the lines of multiple transformational streams.
- Fresh upwellings of the Spirit indicate a vibrant vitality, a holy presence and even "surprises of the Lord" in the midst of your people.

Oh Lord—all praise to you now and forevermore! We rejoice in that you have called us to join you on your mission of transformation among the nations at the beginning of this new century. Dear Lord, we are dependent on your enabling power by your Holy Spirit. With joy and thanksgiving, lead us hour-by-hour, and day by day to be your servant catalysts in your labor of love for the healing of the nations.

Introduction

Mission as transformation has emerged as a new paradigm at the beginning of the twenty-first Century. We are living in a fallen, deformed world needing to be transformed. Individuals are being called to be conformed to the image of Christ. Churches are being challenged to be renewed and reformed to align with God's greater purposes. Cities and nations are being transformed.

The purpose of this handbook is to inform, inspire and involve God's people in connecting with God and one another on His mission of transformation for the healing of the nations.

There are many ways to perceive what is a transformed nation. Each lens provides a potential point of connection for potential involvement of a Christian servant, Christian group or denomination. Each lens also provides a gateway for a transformation initiative. (See What is a Transformed Nation? on pages 20 to 22

I.

Transform World Beginnings

Introduction

Transform World was the term chosen by the organizers of the first Transform World Event in Indonesia. Conveners of similar events in other nations have retained the term. Recognizing the level of commitment by Christian leaders in the nation and need for engagement in an ongoing process of transformation, the term **TRANSFORMATION CONNECTION INDONESIA** (TCI) was used to express the ongoing vision and mission in the country. Other regions of the world, nations and cities have now begun a process of transformation and adopted the term to their region. Examples include: Transformation Connection Silk Road, TC Bihar, TC Korea, and TC Surabaya.

After three years of conducting a WORLD INQUIRY it became clear that God was on a mission of transformation in our world today. This clarity was found during a gathering of 120 servants of God from around the world in Seoul in May of 2003. The **WORLD INQUIRY** was a three-year journey of listening, in order to hear God's voice through His servants, especially those who are now emerging onto their local and national scenes in the majority world.

A number of the participants from different countries decided to hold national catalytic events in their own nations, the first of which was to be Indonesia which led to Transform World Indonesia 2005. In preparations for the upcoming event Christian leaders from Africa and Latin America met with Indonesian leaders in Jakarta in February 2004.

As one of the steps to seek the heart of God on the matter the group decided in Jakarta to convene a global interest group of twelve respected Christian servants of God from the different continents of the world to hear from God regarding the growing number of transformational initiatives witnessed in the nations.

The Global Interest Group met September 7-9, 2004 in London with an open agenda. The group linked continents from around the world to the transformation theme for a time of sharing and seeking God for a united response of the body to the head of the Church, the Lord Jesus. Their findings were later presented at Transform World Indonesia in May 2005, reviewed and endorsed by the participants, becoming the first section of the Transformation Covenant as Covenantal Assumptions (see Basic Assumptions in Chapter II).

The findings of the three-year inquiry were presented at the **WORLD EVANGELIZATION ISSUES FORUM** in Pattaya Oct.-Nov. 2004 in the form of six books[1] and summarized verbally in the following three points:

1. Our world is changing radically: demographically, economically, politically and religiously.

- The winds of change are swirling with great intensity around the Christian world at the beginning of the twenty-first century.

- We are in the midst of a time of change in global missions represented by many emerging streams as well as converging movements of missions.

2. A new epoch of missions is unfolding before our eyes at the beginning of the twenty-first century.

- All the newness and mission initiatives out of mission fields of the past signals a new phase in missions.
- We appear to be at a new stage in the worldwide Christian movement.

3. Transformation has become a unifying vision of the Church's mission.

- Diverse streams of transformation are converging into one great river of transformation
  in which the people of God are moving
  with the power, the presence and the peace of God,
  resulting in the healing of the nations.
- God is calling his servants to act as catalysts of personal, family, church and cultural transformation so that
  compelled by the love of Jesus
  in obedience to his command to love our neighbor
  by the power of the Holy Spirit,
  the Body of Christ can become his agent of transformation,
  a transforming Church on a transforming mission,
  united to bless the nations
  to the glory of God the Father.

Six months later the first global Transform World event took place in Indonesia. As with other events subsequent events the initiative and the leadership and the resources came from the national hosts.

Transform World Indonesia 2005

The National Prayer Committee of Indonesia along with churches and an association of Christian institutions in Indonesia organized **TRANSFORM WORLD INDONESIA 2005**, attended by 500 leaders from 55 nations.

The first overriding purpose was to celebrate the completion of sixteen years (1989–2005) of prevailing prayer. It did happen. The event ended with a four-hour prayer gathering in the national stadium attended by 112,000, broadcast into seventy seven cities with an estimated audience of more than five million. The next day prayer conference seminars with the theme of transformation continued with 3,000 delegates attending in Jakarta and with perhaps another 90,000 more attending in 56 other regional sites.

The second overriding purpose was to convene and connect many worldwide servants of God engaged in significant transformational ministries which became specific outcomes as follows:

- Communed with God in worship and prayer summits to seek the holiness of God, putting aside our individual and corporate agendas to seek the face of God and His Kingdom purposes for our time together and beyond.
- Collaborated with God's servants engaged in transformational prayer for the cities of Indonesia, seeking to bless them as the nation and the peoples of Indonesia.
- Contributed to the focus group process to animate the focused domains, and to enhance God's revealed Kingdom purposes of transformation.
- Covenanted with God and each other around a transformational covenant that would serve "as an altar" of our time together there! Amen!

One participant summarized the experience by saying: "The catalytic impact of our time arose out of a deep sense of spiritual brokenness and need in our Indonesian host brethren. This bathed the entire event in humility, which enabled the Lord to have his way. The warmth and graciousness with which the Indonesian hosts served us was a great testimony to God's grace at work in their lives, and to the commitment of the Church in Indonesia to transformation."

Others expressed how they had gained a sense of the global (big picture) synergy that is now happening, as God joins various streams into a larger river of transformation. The testimonies of God's transformational work around the world were almost beyond belief. A great cultural diversity within the context of the Lord's transforming global move was compelling.

On the final day of the event Canon James Wong from Singapore proposed to the participants that a small office be established based in Singapore to be called Transform World Connections to support ongoing related events and processes. With the affirmation of the participants of that first Transform World event a small board made up of Singaporean and Indonesian leaders primarily was established as a non-legal entity.

Transform World India 2006

The second major global Transform World event took place eighteen months later called **Transform World India 2006** (TW India 2006). The concluding declaration endorsed by the conference read:

As 1000 Indian and International participants to the Transform World India 2006 conference, we have celebrated and deliberated God's work of transformation in India and the world. We declare the following before God and one another, acknowledging that this is a visionary proclamation with varying degrees of actualization.

1. We affirm the two foundational propositions of TW India 2006:

1.1. Transformation is a result of God's Kingdom mustard seed—God's power for wholistic spiritual, socio-structural, ecological and cosmic transformation.

1.2. Wholistic Transformation begins in local and national contexts when a creative Christian minority says "yes" to God's Kingdom initiative and calling, applying Biblical truth to the Church and to the context, within a kairos/catalytic moment.

2. We declare that this Kingdom Transformation is:

Founded in the merciful and just love of the Father

Realized in the sacrificial life, death and resurrection of the Son

Released in the empowering and enabling presence of the Spirit

Actualized in the faithful obedience of the followers of Jesus

Reflected in a spirit of invitation, not in an attitude of bitterness

And consummated in the Messiah at his glorious Second Coming.

3. **We declare that the Church must repent from disobedience and from all forms of dualism, as in personal spirituality versus social activism**. We embrace the wholistic nature of God's Reign of *Shalom*, seeking to work with His transforming activity in all spheres of life. We seek to do this while upholding the tension of the "already" and "not yet" of the Kingdom, avoiding the extremes of both triumphalism and defeatism, in the kairos era between the first and second coming of Jesus.

4. **We declare that the Church of Jesus Christ, as the community of the Kingdom, is God's primary instrument of transformation.** But we also declare that God works through providential grace in societal movements and upheavals, offering *kairos* moments for the Church to respond to Kingdom breakthrough, as it interprets the signs of the times.

5. **We declare that India is in such a catalytic moment in its history.** There are signs of God's work in the Church through repentance from caste-ism that exists inside and outside the Church; and through a revival in evangelism and church planting. There are signs of God's work in society through the search for personal and national identity; through the quest for an egalitarian society; and through the caste churning, especially in regard to the liberation of women and the Dalit-Bahujan people.

6. **We recognize the multiple emerging transformational streams in India.** And we pray that Transform World India 2006 has served to further catalyze these streams toward the river of Church Unity and National Transformation.

Therefore we call upon the Indian and International Church, and *we commit ourselves*, to work together with God for the transformation of the entire Indian society, for the glory of God Almighty. Amen!

For a more extensive description of the spirit and outcome of several other events that are shaping the emerging Transform World Movement, see Appendix A.

II.

Basic Assumptions [2]

Introduction

This "Transformation Covenant" calls Christians everywhere to unite in effective witness to the *whole* Gospel. The gospel is concerned with every dimension of life. Nothing less than the full-orbed message of Jesus Christ can provide an adequate remedy. We call Christians all over the world to joyfully and compassionately share that "which we have heard, which we have seen with our eyes, which we have looked at and our hands have touched—this we proclaim concerning the Word of life" (1 John 1:1b).

Transform World is committed to the transformational mission of God that results in the healing and blessing of the nations so that all may experience the presence, power, and peace of God.

Transform World seeks to serve communities of servant-catalysts in motivating the whole body of Christ to bless the nations. This requires that the body of Christ be mobilized for prayer and collaborative action in order to reach all nations with the good news of the kingdom of God.

Key Assumptions

1. **Nature:** This is a "God-movement." Streams of transformation from all over the world are converging into one great river of transformation so that the people of God are beginning to move with the power, the presence, and the peace of God. This is bringing healing in the churches that is overflowing in the healing of the nations. Transformation is becoming a unifying vision of the church's mission.
2. **Context:** This "God-movement" is happening within specific but diverse contexts. Therefore we need to be sensitive to the particular cultural context in which we are working. We seek to be relevant to, but also transforming, our contexts.
3. **Identity:** We seek to be a transforming community with a transforming mission united to bless all peoples. We are a group of individuals who unite spontaneously around community, city, national, and regional initiatives. We are burdened for the transformation of our own communities, cities, nations and regions—to bless and be blessed in fellowship with others.
4. **Destiny:** Pursuing transformation means to strive for Christ-likeness as individuals, families, and churches with the goal of impacting community, city, nation and world. The goal of transformation is to grow into the *Imago Christi*—the image of Christ—so that we might be faithful witnesses of the Gospel.
5. **Participation:** All who affirm that Jesus Christ is Lord and who seek to fulfill their calling in obedience to the Word of God are invited to participate in this movement. Their level of involvement will be determined by their own initiative, working in concert with the other leaders in their locale, sphere and scope.

6. **Empowerment:** "Transform World" means empowering the local church and every believer to be the instrument of God's transformation. The basic challenge is to train and transform churches and Christians in the character of Jesus Christ and through the Holy Spirit equipped to be God's instrument of transformation in society.

7. **Commitment:** Our commitment is joyfully to "seek and observe" what God is doing so that we might join in the *missio De*i, God's mission, rather than pursuing our own desires and designs.

8. **Ethos:** We pray that all will be rooted in the "love of God"—sensing the compelling call of God to "love our neighbor!" This ethos of the "love of God" is essential to effective collaboration

9. **Status:** Global transformation events are independent, self-selecting and self-sustaining. Each city, national, and regional initiative participating in these events seeks to make a unique contribution from their own calling and place in the body to the global body of believers. The participation of each group contributes to the building up of the global body. The national host group takes responsibility for the event it sponsors.

10. **Calling:** God is calling his servants to be catalysts that enable personal, ecclesial, societal, and cultural transformation. Compelled by the love of Jesus, in obedience to his command to love our neighbor, the body of Christ empowered by the Holy Spirit can become his agent of transformation, to the glory of God the Father.

III.

Multiple Transformational Streams

One Great Transformational River

Multiple transformational streams are welling up and flowing across the world into one great "transformational river" of God's blessing for the nations, prophetically announcing that God is on a mission of transformation at the beginning of the twenty-first century. We read in Ps. 46:4, "There is a river whose streams make glad …." The Psalmist says: "The Lord almighty is with us. Come and see the works of the Lord." In places as distant from one another as Indonesia, Fiji, Uganda, India, and Colombia, transformational streams are converging under God's hand into this one great "transformational river."

1. **THE REVIVALIST STREAM** is characterized by divine visitation and revival; this stream can be seen today in Fiji. In this stream, God acts on the Church, bringing revival, He acts on society, bringing spiritual awakening and He acts on political leaders, bringing ethical leadership, concern for the needs of the people, and readiness to review political and economic structures and systems in light of a Biblical Worldview and Kingdom values.

2. **THE SATURATION CHURCH PLANTING STREAM** results in the establishment and nurturing of vital, healthy churches in every class and kind of people that are within practical and relational reach of every person, permeating every segment and sphere of society as salt and light with the love, truth and saving power of Jesus Christ.

3. **THE TRANSFORMATIONAL DEVELOPMENT STREAM** seeks to create a better future for the poor and the destitute through community development. Those living in poverty are often caught in mutually reinforcing cultural mind-sets and the resulting juridical/social/economic systems that mar the dignity and identity of all, dehumanizing rich and poor alike. The power of the Gospel of transformation consists of inspiring the privileged to freely and compassionately come alongside the underprivileged to repent each of their own sin. Then they can address together the cultural lies and the pervasive systems of injustice, undertaking community development initiatives and producing sustainable development in a changing world.

4. **THE TRANSFORMATIONAL PRAYER STREAM** prays out God's heart for the cities and the nations of the world. It begins with listening to God for his agenda for the world.

Some of us agree that these four major transformational streams that have already emerged are the four major streams of transformation for the healing of the nations.

5. **THE CITY-REACHING STREAM** builds on the foundation of vital, Biblical churches to mobilize God's people toward a mission to transform people, places and cultures where the Church lives around the world.

6. **THE MARKETPLACE STREAM** recognized that God is at work transforming people and nations through business and that Kingdom business is an effective mission strategy for the twenty-first century.

7. **THE TRANSFORMATIONAL WORSHIP STREAM** though more difficult to describe, its representatives affirm that Transformational Worship involves ministering to the Lord in united worship. Some use the term “harp and bowl worship,” others call it "end times worship" because it focuses on the final worship scenes of the worthiness of the Lamb in Revelation 4 and 5. It is not heritage-based, connection-based or evangelism-based (although it can have that effect). It's all about the Lord. It exalts Christ. It brings the worshipper to greater intimacy with God with an attitude of self-abandonment. Emphasizing more attitude than forms, it is characterized by a manifest sense of the presence of God as he is enthroned in the worship of his people.

8. **THE “BACK TO JERUSALEM” MOVEMENT STREAM** flows out of prayer convocations in which a growing number of God’s people are cooperating together from the first fruits of the Great Commission, going back to Jerusalem to prepare the way for the Lord of Glory through worship, intercession, preaching of the Gospel of the Kingdom, church planting and a Kingdom mindset.

CONCLUSION: We celebrate multiple transformational streams, which are becoming one great “transformational river” broadening and deepening the healing of the nations. The river is here.

IV.

The Mission Of Transformation

Transformation is a concept rooted in the New Covenant (see John 4:14; Rom. 12:2; 2 Cor. 3:18, 5:17; I John 3:9). The term itself derives from the Greek word "*metamorphoo*" which means to change from one degree of glory to another with ever increasing glory. It is the spiritual equivalent of a caterpillar being metamorphosed into a butterfly. Unlike men's effort at self-reformation, it does not merely tinker with society; it changes it from the inside out. It operates at the heart level.[3]

Transformation involves seeking positive change in the whole of human life, materially, socially and spiritually, by recovering our true identity as human beings created in the image of God and discovering our true vocation as productive stewards, faithfully caring for our world and people.[4]

According to the Biblical view of human life, transformation is the change from a condition of human existence contrary to God's purposes to one in which people are able to enjoy fullness of life in harmony with God (John 10:10; Col. 3:8-15; Eph. 4:13). This transformation can only take place through the obedience of individuals and communities to the Gospel of Jesus Christ, whose power changes the lives of men and women by releasing them from the guilt, power and consequences of sin, enabling them to respond with love toward God and towards others (Rom. 5:5) and making them "new creatures in Christ" (2 Cor. 5:17).[5]

Transformation is the progressive, ongoing and measurable, supernatural impact of the presence and power of God working in, through and apart from the Church on human society and structures.[5]

In the Church, this is characterized by increased holiness of life, reconciliation in relationships and appetite for prayer, God's Word and worship. Through the Church this is characterized by accelerated conversion growth, mobilization of gifts and callings, and an increased relevance to and participation in greater society.

To this end, a catalytic core of saints embrace a lifestyle of persistent repentance, humility, and sacrificial servanthood that attracts the favor and presence of God, and breaks the predominating influences of the ruling power structures of human flesh and negative spiritual forces.[7]

In the culture, this may be characterized by pervasive awareness of the reality of God, a radical correction of social ills, a commensurate decrease in crime rates, supernatural blessing on local commerce, healing of the brokenhearted, regenerative acts of restoring the productivity of the land, and an exporting of kingdom righteousness.

City Transformation as a Paradigm of Transformation

Much understanding of the concrete process of transformation has been gained from the experience of **City Transformation** strategies. City Transformation is the ongoing process of mobilizing the whole body of Christ in a geographic area to strategically focus

its resources on reaching the whole city with the whole Gospel, resulting in the transformation of the city and its societies.

Dedication to mobilizing the whole Church requires the initiative be *inclusive* (that means, open to every willing believer that adheres to the initiative's spirit and principles) in its approach. Commitment to the whole city requires that the initiative be *comprehensive* in its scope to include all peoples, problems, and conditions that affect community life. The whole Gospel requires methods that are *wholistic* in nature requiring a balanced integration of proclamation and incarnation.

As the head of the Church, Christ initiates and His body responds – as one body. Transformation initiatives under Christ's direction must be inclusive in approach, comprehensive in scope, and wholistic in nature.

Efforts to mobilize the whole Church compel us to include every willing believer. Just as the Godhead is a community, so we believe that God's nature and character are most clearly manifest in the world as the Church lives out the Kingdom life in incarnational community (Eph. 4:11-13).

God is Lord of all, and therefore, His redemptive concern is comprehensive—seeking to bring healing and restoration to "all things" by means of Christ's blood shed on the cross (Gen. 1:31a; Rom. 8:18-23; Col. 1:19-20). The Kingdom of God advances to the extent that local Churches reflect God's comprehensive, redemptive concern for the whole of creation (Matt. 4:23; Luke 4:18-21). Therefore, the ministry of the Church must be wholistic, encompassing the whole person (spiritual, physical, and social), and all of their relationships (with God, with others, and with the environment; Gen. 1:26-28). The answers to these questions should set the agenda for the local Church; what would our town look like if Christ were mayor; what would our nation look like if Christ were president?

Transformation is a reference to two points of time in a city's history; where the city is now and where it once was. For a growing number of cities the language that best describes the degree of societal change occurring between those two historic points is transformation. Deep and profound change is possible in human beings and is equally possible for the social organisms that we call cities and communities.[8]

An effort to define a comprehensive approach to transformation must be "rooted in the theology of the mission of the Kingdom of God and seeks to express the Lordship of Jesus over every aspect of life, economic, religious, personal, political. It does not give priority to any area of life as an area for mission…but this change will be effected whenever people address issues of life directly, rooted in a gospel perspective."[9] As the head of the church Christ initiates and His body responds—as one body.

A comprehensive movement to bless the nations includes many emphases. Missions initiatives among the last and the least prioritize the spiritually needy while integrating the physically needy without leaving any country "out of focus." Transformational leadership engages a new generation in participatory leadership with current leadership.

A transformed world is a place where the power, the presence and the peace of God are experienced by all. The power of God is unleashed and the peace of God rules. Shalom-Salaam embrace. The presence of God fills the earth (Ps. 85:10-11).

Key Vision and Mission Components

Vision Statement

Transform World seeks to engage in the transformational mission of God that results in the healing/blessing of the nations so that the presence, power, and peace of God may be experienced by all.

Mission Statement

Transform World Connections exists to serve communities of servant-catalysts engaged in God's mission of transformation by catalyzing and connecting them together in consultation with people and communication resources, to equip the body in motivating the whole Church to bless the nations through prayer and collaborative action to see all nations redeemed, restored, and transformed, as cultures increasingly reflect the value system of the Kingdom of God.

Definition And Core Values [10]

Background Thoughts

Transformation is one of the hottest topics in Christendom, but the word does not have a commonly accepted definition. This has led many to adopt an "anything goes" approach that has diluted the term of its inherent power and meaning. All too often definitions are derived from our inventory of available resources rather than the revelation of Scripture.

In Matthew chapter six Jesus declared to his disciples, "*This is how you should pray: Our Father in heaven, hallowed be your name, your kingdom come, your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven.*"

With these brief words we are reminded that God's presence and purposes are to be the central focus of human society. They are to be realized and promoted not in some limited, religious manner, but *as they are in heaven*. In the words of the prophet Isaiah we are to "give [ourselves] no rest, and give him no rest till he establishes Jerusalem (or Chicago, London or Singapore) and makes her the praise of the earth" (Isa. 62:6-7). We are to "renew the ruined cities that have been devastated for generations" (Isa. 61:4). If we do this, Ezekiel promises, "the name of the city from that time on will be: THE LORD IS THERE" (Ezek. 48:35).

While many Christians assume transforming revival is about growing congregations, it is actually a matter of renaming or re-identifying our cities and nations. Since we lack both the right and the capacity to define transformation, our only sensible course is to "consider what God has done…" (Eccles. 7:13). Apart from observing the Father at work we have no way to discover truly reliable principles for success.

Because transforming revival is a principle-based enterprise we can anticipate what God will respond, namely to humility, holiness, repentance, prayer, worship, compassion, faith (2 Chron. 7:14; Isa. 58:9-12; Isa. 62:6-7; Hos. 6:3). This allows us to prepare the way of the Lord with confidence: "*If my people will…*" then "*I will heal their land*." There is no presumption here, only obedience. He has removed all mystery from the discussion. We

can also safely predict what the *fruit* of transformation will look like, because, again, God's Word describes it for us (Ps. 144:14; Isa. 1:26; Acts 11:20-24, 19:18-20) and because we have seen it in the microcosm of the lives of redeemed individuals. What we cannot be certain of are the *means* by which God will accomplish his purposes. These are as unique as snowflakes, fingerprints and cities.

If revival were, as some claim, the product of arbitrary dictate, faith would not even enter the equation. We could only *hope* that God might one day include our community on his revival itinerary. There would be no principles to apply, no guidelines to follow, no promises to expect, and no certainty of success.

We cannot please God in the absence of faith (Heb. 11:6), neither is faith to be used as an instrument of manipulation. We do not summon God's presence in order to repair our broken communities, we summon him because we cannot bear to live another day apart from his touch. We seek a lover, not a handyman. If we will make his kingdom purposes our priority (Matt. 6:33), he will come. And when he comes, he will arrive with healing in his wings (Mal. 4:2).

What Is A Transformed Community?

For the term transformation to be properly applied to a community, change must be evident not only in the lives of its inhabitants, but also in the fabric of its institutions. In the end, it is dramatic social, political, and even ecological renewal that sets these cases apart from common experience.

In short, a transformed community is…

- A neighborhood, city or nation whose values and institutions have been overrun by the grace and presence of Jesus Christ
- A place where divine fire has not merely been summoned, it has fallen
- A society in which natural evolutionary change has been disrupted by invasive supernatural power
- A culture that has been impacted comprehensively and undeniably by the kingdom of God
- A location where kingdom values are celebrated publicly and passed on to future generations

This is a matter of faith, not triumphalism. There is, and will likely continue to be, gross spiritual darkness in the world. Our goal is not to make a new heaven and a new earth, but rather to create salty spots on the earth that stimulate a thirst for God. Like many salty appetizers, these temporal transformations point the way to a larger, more satisfying meal to come.

Shared Values & Beliefs

PRESENCE PRIORITY. We believe that God's presence is essential to transforma-tional success and must always take precedence over our programs.

OBEDIENCE. We are committed to abandoning our own ideas and agendas in order that

we might walk out God's will and purposes in our corporate mission.

PRAYER. We believe that communion with the Lord of Hosts is the only way to nurture spiritual intimacy and avoid the pitfalls of pride and presumption.

RELATIONALLY FOCUSED. We are bound by long-term, committed friendships rather than short-term project assignments.

HUMILITY & SERVANTHOOD. We seek to advance our common cause by preferring and serving one another in love according to Philippians 2:1-11.

ACCOUNTABILITY. We covet the strength that comes as we walk together and sharpen one another through times of challenge.

DIRECT PARTICIPATION. We are not theorists, but practitioners who mentor and guide communities to and through the transformational process.

INCLUSIVENESS. We celebrate unity with diversity and look to empower, encourage and equip all who desire to bring transformation to the world.

COLLABORATION. We believe that any attempt to control or compete with others is incompatible with God's desire that his body be "jointly fitted together" for kingdom purposes. We celebrate the autonomy of each member, but we also recognize that autonomy must be linked to interdependence (as opposed to independence).

SENSITIVITY. We are committed to cultivating an ever-deepening awareness of the feelings held by our Lord, our colleagues, and those we look to serve.

HIDDENNESS. We seek to avoid the limelight in those situations where adopting a high profile risks casting a shadow over the work and person of Christ.

GODLY CHARACTER. We esteem honesty, integrity and a commitment to holiness that begins in a personal transformation.

INNOVATION & CREATIVITY. We reject stale, lazy and traditional thinking as unrepresentative of a dynamic God.

FLEXIBILITY. We believe a malleable heart and perspective is key to remaining relevant in a changing world.

Core Values

VISION GUIDED. As a sense of urgency rises within the emerging vision community, so does the consensus that change must occur. Thus the transformational vision becomes the guiding factor in strategic decision making and every decision, each action step and attempt to mobilize the Church, must be assessed in terms of how it contributes to and aligns with the current transformational vision. Once a commitment to change is made agreement on the scope and approach to change should follow.

INCLUSIVE IN DESIGN. Dedication to mobilizing the whole Church requires the initiative be *inclusive* of every believer in its approach. Leaders are discovering joy and effectiveness in linking arms with those whom they hold the essentials of salvation in common, while giving freedom and grace in those factors that distinguish them from one another. The

will of the Father is to mobilize the whole Church around the majesty of his Son and his mission to the world.

WHOLISTIC IN NATURE. The operative concern in effective ministries is not what we think we should do but what God wants us to do, according to His Word and Spirit. Jesus demonstrated His loving care for others and then shared words of hope and salvation. He also confronted the hypocrites and exhorted all to the repentance of faith.

COLLABORATIVE IN APPROACH. Our Lord expected his people would work together (John 17), the Bible illustrates it (1 Cor. 12; Eph. 4) and human experience demonstrates that the law of synergy produces greater effectiveness than working alone. An African proverb states, "if you want to run fast, go alone. If you want to run far, go with another." The overall success of our transformational initiatives will be largely determined by the Church's ability to partner within itself and the broader community.

COMPREHENSIVE IN SCOPE. The task of blessing an entire city or nation is formidable. The vision for transforming cities is comprehensive and the Church's approach must match this in scope. Though the Church cannot engage every matter simultaneously the Church must have a strategic plan to guide its response, enabling it to monitor progress toward transformation.

EXTERNALLY-FOCUSED AND COMMUNITY-BASED. Effective Churches in the Third Millennium have an outward focus toward the community; endeavoring to get the Church into the community not the other way around. Community-based efforts require the Church to establish itself and minister in the community where people live, work, and play assessing needs and building systems of support. The measurement of effectiveness is not the size of the congregation but its impact in the community.

LOCALLY LED. Too often national partners have come up with great ideas for some new project but don't have the means to implement it by themselves so they attempt to sell it to local leaders. The national partner leads the process while local leaders implement it. This relationship is upside down and needs to change. While vision may be imported, leadership cannot be. Local leaders have the calling from God, the understanding of context, and the credibility to assess appropriate responses to God's vision for the city. All efforts must be focused upon serving local leaders to help them be as effective as possible.

What Is A Transformed Nation?

There are various ways to answer that question, depending on which lens you are using. As we approach this topic we do well to adopt the watchword "*transformed and always transforming*" to remind us that transformation is a process and not realized in fullness until Jesus comes. God's agenda is to restore every nation to Himself through Christ (Eph. 1:10 and Col. 1:20).

There are various lenses through which to see what a transformed nation is. In summary, for example you could say the following:

- Biblically, it is a nation built upon the principles of God's word, and infused with the

presence of God (Deut. 4:5-8)

- Theologically, it is a nation in which the glory of God fills the nation like the waters cover the sea
- Missiologically, it a nation where you find the full display of the power, the presence and the peace of God
- Institutionally, it is where the priority purpose 1) for family is to procreate, educate and provide health and welfare; 2) for the church is the regular instruction of members in Biblical truth for every sphere of life, discipling and administering the Sacraments and discipline and 3) for the state, is protecting the righteous, punishing the evil doers and practicing justice for all.

Poetically, a transformed nation has been described by a Christian Indian poet talking of his dream for a transformed India beginning in a village in India in detail as follow. A transformed nation is one:

Where the mind is without fear and the head is held high

Where the world has not been broken up into fragments by narrow domestic walls

Where words come out from the depth of truth

Where tireless striving stretches its arms towards perfection

Where the clear stream of reason has not lost its way into the dreary desert sand of dead habit [+ vain philosophies + man-made jurisprudence and governance]

Where the mind is led forward by God into ever-widening thought and action

Where Satan and his angels have been bound and disempowered

Where the Lord Jesus is exalted, and lifted up, and where every knee bows and every tongue confesses his Lordship

Where the curse upon the land issued at the fall of man has been lifted

Where the land has been healed and plants and the trees yield their fruit in season (Ps. 104)

Where rain falls in its season and the weather is predictable (without drought or floods)

Where families own their own homes, land and assets to generate sufficient household food security

Where children are healthy and free from dangerous illness

Where every child born lives expecting to die only at the end of a long, fruitful and useful life

Where mothers live through safe pregnancies and deliver their babies without complications

Where mothers & fathers not only love the Lord but each other and their children and teach them to love the Lord

Where families reflect models of the triune Godhead (Fatherhood/Fellowship/Love/Resonance/Perfect Understanding)

Where children are brought up in loving caring families and nurtured and taught the

'way they must go' as they grow

Where wages are fair and just

Where the birds sing happily in the trees

Where every family has enough food to eat and no family takes desperate steps to sell their children or have them resort to prostitution

Where desperate migration is not necessary, and when it does happen, it is only for better work or education

Where the council of elders in each village and community is able to resolve all disputes justly at their own level

Where life is at a pace where it is easy to balance work - leisure - family time - reflection - study of the word - and relationships

Where those in authority are concerned and care for the welfare of those in their charge and are continuously planning for their betterment

Where the quest of the national leadership is to seek and pursue 'fullness of life for every individual'

Because a transformed nation is one that progressively moves toward God intended permanent change!

V.

A Biblical/Theological Framework

A Biblical/Theological Framework[11]

WORLD

The Biblical creation narrative asserts that God is Creator and all God created was good. The purpose of the whole creation was to glorify the Creator. Man and woman were created in the image of God and appointed stewards of God's creation (Gen. 1-2). Satan succeeded in tempting Adam and Eve to sin, thereby breaking their relationship with God. Satan presented himself as rival to God. As "ruler of the kingdom of the air" Satan instigated rebellion against God (Eph. 2:2), but man and woman are responsible before God for their choices. All of human life and endeavor is marked by this struggle between the kingdom of this world and the kingdom of God. From Genesis 3 through Revelation 22 the Scriptures give an account of God's ceaseless efforts to redeem humankind and restore his people to their rightful role as stewards of the earth. God's final initiative was to send Jesus Christ to deliver this world from Satan's power and call all peoples to accept God's gift of salvation through Jesus Christ (Acts 26:18-20). The death and resurrection of Jesus Christ marked the victory of God over Satan (Isa. 25:7-8; 1 Cor. 15:54-57). All are called to respond to this message and are accountable for their response (Acts 10:42-43). Jesus' model prayer, "Your kingdom come, your will be done on earth as it is in heaven," is a divine mandate for social transformation as God calls us to love God and our neighbor as the summary of all his commandments. Because of the bloodshed on the cross, God's people have the spiritual authority to confront the principalities and powers of darkness and to proclaim the message of God's work and reflecting his righteous presence, thus moving together toward transforming the world.

SCOPE OF THE GOSPEL

As Creator, God is Lord of all, and, therefore, his redemptive concern is comprehensive—seeking to heal and restore "all things" by means of Christ's atoning sacrifice on the cross (Gen. 1:31a; Rom. 8:18-23; Col. 1:19-20). The church's calling is to witness to the kingdom of God in its fullness (Matt. 4:23; Mark 1:15; Luke 4:18-21). To be faithful to the gospel the ministry of the body of Christ must be wholistic—encompassing the whole person—spiritual, physical, and social, and all human relationships—with God, with others, and with the environment (Gen. 1:26-28). Anything less than concern for all spheres of life is to misrepresent the all-encompassing Lordship of Jesus Christ over the world.

THE PEOPLES OF THE WORLD

The kingdom of God advances as individuals hear and accept the gospel by faith, are born again, experiencing inward regeneration and *transformation expressed* in obedience to "all I have commanded" (John 3:3, 16; Matt. 28:19-20; Acts 2:21; Rom. 1:16-17). However, God's concern goes beyond the salvation of the individual. God's redemptive plan encompasses all families, tribes and nations (Gen. 12:1-2; Matt. 28:19-20; Rev. 7:9). As the people of God faithfully witness to the love, truth and power of the Gospel in whatever sphere of life they serve, individuals will be touched and transformed. In this way they

become the salt and light that transform society, thus fulfilling the mandate to “disciple all nations” (Matt. 28:19).

WORLDVIEW

As the inspired and authoritative Word of God, the Bible provides a comprehensive worldview, revealing God's truth to all peoples about the nature of ultimate reality, the source of evil, the origin and nature of the physical universe, the meaning and purpose of human life, and the goal of history (John 17:17; 2 Tim. 3:16-17; Gen. 1:1; Col. 1:15-18). Christ's disciples are those whose minds have been renewed by actively putting off false worldviews—distortions of the truth used by Satan to enslave individuals and nations—by being transformed by the biblical worldview (Matt. 22:37; Rom. 1:18-23; 12:2; 2 Cor. 10:3-5; Col. 2:6-8; 1 Peter 1:13). The discipling of the nations requires that the disciples of Jesus Christ allow the biblical worldview to enlighten and enliven every area of their lives and carry it into each sphere of society in order to set men and women free (Isa. 11:9b; Matt. 28:18-20; John 8:31-32).

APPLICATION IN LIFE, FAMILY AND VOCATION

As Jesus was God in human flesh, so the church—as the body of Christ—is to manifest Jesus Christ in human flesh as it ministers in the midst of this broken world (John 1:14; Rom. 13:14a; Eph. 5:1; Phil. 2:5-8). As the watching world looks upon the church, Christ's love, sacrificial service, and humble obedience should be clearly reflected (Matt. 22:37-40; 25:32-46; Jas. 2:14-19; 1 John 2:3, 3:16-18, 4:19-21; Rev. 19:7-8). As the Godhead is a community, so we believe that God's nature and character are most clearly displayed in the world when kingdom life is incarnated in community as the body of Christ (Eph. 4:11-13; John 15:12-17).

IMPLEMENTATION THROUGH THE BODY OF CHRIST

The body and bride of Christ—the church—is ordained to be God's primary agent in advancing the kingdom of God (Matt. 16:18-19; Eph. 1:22-23, 3:8-11). The present expression of the universal church is the living, worldwide body of redeemed people who have placed their faith in the person and work of Christ alone for the forgiveness of their sins, have been adopted as children of God, and have been given God’s Spirit as a pledge of their inheritance and the source of their power to fulfill God’s purposes. The local church is the intentional local expression of the universal church that meets regularly for worship, equipping, fellowship and service, making the gospel credible as the incarnate body of Christ in a particular locale (Eph. 2:14-22; 1 Pet. 2:9-10; 1 Cor. 12:4-13, 12:27-28). At the same time the local church engages in discipling the nations by setting apart for cross-cultural ministry those called by the Holy Spirit (Acts 1:8, 11:19-30, 13:1-3).

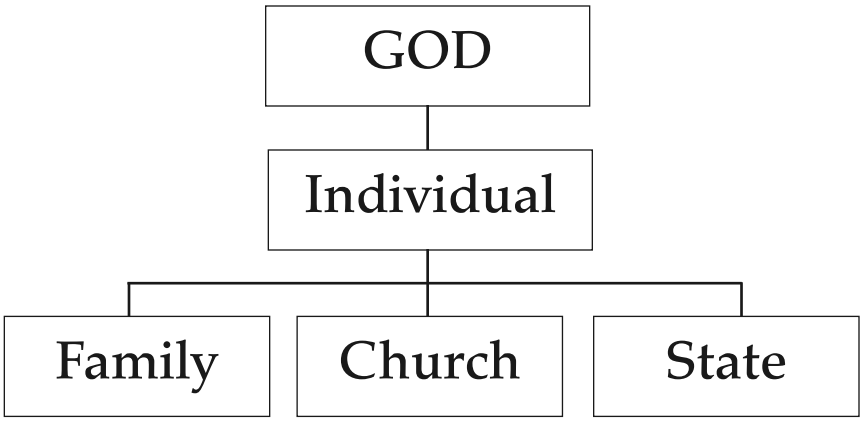
THE ESCHATOLOGICAL MOTIVE

The transformational changes taking place through the kingdom of God on earth should be kept in the perspective of “already—not yet.” Transformation will be completed when God announces “I am making everything new!” from his throne at the return of Christ (Rev. 21:5). In the meantime, we are urged to live transformed lives and look forward to the day of God and speed its coming (2 Pet. 3:11-13). Only then will there be “a new heaven and a new earth, the home of righteousness.” As the first coming of Christ has motivated his disciples to witness and serve (2 Cor. 5:14) so the second coming of Christ gives urgency to living transformed lives and doing transformational missions (2 Pet. 3:14; 2 Cor. 5:11).

The Biblical Conception Of Society[12]

BIBLICAL JURISDICTIONAL AUTHORITY

Jesus taught we are to "render to Caesar the things that are Caesar's; and to God the things that are God's" (Matt. 12:17-21). The problem is that many have rendered to Caesar the things that are God's. To whom has God commissioned to do what?



Purpose and Responsibilities of Individuals and Divine Institutions

THE INDIVIDUAL'S PURPOSE AND RESPONSIBILITIES:

1. WORSHIP – "LOVE THE LORD YOUR GOD." (Luke 10:27; Deut. 6:5)
Man's primary purpose is to glorify God and enjoy him forever
   a. Personal prayer, Bible reading/study/meditation
   b. Assemble with other believers
   c. Christian Sabbath observance

2. CHARITY – "LOVE YOUR NEIGHBOR." (Luke 10:27; Lev. 19:9-18; Matt. 25:35-36)
The Golden rule: Do unto others as you would have them do unto you
   a. Assist the needy and show mercy
   b. Speak the truth – evangelism, exhortation, edification
   c. Involvement in society/government (conversion of institutions)

3. WORK – "AS [YOU LOVE] YOURSELF" (Luke 10:27; Gen. 1:26-28, 2:15)
That man is God's creation and made in God's image is the foundation for self-worth, self-preservation, human dignity, and work. Our calling or work is the means of fulfilling the cultural mandate of being fruitful and subduing the earth.
   a. Provide for self and family – individuals will start businesses and create wealth
   b. Bless the nations – occurs as individuals provide needed goods and services

THE FAMILY'S PURPOSE AND RESPONSIBILITIES:

A family is simply a man, woman, children who are related by marriage, blood, or adoption. The ideal marriage has a man and woman who covenant together to fulfill God's desire for them to be fruitful and bless the world. Both parents are to fulfill their purpose

and responsibilities. In this context fathers (in general, but not exclusively) lead in society, while mothers raise the next generations (Gen. 2:18, 22-24, 3:16).

1. DOMINION AND PROCREATION (Gen. 1:28; 1 Tim. 5:10,14)
Be fruitful and multiply, subdue the earth.
   a. Pro-life – sanctity of life (Gen. 9:6)
   b. Children – a blessing (Ps. 127:3-5)

2. EDUCATION (Deut. 6:6-7)
"You shall teach your sons."
   a. Fit children to fulfill their individual purposes and responsibilities (Prov. 22:6)
   b. Build Godly character (Gen. 18:19)
   c. Train in a Biblical worldview (Ps. 78:5)
   d. Discipline as well as instruction (Eph. 6:4)

3. HEALTH AND WELFARE
Practice hospitality (Rom. 12:13), especially for those of your own household.
   a. Preventative health care – proper exercise, nutrition, sanitation
   We are the temple of God (1 Cor. 3:17, 6:17; 2 Cor. 6:16) and should seek to take care of ourselves and those in our charge. God is concerned with sanitation (Deut. 23:12-13; Num. 19:11-22), with what we eat (1 Cor. 6:12-20; Phil. 3:18-19), and with how we take care of our bodies (1 Tim. 4:7-8 tells us that bodily discipline is of profit, but only for a temporal time, while we are in the body).
   b. Taking care of the sick, elderly, orphan, widow (1 Tim. 5:4,8,10,16; Deut. 15:7,8,11, 14:28-29)
   c. Saving and investing for your retirement and your posterity (2 Cor. 12:14, Prov. 19:14, Deut. 21:17)

THE CHURCH'S PURPOSE AND RESPONSIBILITIES:

The church prepares people to govern society (to rule, Ps. 8:6), and to fulfill the redemption and creation commissions.

1. REGULAR INSTRUCTION OF MEMBERS IN BIBLICAL TRUTH FOR EVERY SPHERE OF LIFE
   a. Sunday preaching, regular classes, and other educational means (Mt. 28:18-20, 2 Tim. 3:16-17)
   b. Includes starting schools and colleges

2. ADMINISTER SACRAMENTS AND CHURCH DISCIPLINE (1 Cor. 5:8-13; 11:23-25; Mt. 18:15-17)
   a. Corporate worship and sacrifice (Gen. 4:3-5,26)
   b. Baptism and Lord's Supper (communion)
   c. Excommunication

3. DISCIPLING, EQUIPPING, AND ORGANIZING BELIEVERS (Eph. 4:11-12,16; Titus 3:8,14)
   a. Equipping the saints for the work of service, enabling them to fulfill their divine occupation or calling.
   b. Providing coordination and support for individuals and families to work in voluntary union with others to fulfill their purpose

c. Pastors are to be role models of what the church teaches in their personal conduct and through their involvement in society.

THE CIVIL GOVERNMENT'S (STATE'S) PURPOSE AND RESPONSIBILITIES:

1. PROTECT THE RIGHTEOUS, I.E. LAW-ABIDING CITIZENS (Rom. 13:3-4, 1 Pet. 2:13-14)
   a. Protection of life, liberty, and property from domestic and foreign lawbreakers. Governments are to secure God-given inalienable rights:
   LIFE
      Exod. 20:13 – "You shall not murder"
      Self-defense
      Government protection
   LIBERTY
      Ex. 21:16 – "He who kidnaps a man...shall be put to death."
      Freedom of worship
      Freedom of speech
      Freedom of assembly
      Freedom of the press
      Freedom of schools
      Right to petition government
   PROPERTY
      Ex. 20:15 – "You shall not steal."
      Private property
      Individual enterprise
      Acquire necessities of life
   b. Government coordinates civilian police for order and army for defense.
   c. Protection of rights from government abuse as well, via:
      Decentralized government
      Separation of powers
      Election of representatives

2. PUNISH THE EVIL DOER, I.E. CRIMINAL (Exod. 20:13, 21:12, 22:2)
   a. Set up constitution with just laws and penalties
   b. Impartial judges and fair trial to establish justice

3. ADMINISTER GOD'S JUSTICE
   a. Civil leaders are ministers of God for good (Rom. 13:4).
   b. They are to judge for God in matters under their jurisdiction.

VI.

Transformation Principles

We are being called to seek God in all his holiness, to humble ourselves as did Isaiah of old, to respond to God with a "yes" when he asks "Whom shall I send?" to seek the unity of God's servants and to cultivate creative transformational community initiatives to bless the peoples and the nations.

Principles emerge in response to the question "What will it take to achieve the vision for transformation?" Some of the proven principles include the following:

SPIRITUAL VITALITY – Laying the foundation for ministry through corporate spiritual growth

Experiencing the holiness of God with other leaders leads to repentance, humility, and deeper life commitment to Christ and his mission in the world.

RELATIONAL PRIORITY – Fueling momentum for ministry through loving relationships

Reconciling, forming and developing relationships of mutual love, respect, and trust enables leaders to work together for the common good of their community.

COMPELLING VISION – Aligning transformational efforts by maintaining vision for the completed task

Ongoing clear, compelling and comprehensive vision casting that involves everyone in the project brings about shared vision, values and strategy, common language and goals, urgency to act and a bonded team.

EMPOWERING LEADERSHIP – Identifying leaders and initiating a process for community transformation

Empowerment thrives from a growing base of committed leaders and no barriers to keep them from doing a good job. Effective leaders shepherd people and processes putting together the structures and strategies to carry out God's vision. Strategy results from the prayerful planning of leaders who recognize the activity of God in the community and make the large-scale adjustments needed to join him in that activity.

THOROUGH RESEARCH – Increasing understanding of the current realities of one's community

If the Church wants to be relevant and effective in the community, it needs good information that describes the community's people and need, the condition of the church; and the spiritual forces which influence current reality. The Church must see the city as it truly is; not just what it seems to be. These data will show leaders God's top priorities and highest leverage (greatest results per effort) ministries that will bring about the most impact and lasting results.

LOVING SERVICE – Enacting high leverage opportunities to minister to the community

Building bridges through acts of service and kindness establishes relationships of trust and credibility with the community. People open their lives to those who genuinely care about personal and community needs and more often will open their heart to the One who empowers loving service.

INTENTIONAL LEARNING – Making a fresh commitment to individual and corporate learning around needed skills and effective ministry models.

Constructing the right structures and steps to work together effectively means we must use the assets God has given us to their fullest extent - committing ourselves to training and ongoing learning.

Finding out what the church needs to learn to bring about greater impact is crucial to achieving its goals. For many of us, community transformation means a shift in our underlying philosophies, as well as learning new skills.

Building the church's ability to facilitate change in the city requires a community of learners who are committed to discovering new ways to achieve god's plans and purposes.[13]

Transformation As Restoration[14]

Biblical transformation can be defined as the process of restoration to God's intentions of all that was broken when man rebelled against God in the Fall.[15]

God's agenda is to restore all things to himself making known to us the mystery of his will, according to his purpose, which he set forth in Christ as a plan for the fullness of time, to unite all things in him, things in heaven and things on earth (Eph. 1:10) and "God was pleased to have all his fullness dwell in him, and through him to reconcile to himself all things, whether things on earth or things in heaven…" (Col. 1:19-20). In biblical restoration promises you will discover what God will restore in the following:

1. THE LOST SENSE OF JUSTICE: Isaiah 1:26—"I will restore your judgesas in days of old, your counselors as at the beginning. Afterward you will be called the City of Righteousness, the Faithful City." The ravages of sin have brought about an insensitivity to justice. A lawlessness rules without the honoring of absolutes, or the framework upon which a just community can be based. God promises to restore His people so their lives can be based on justice, which makes life available as it was intended to be lived.
2. LOST INTIMACY WITH GOD: The prophet Jeremiah spoke, "For I know the plans I have for you," declares the Lord, "plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future" (Jer. 29:11). The power of the promise is that it is spoken duringthe season when Israel is reaping the judgment she has sown. Even then, God is saying, "This will pass. This is not what Iintend for you. I will bring you to peace. I will bring you to the expectations, which are still possible because you are My people." God wants to heal the wounds of his judgment andrestore your heart to himself.
3. LOST TIME: Joel 2:25—"I will repay you for the years the locustshave eaten— the great locust and the young locust, the other locusts and the locust swarm _—my great army that I sent among you." It would be enough if the Lord had promised to restore what had been ravaged by the plagues of locusts. Instead, he moved beyond the material substance, extending the promise of restoration to the time which had been lost because of the plagues! Sin and its consequences rob man of his most valuable possession: time. But when the heart returns to God, restoration of lost years in a marriage can be restored; lost years in parenting can be restored; the lost years of youth, when valuable lessons could have been learned, can be restored. Your years … can be restored!

Transformation Partnerships:

Seven Key Principles for Effective Work Together[16]

Principle # 1

Effective partnerships for transformation require an inspiring, action-oriented vision. The vision must clearly be beyond the capacity of an individual or single ministry.

That vision must meet three criteria:

The vision must clearly be something God wants done

There must be clear value & relevance for each participating ministry–bringing value to their ministry goals

There must be limited yet high value, achievable objectives in the beginning allowing the partnership to have encouraging success in the early stages

Scripture: Nehemiah 1:11-18, Proverbs 29:18, Isaiah 50:7, John 10:10, John 17:4

Principle #2

Effective transformation partnerships are built on commitment to active, consistent prayer.

The prayer must focus on:

Our relationships as we work together

Those we are seeking to reach & serve

Wisdom regarding the specific vision God puts on our hearts

The consensus & unity we need to focus our energy & work together

Any differences in background and ideas on strategy

For our families and those who support and pray for us

That Satan's power will be broken and Jesus' power will break through

Scripture: I Samuel 12:23, Proverbs 15:8-9, Matthew 21:22, Acts 1:14, 6:4, Romans 12:12

Principle #3

Effective partnerships are based on open, trusting relationships.

These relationships are built by:

Taking time to truly know each other's spiritual journey and ministry vision

Taking time to know each other's family, ministry experience, and calling

Spending time in prayer – for each other first and then for the work together

Being committed to each other's personal welfare, not just the partnership's success

Focusing on the things we have in common, not the differences that can divide us

Scripture: Psalm 133, Matthew 5:23, John 17:21-23, Romans 12, Ephesians 4:3

Principle #4

Effective, lasting partnerships for transformation are a process, not an event.

Key stages are:

Exploration (getting to know the key leaders and the primary issues)

Formation (meeting, praying, defining vision/goals, deciding on action)

On-going operation (turning the initial limited but high-value goals into action)

Key elements are:

Get to know one another and build relationship, initially "one on one"

Calling a group meeting too early can often be counterproductive

Keep the big challenge clearly in everyone's heart but agree on very practical outcomes – particularly in the early stages

Small steps first, bigger ones later - walk before you run

Scripture: Joshua 1:5-9, Nehemiah 3, John 4:35-38, I Corinthians 3:1-9

Principle #5

Effective transformation partnerships have a dedicated facilitator for whom the partnership and its vision is their primary priority.

This person must:

Be both servant and prophet

Be energetic, always looking forward, yet patient, always ready to listen, serve, and deal with day to day issues

Be committed to the partnership's transformation goals and the welfare of each partner ministry

Be able to keep confidential matters confidential and always do what they personally promise

Be a person of spiritual maturity, compassion, and personal integrity

Hold strongly the conviction that the power of the Gospel transforms lives and communities

Scripture: II Chronicles 1:7-12, Nehemiah 1:4-9, II Corinthians 1:24, Galatians 5:22-26, I Peter 5:3-7

Principle #6

Effective transformation partnerships focus first on the what (the goal) rather than the how (the structure).

The human spirit seeks to find safety in structure and predictability. Starting first with organizational issues is a dead-end for transformational partnerships. Vision must always come first. Always keep the organizational structure to the absolute minimum necessary to accomplish the partnership's vision. Do as much as possible through prayer and consensus rather than depending on a constitution and voting rights!

Scripture: Judges 7:1-25, II Samuel 5:17-25, Mark 6:7-13, Acts 13:1-3, I Corinthians 1:27

Principle #7

Effective transformation partnerships celebrate the diversity of their members, their common calling, and the success God gives them.

Lasting Kingdom partnerships are rare and must be celebrated as we see His Spirit's blessing. Celebration acknowledges that we can do more together than we can do

individually. The diversity in backgrounds, callings, and gifts that make up our partnership are a demonstration of God's generosity and call for celebration.

Acknowledging success and celebrating what God has done as we work together brings hope and encouragement to expand the vision and carry on.

Scripture: Nehemiah 12:27-43, Luke 10:17-24, Acts 14:26-28, I Corinthians 1:4-10, 12:12-26

Fundamental Principles Of Christian Nations[17]

Every nation is built upon some set of ideas or presuppositions that are rooted in the faith of the people; hence, all nations have a religious foundation. The source of law of a society is the god of that society.

By "Christian nation" we do not mean that the state, regime or ruler that governs a nation are literally "Christian", nor that all, or even the majority of the people or of the governants of a nation are believers in the Christian faith. We define a "Christian nation" as one that is founded upon Biblical principles, where Biblical truth and law are the standard for public life, law, and societal institutions. Such was explicitly the intent of the Founding Fathers when they established the United States of America.

SEVEN FUNDAMENTAL PRINCIPLES THAT SUPPORT CHRISTIAN NATIONS

1. SELF-GOVERNMENT
   Government means direction, regulation, control, restraint. There are two spheres of government, internal and external. Internal government is self-government. External government is manifested in the home, church, school, business, associations, and civil arena. The internal is causative to the external. The external is a reflection of the internal. All government begins internally in the heart of man. Effective government begins by an individual learning to govern himself.

2. UNION OR COVENANT
   The people of a free nation will voluntarily work in union with each other for the common good of the entire nation. The external union of a people results from an internal unity of ideas and principles residing in the hearts of the people. Historically, civil covenants developed in Christian nations where the people first covenanted together to form a church estate. Christianity provided the basis of a "community united, not by external bonds, but by the vital force of distinctive ideas and principles." Stronger internal bonds within a people will produce a stronger union.

3. INDIVIDUALITY
   All of creation reflects the Creator. Man is created in the image of God, and hence has great value. Man reflects his creator and displays a unity with diversity. Each person is unique and distinct, with a unique calling or destiny. God gives us the talents and skills and characteristics we need to fulfill our calling; however, we must develop our talents through labor or we will lose them. Nations also display the principle of individuality—they have unique destinies and characteristics that we must identify so as to assist in the fulfillment of their providential purpose.

4. PROPERTY OR CONSCIENCE

A person's property is whatever he has exclusive right to possess and control. Property is first internal. Conscience is the most precious aspect of property. Internal property includes our thoughts, talents, ideas, and conscience; external property includes land, money, possessions, freedom of speech, and freedom of assembly. Governments exist to protect property of every sort. Tyrannical governments plunder, instead of protect, the property of its citizens. We are to be good stewards of all property God puts into our hands. Labor is the title deed to property.

5. EDUCATION

An ignorant people will quickly become an enslaved people. God desires everyone to be educated in the truth. Education is a sowing and reaping process. It is like a seed, where you reap what you sow. The philosophy of the schools in one generation will be the philosophy of government in the next. Biblical education will implant morals in the people as well as a biblical worldview. Biblical education is a means of extending God's Kingdom in the earth, while secular state education is the means of extending man's kingdom in the earth.

6. MORALITY OR CHRISTIAN CHARACTER

No nation can long endure without morality in the people. Virtuous citizens are the greatest security from enslavement (either from internal or external invaders) in a country. Citizens and leaders with Christian character are necessary for the preservation of life, liberty, and property. All spheres of life— government, business, family, education, law— are positively affected by people of Christian character.

7. FAITH IN GOD AND HIS WORD

The foundational principles of a free society flow out of Christianity, for a living Christian faith produces self-governed, moral people who work together with others for the common good, recognizing the great value of the individual and property rights, and desiring to teach all people eternal absolute truths. History reveals that the degree that nations have applied the principles of the Bible, is the degree that those nations have prospered and been free. Every nation is based upon some religion. Christianity produces, not only individual, but also civil liberty.

VII.

Transforming The Divinely Ordained Institutions

The Family

Transformation: First Personal, Then Relational, Lastly Social
Healing the Culture through Transformational Marriage and Relationships [18]

To be authentic, effective and lasting, transformation must begin internally, and then manifest itself externally. Personal transformation must precede and under gird social transformation. Thus, no one should embrace the call to transform their community, society or nation, who has not committed himself to allow God to simultaneously transform him. We are his workmanship, his showpiece. His inward work in us is the necessary platform for the works he has prepared for us to do with him.

TRANSFORMATION IS GOD-INITIATED, Spirit-directed, and it is designed to equip us both to know and to do God's will. "*Therefore I urge you, brothers, in view of God's mercy, to offer your bodies as living sacrifices, holy and pleasing to God – this is your spiritual act of worship. Do not conform any longer to the pattern of this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what God's will is – his good, pleasing and perfect will."* (Rom. 12:1 and 2.)

TRANSFORMATION IS GOD'S WORK. The Holy Spirit is the agent, inviting the active partnership of each of us, guiding and teaching us all the truth we need to know about Him, ourselves, and our neighbors. "*You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you to go and bear fruit—fruit that will last*" (John 15:16).

TRANSFORMATION ONLY OCCURS IN RELATIONSHIPS. God's work in us is inextricably linked to the way we treat others, because the love of God is inseparable from the love of neighbor. "*The most important one,' answered Jesus, "is this: 'Hear, O Israel, the Lord our God, the Lord is one. Love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind and with all your strength.'The second is this: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.' There is no commandment greater than these*" (Mark 12:29-31).

God's work in us is made manifest, not by the way we speak to him, or the works we do for him, but by the way we treat one another. Our personal transformation must bear fruit in relational transformation. *"If I speak in the tongues of men and of angels, but have not love, I am only a resounding gong or a clanging cymbal. If I have the gift of prophecy and can fathom all mysteries and all knowledge, and if I have a faith that can move mountains, but have not love, I am nothing*" (1 Cor. 12:1-2).

Our love of God, then, must bear fruit in our love of our neighbor, the one who lives near us. For those of us who are married, our nearest –and dearest- "neighbor" is our spouse, so "near" to us that God considers us "one" in Him. "*For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united to his wife, and the two will become one flesh.' So they are no longer two, but one. Therefore what God has joined together, let man not separate*" (Mark 10:7-9).

Marriage Is The Most Important And Powerful Transformational Relationship

The first-fruit of our personal and relational transformation must be manifested in our marriage, because the way we treat our spouse should reflect the relationship of Christ and the church. The Apostle stresses this, repeating it five times in Ephesians 5:21-32:

- The husband is the head of the wife as Christ is the head of the church
- As the church submits to Christ, so also wives should submit to their husbands
- Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her….
- Husbands ought to love their wives as their own bodies... just as Christ does the church.
- I am talking about Christ and the church.

The same passage also shows that loving our spouse is the perfect fulfillment of the second great commandment: "*He who loves his wife loves himself and each one of you also must love his wife as he loves himself.*"

God designed marriage as an image of his own love, a living illustration of his love covenant with mankind. Marriage is therefore the most perfect and powerful love relationship possible between two human beings. It is the fulcrum of God's love, its most potent manifestation on the earth.

Christian marriage is a three-way covenant because *what God has joined together* is a man and a woman who were already joined to him. Because of this, the marriage and its fruit, the family, are "the origin" of, and also "the original" church. "For where two or three come together in my name, there am I with them" (Matt. 18:20).

Indeed, marriage is unique among all human relationships. It is the most complete, fulfilling and fruitful possible experience, an exclusive and life-long bonding which God ordains, sanctifies, and personally inhabits. The indwelling Spirit in each completes and perfects their unity, rehearsing the perfect unity of the Body of Christ, and the promised unity of Christ with his Bride. Christian marriage is not only mind-to-mind, soul-to-soul and body-to-body unity, but also the most fulfilling unity of all: oneness in, by and with the Spirit.

Their complete unity makes husband and wife perfect partners in their mutual growth and discipleship. They can clearly see in the other what neither can see for themselves, *the speck in your neighbor's eye*. And since each is pledged to *lay their life for their friend*, their covenant becomes one focused on maturing and growing in Christ together, "*until we all reach unity in the faith and in the knowledge of the Son of God and become mature, attaining to the whole measure of the fullness of Christ*" (Eph 4:13).

Christian marriage is therefore the most powerful instrument for personal and relational transformation possible. As mutual mentors unto Christ, husband and wife embrace the life-long, loving and sacrificial mission of helping the other to overcome the emotional and spiritual sin baggage of each, maturing in Christ, and being transformed, and transformational, in all their relationships. The power of heaven backs their sanctifying goal. They can ask anything according to God's will, and rely on Him who is faithful who promised, who will also do it. "*…I tell you that if two of you on earth agree about anything you ask*

for, it will be done for you by my Father in heaven" (Matt. 18:19).

Personal and relational transformation can be powerfully nurtured by a marriage of disciples committed to growth and wholeness in Christ through marital transformation. The family is thus both the platform and the engine for social, community, national and world transformation, to the glory of God.

The joy and transformational power of the marital union takes a different form for those who are called to singleness, widowhood or have the gift of celibacy. Through godly relationships they too can grow, establishing covenants with Christ and, for Christ's sake, with those He puts in their lives (their neighbours, or "near ones"). Transparent, committed, accountable relationships of natural and spiritual kinship, friendship and co-laboring in Christ can be deeply satisfying, mutually beneficial and fruitful. As in godly marriage, the parties must make of their life in Christ the touchstone and growing in him the mutual priority. Thus, they will experience the transformational power of Christ's love in their relationship with another human being, "*as iron sharpens iron*" and "*deep calls unto deep*." "Johnathan made a covenant with David because he loved him as himself" (1 Sam 18:1,3,17). "*Two are better than one... a chord of three-stands is not quickly broken...*" (Eccles. 4:9-12).

The effect, by instruction, influence and example of godly, adult transformational relationships upon the young is incalculable. It has a multiplying effect upon the generation, not only through the multiplication which is the object of godly marriage, but also through the simple synergy which unity in Christ necessarily produces. "*Train up a child in the way that he should go; and when he is old he will not depart from it*" (Prov. 22:6).

The Church

The Transformational Church: Characteristics Of The Church As God's Agent Of Spiritual And Social Transformation In Its Community

Formulae and strategies cannot convert a church into an agent of spiritual and social transformation in its community overnight. What it does mean is that churches that are making an impact that is truly evangelical, rooted in the gospel and consequently bringing about transformation in society, are churches that share certain characteristics that contribute to that impact. [19]

What are these characteristics? What are the marks of a church which, through the power of the Spirit, is prepared to fulfill its role in its own surroundings as "salt of the earth" and "light of the world," a task to which all followers of Jesus Christ have been called? Obviously, one prerequisite for practicing wholisticism is to be a wholistic church.

That is not to say a perfect church, for that would render integral mission impossible. It means a church in which God's Spirit is free to act so that in it the Word of God becomes flesh. It means a church which is making progress in its own transformation and the transformation of the community in which it serves. More concretely, an integral church is a community of faith which gives priority to:

1) its commitment to Jesus Christ as Lord of everything and everyone;

2) Christian discipleship as a missionary lifestyle to which the entire church and every

member have been called;

3) the vision of the church as the community that confesses Jesus Christ as Lord and lives in the light of that confession in such a way that in it can be seen as the inauguration of a new humanity; and

4) its use of gifts and ministries as instruments that the Spirit of God employs to prepare the church and all its members to fulfill their vocation as God's co-workers in the world. [20]

The Civil Government

The Power And Form Of Free Governments

Both a Christian power (internal ideas and principles) and form (external frameworks and structures) are necessary for freedom. The pathway to liberty within a nation is from the internal to the external, from the inside out, from the bottom up.

Seven Ideas That Have Transformed The World [21]

(Summary by Stephen McDowell of Chapter 2, *The American Dream*)

To transform the nations, we must plant seeds of liberty; that is, the Christian ideas that formed the foundation of Western civilization and made America the most free, just, and prosperous nation in history. The seed determines the fruit. Ideas determine what a culture or nation will be. All ideas are not the same; therefore, all nations are not the same, since the foundational ideas have differed. Some nations have more liberty, prosperity, justice, and virtue than others. The Bible teaches, and history confirms, that the most free and prosperous nations are those that have most embraced the following seven ideas.

1. THE CHRISTIAN IDEA OF GOD AND THEOLOGY
   The most important thing about a person is his view of God. The most important thing about a society is its view of God. This is true because we become like who or what, we worship. People are always moving toward their image of God. Since Christianity is the revealed truth of the Creator, cultures embracing Christianity have moved toward the true image and nature of God and the true state of reality within His universe. The unique aspects of God only revealed in the Christian faith (such as the Triune nature of God, justification by faith, and the priesthood of the believer) have implications in the economy, law, form of government, education, family life, and so on. Christianity produces all kinds of liberty; personal, religious, civil, political, and economic.

2. THE CHRISTIAN IDEA OF MAN
   Man is not an accident of nature, merely a material being. Man is created in the image of God, having great value and a right to life, liberty, and property. However, man is sinful, in a fallen state, and in need of a redeemer. Christ's redemptive work adds great value to man. Understanding man's value, as well as his sinfulness, affects economics, invention, business, the medical field, forms of government and education, essentially all areas of life.

3. THE CHRISTIAN IDEA OF THE FAMILY
   The family is the basic building block of society. As the family goes, so goes the nation. The state of the family determines the state of the church, education, business, arts,

civil government, and life. The home is the first sphere of society. The true idea of family is realized only in the context of Christianity. Christianity defines the family's mission, purpose, and nature; plus it gives principles for strong and successful families. Simply stated, the purpose of the family is to be fruitful, to multiply, and take dominion over the earth (Gen. 1:28). The family is the institution that God created to provide education, health, and welfare for all its members. The family is responsible to govern property and children. The Christian view of the family elevated women.

4. THE CHRISTIAN IDEA OF TRUTH (LAW)
   A Christian worldview proclaims that there is truth, there is right and wrong, that there are absolutes we can know. The Bible is God's Word and the source of truth to all men. "Truth" for much of the world today is relative. From a humanistic perspective there is no absolute truth. The Christian idea of truth says there are fixed laws that apply to everyone and are always true. This concept is the foundation for the rule of law, constitutional government, and inalienable rights of all men.

5. THE CHRISTIAN IDEA OF CREATION AND HISTORY
   God created all things and He has a purpose for His creation. His creation functions upon a set of laws, physical and moral, that He built into the fabric of his universe. We can and should discover those laws. As we apply them, we are taking dominion over the earth and bringing advancement to mankind. These laws touch all areas of life, from understanding the force of gravity to understanding the Biblical power and form of government.

   God has a purpose for his creation that has been unfolding throughout history. Events of history, all of which contribute to his purpose and plan for mankind, have not been occurring by chance, but under the direction of the Sovereign God. This providential view of history produces optimism as we look to the future. God ultimately directs history, but he has given man authority, power, and the ability to rule God's creation — to change and direct what happens in the earth. If things are bad or not right, we can change them.

6. THE CHRISTIAN IDEA OF GOVERNMENT
   All government begins in the heart of man with his ability (or inability) to direct, regulate, manage, and control his life. There are two spheres of government — internal and external. Internal government is self-government. External government occurs in the family, church, business, associations, and civil government. External spheres of government are a reflection of the degree of internal self-government a person or people possess. Internal government is causative to external government.

   The flow of power in a Christian society is from the internal to the external, from the inside out. All authority and power comes from God. It flows from Him into the heart and mind of man, and then out into the family, church, business, schools, and civil realm. Civil government is a divine institution with a legitimate function, but it is limited. It is to protect the righteous, punish the evil doer, and administer God's justice in the civil realm that is under its sphere of authority. The state exists to serve man. The state is not our savior.

7. THE CHRISTIAN IDEA OF EDUCATION
   Biblical education is the means of sanctifying men and extending God's kingdom. All

people must be educated so they can know the truth themselves. Knowledge of truth brings liberty to men and nations, while ignorance produces bondage. Education is much more than imparting knowledge and skills; it is preparing people to fulfill their destiny in assisting to advance God's kingdom in the earth. G.K. Chesterton said: "Education is simply the soul of a society as it passes from one generation to another. Whatever the soul is like, it will have to be passed on somehow, consciously or unconsciously…It is…the transfer of a way of life." Christian education passes on the biblical way of life. State education today is passing on a secular, humanistic, socialistic way of life.

The Bible teaches that parents have the right and responsibility to govern the education of their children. This idea has motivated Christians throughout history to educate their children at home, to start schools and colleges, and to make education available to all citizens. All education is religious — it imparts a basic set of principles and ideals, a worldview. How the youth are educated today will determine the course the nation takes in the future.

The Source Of Transformational Ideas

Christianity is the source of these ideas that have transformed western civilization. As a result of the Protestant Reformation, God's Word was made available to the common man, which gave him access to the ideas that produce liberty, prosperity, justice, and virtue.

VIII.

Signs Of Transformation [22]

Jesus did more than preach the kingdom; he demonstrated its reality with "signs of the kingdom," public evidence that the kingdom he was talking about had come. These "signs of the kingdom," are the same as signs of transformation.

Since "*the reason the Son of God appeared was to destroy the devil's work*" (1 John. 3:8), he inevitably came into collision with the prince of darkness.

The signs of the kingdom were evidences that the devil was retreating before the advance of the King. As Jesus put it, once the strong man has been overpowered by the Stronger One, his possessions can be taken from him (Matt. 12:29; Luke 11:22).

Similarly, signs of transformation prompted by God-initiatives often through transformed individuals and the Church which is the body of Christ also evidence the advance of the King of Glory in the 21st Century.

The **first** sign of transformation was (and still is) Jesus himself in the midst of his people (Luke 17:21; Matt. 18:20), whose presence brings joy, peace, and a sense of celebration (John 15:11, 16:33; Mark 2:18-20).

The **second** sign is the preaching of the Gospel. There was no Gospel of the kingdom to proclaim until Christ arrived. Now that he has come, however, the good news of the kingdom must be preached to all, especially to the poor (Luke 4:18, 19, 7:22). The preaching of the Kingdom points people to the kingdom itself.

The **third** sign of transformation was exorcism. Although the "principalities and powers" may have a reference to demonic ideologies and structures, they are evil, personal intelligences under the command of the devil. Demon possession is a real and terrible condition. Deliverance is possible only in a power encounter in which the name of Jesus is invoked and prevails.

The **fourth** sign of transformation was and is the healing and the nature miracles making the blind see, the deaf hear, the lame walk, the sick whole, raising the dead (Luke 7:22), stilling the storm, and multiplying loaves and fishes. We all agree that these were not only signs pointing to the reality of the Kingdom's arrival, but also anticipations of the final Kingdom from which all disease, hunger, disorder and death will be forever banished. We also agree that God is still free and powerful, and performs miracles today, especially in frontier situations where the Kingdom is advancing into enemy-held territory. Some Christians think we should expect miracles as commonly as in the ministry of Jesus and his apostles (e.g., John 14:12), while others draw attention to the texts which describe these miracles as authenticating their unique ministry (e.g., Heb. 2:3, 4; 2 Cor. 12:12).

A **fifth** sign of transformation is the miracle of conversion and the new birth. Whenever people "turn to God from idols, to serve the living and true God" (1 Thess. 1: 9,10), a power encounter has taken place in which the spell of idols, whether traditional or modern, and of the spirits, has been broken. God's power for salvation is displayed in the Gospel (Rom. 1: 16), and converts who have been rescued from darkness to light and from the

power of Satan to God (Acts 26:18) are said to have "tasted ... the powers of the age to come" (Heb. 6:5).

A **sixth** sign of transformation is the people of the kingdom, in whom is manifested that cluster of Christ like qualities which Paul called "the fruit of the Spirit". For the gift of the Spirit is the supreme blessing of the kingdom of God. Where he rules, love, joy, peace and righteousness rule with him (Gal. 5:22, 23; Rom. 14:17). Moreover, love issues in good works. Thus, if the Gospel is good news of the kingdom, good works are the signs of transformation. Good news and good works, evangelism and social responsibility, are once again seen to be indissolubly united.

The **seventh** sign of transformation is suffering. It was necessary for the King to suffer in order to enter into his glory. Indeed, he suffered for us, leaving us an example that we should follow in his steps (I Pet. 2:21). To suffer for the sake of righteousness or for our testimony to Jesus, and to bear such suffering courageously, is a clear sign to all beholders that we have received God's salvation or kingdom (Phil. 1:28,29; cf. 2 Thess. 1:5).

Impact On Individuals, Churches And Nations

Transformation is a reference to two points of time in the history of an individual, a community or a nation: where they are now and where they once were. It is more important to compare where an individual, community or nation is today with where it was in the past than merely to look at where they are on the transformational continuum. [23]

The result of transformation is always remarkable, and often beyond imagination. It cannot be predicted or extrapolated from the current situation, nor from present resources or methods. "So will it be with the resurrection of the dead. The body that is sown is perishable, it is raised imperishable; it is sown in dishonor, it is raised in glory; it is sown in weakness, it is raised in power; it is sown a natural body, it is raised a spiritual body" (1 Cor. 15.42-44).

The Transformational Individual: Characteristics Of Individuals As Catalysts Of Spiritual And Social Transformation

Christ's disciples must have their minds renewed by actively putting off false worldviews—distortions of the truth used by Satan to enslave individuals and nations—and be transformed by the biblical worldview (Matt. 22:37; Rom. 1:18-23, 12:2; 2 Cor. 10:3-5; Col. 2:6-8; 1 Peter 1:13). The discipleship of nations requires that Christ's followers allow the biblical worldview to enlighten every area of their lives, and carry it outward into every sphere of society (Isa. 11:9b; Matt. 28:18-20; John 8:31-32).

Typically, a transformation process begins with a catalytic core of saints who embrace a lifestyle of persistent repentance, humility, and sacrificial servanthood. This both demonstrates and attracts the favor and presence of God, and breaks the predominating influences of the ruling powers of human flesh and negative spiritual forces.

Christians engaged in a transformational mission – "transformational catalysts" – begin with a fresh awareness of the holiness of God which leads to greater humility. The humility of the servants of God makes way for a spirit of unity. Greater unity leads to the cultivation of a transformed and transformational community sensitized to discover, em-

brace and become servant catalysts on his mission of transformation. These transformational catalysts from around the world contemplate the beauty of God's movements and then seek to cooperate with him, as they invest themselves in transformation coordination and leadership.

- Transformation coordination is exercised in the belief that we can do more together than we can separately, and that this will enable us to move to a new ministry impact level.
- Transformational leaders are committed to engage new generations in participatory leadership with them.

And the cycle repeats itself.

The Transformational Church: Characteristics Of The Church As An Agent Of Spiritual And Social Transformation In The Community

The Church—the body and bride of Christ—is God's principally ordained agent in advancing the Kingdom of God (Matt 16:18-19; Eph. 1:22-23; 3:8-11). The present expression of the universal Church is the living, worldwide body of redeemed people who have placed their faith in the person and work of Christ alone for the forgiveness of their sins, have been adopted as children of God, and have been given the Spirit of God as a pledge of their inheritance.

The local Church is an intentional community-based expression of the universal Church that meets regularly for worship, equipping, fellowship and service, and is the principal agent of God's agenda in the community where it serves (Eph. 2:14-22; 1 Pet. 2:9-10). Each local Church is called to live as a kingdom community, making the message of the kingdom credible as the incarnate Body of Christ in the particular locale where it serves (1 Cor. 12:4-13; 12:27-28). Nations are discipled as local Churches send their members into every sphere of society as servant leaders who promote the reign of Christ over all creation (Eph. 4:11-13). [from "A Biblical framework…"] But how does a local Church become an agent of spiritual and social transformation in its community? Formulae and strategies alone are insufficient.

Churches that are having a truly transformational impact share certain characteristics that contribute to that impact. In the Church, as in the lives of individuals, transformational change is characterized by increased holiness, reconciled relationships, and an appetite for prayer and worship.

A Church that is truly the "salt of the earth" and "the light of the world" is one in which God's Spirit is free to act so that in it the Word of God becomes flesh. A Church that is moving toward its own transformation and the transformation of the community it serves gives priority to living out its identity as God's redeemed and renewed people in:

- **Complete** commitment: Its commitment to Jesus Christ as Lord of everything and everyone.
- **Comprehensive** commitment: Christian discipleship as a missionary lifestyle to which the entire Church and every member have been called.
- **Community** commitment to inaugurate a new humanity: as the community that confesses Jesus Christ as Lord and lives in the light of that confession.

- **Ministry** commitment: using its gifts and ministries as instruments that the Spirit of God employs to prepare the Church and all its members to fulfill their vocation as God's co-workers in the world, involved in loving service through wholistic ministries that touch every area of life.

This kind of Church is often characterized by accelerated conversions and an increased relevance to greater society and participation in it.

Historical Signs In A Nation -- Developmental Stages Of Transformation Of A Nation

While there may be variations in sequence and content, a pattern may be seen in the phase by phase development of a nation as in the case of the formation of the nation Israel as revealed in the book of Exodus.

The observation of phases of transformation of a country provides insights into nation building (See case study of Norway in Appendix B2). Typical stages of transformation include the following:

STAGE ONE: REALIZATION OF CRISIS/NEED/DEFICIT – as Jesus realized when he walked the villages in his day looking out for the helpless and the harassed (Matt. 9:36).

STAGE TWO: REVELATION FROM GOD TO HIS SERVANT – as with the prophet Habakkuk who is instructed by God to: "Write down the revelation and make it plain on tablets so that a herald (whoever reads it) may run with it" (Hab. 2:2).

STAGE THREE: REPENTANCE – when desperate people seek God's presence. "Hey, look from where you have fallen. Look how you have lived. Repent and turn to the Lord."

STAGE FOUR: REVIVAL/REFRESHING OF THE SPIRIT – in which there is increasing awareness of God's nearness. This is what George Otis calls "the breakthrough phase".

STAGE FIVE: RENEWAL OF THE MIND – as in Romans 12:2, in which people are instructed: "Do not conform any longer to the pattern of this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind." Ultimately it is a change to a Biblical Worldview which leads to cultural transformation.

STAGE SIX: REPRODUCTION AND TRANSFORMATIONAL LEADERSHIP – immediately following his indication that the time had come–the kingdom of God was at hand, it was time to repent and move into a faith mode - in Mark 1:5, Jesus went out to reproduce himself in the lives of 12 others.

STAGE SEVEN: RECONCILIATION OF ALL THINGS TO GOD – this is the operational phase in which a renewed Christian minority on God's agenda acts as salt and light wherever they are, repositioning their lives and the organizations they serve in all spheres of society to align with God's purpose of reconciling all things to Himself.

STAGE EIGHT: RESTORATION/TRANSFORMATION – Biblical transformation can be defined as the process of restoration to God's intentions of all that was broken when man rebelled against God in the Fall.[24] God's agenda is to restore all things to himself (Eph. 1:10 and Col. 1:20). This will occur fully at his coming. A transformed nation is a community whose people and institutions have been overrun by the kingdom of God.

Transformed Communities And Nations: Examples Of The Impact Of Transformational Churches Ministering Under The Guidance Of The Spirit Of God

More and more stories of transformation are being told around the world. In this sphere, transformation may be characterized by pervasive awareness of the reality of God, a radical correction of social ills, a commensurate decrease in crime rates, supernatural blessing on local commerce, healing of the brokenhearted (the alienated and disenfranchised), restoration of the productivity of the land, and visible expressions of kingdom righteousness.

The Core Phases of Societal Transformation [25]

The three core phases, which every community passes through on its journey to full societal transformation, are these:

1) **The Invitation Phase** in which desperate citizens actively summon God's Presence through prayer, fasting, repentance, and reconciliation
2) **The Breakthrough Phase** when an increasing awareness of God's nearness gives rise to rapid and substantial Church growth
3) **The Transformation Phase** in which the manifest presence and favor of God yields dramatic social, political, and even ecological renewal

Once a society begins to manifest comprehensive renewal, the question is no longer how to achieve transformation, but rather how to *maintain* and *export* this blessed condition. What a community does during this period, called the **expansion phase**, plays a major role in determining whether its revived state will extend beyond the historical average of three years.

In many societies, the problem is not one of finishing well, but of *getting started* on the road to transformation. This is particularly true of Western cultures where distraction and self-satisfaction are major impediments to revival. It is also an issue in many communities that are dominated by rival belief systems such as Hinduism, Buddhism, Islam, and Communism. In these settings the journey to transformation may involve passage through two additional phases:

1) **The Investigation Phase** in which servant catalysts select spiritual targets through prayer and diligent research
2) **The Inspiration Phase** in which media, seminars, and exposure tours are employed to provoke an appetite for God's transforming presence

The Stage Indicators Of Community Spiritual Transformation

Indicators That We Are Approaching The Threshold Of A Spiritual Breakthrough

1. Fervent prayer and fasting becomes focused, frequent and widespread.
2. Interest in spiritual issues increases markedly among non-believers (this is often impelled by special circumstances that God has either arranged or exploited).

Indicator Stages [26]

Stage	Action by Party	Action Path	Key Words
1. Spiritual Beachhead	Preparation (man inspired by God)	Predictable (Known principles)	Petition, Principles and Desperation
2. Spiritual Breakthrough	Harvest (God assisted by man)	Unpredictable (Human limitations)	Response, Presence and strategy
3. Spiritual Transformation	Renewal (God assisted by man)	Predictable (Standard fruit)	Destination, product and maintenance

Indicators That We Have Actually Entered The Breakthrough Stage

1. Intercessors report a lifting of their prayer burden.
2. An intense awareness of God's presence settles over the community.
3. Non-believers speak openly of their sin and lostness (this occurs even where there have been no special programs or crusades).
4. Rapid and substantial Church growth occurs across a variety of socio-economic and denominational settings.
5. A powerful spirit of unity emerges between many believers.

Indicators That We Are Approaching The Threshold Of A Spiritual Transformation

1. Converted politicians, businessmen and professionals consider ways to translate new kingdom values into godly policies and practices
2. Convicted believers publicly dispose of illicit, besetting possessions.

Indicators That We Have Actually Entered The Transformation Stage

1. Political leaders publicly acknowledge their sin and dependence on God (2 Kings 11:17-18; 23:2).
2. New laws, curricula, and business practices are put into effect (2 Chron. 19:4-10; Neh. 10:3 1).
3. The natural environment is restored to its intended life-nurturing state (Lev. 26:4-5; 2 Chron. 7:14; Eze. 34:27; 36:29-30).
4. Economic conditions improve and lead to a discernable lessening of poverty (2 Chron. 17:3-5; Ps. 144:14; Isa. 60:5; Amos 9:13).
5. There is a marked change in social entertainment and vices as Kingdom values are integrated into the rhythm of daily life (Ezra 10:1-4; Neh. 8:10, 16; Eccles. 10:17; Acts 19: 17-20).
6. Crime and corruption diminish throughout the community (2 Kings 12;13-15; Neh. 5:6-12; Isa. 60: 17-18).

7. Volunteerism increases as Christians recognize their responsibility to heal and under gird the community (Isa. 58: 10-12, 61:1-4).
8. Restored hope and joy leads to a decline in divorce, bankruptcy and suicide. (Neh. 12:27-28, 43; Isa. 54:11-14, 61:3,7; Jer. 30:17-19, 31:11-13; Hos. 2:15).
9. The spiritual nature of the growing socio-political renewal becomes a hot topic in the secular media (2 Chron. 20:29, Neh. 6:16; Isa. 55:5; Eze. 36:36; Acts 19:17).
10. Overwhelmed by the goodness of God, grateful Christians take the embers of revival into surrounding communities and nations. (2 Chron. 17:9; Isa. 61:6; Acts 11:20-26)

IX.

Spheres Of Societal Transformation

Introduction

The sphere concept becomes important for understanding God's purposes in transforming human societies in his mandate to disciple the nations. The Bible makes one thing clear: "*…dominion belongs to the LORD and he rules over the nations*" (Ps. 22:28). The domains or spheres of society are part of God's domain. It is no surprise that an atheistic system of rule over nations will eventually fail.

> The collapse of communist governments in Eastern Europe beginning in 1989 represents a popular judgment that more than four decades of Soviet-dominated, Marxist-Leninist practice has failed. The drive is now on to reconstitute the states and societies of that region in ways that will allow political, economic, religious, and cultural life to flourish. Whether those countries will be reconstructed so that democracy, social freedom, and greater prosperity can become standard practice remains to be seen. But at least for the moment the rejection of centralized collectivism as a social model seems to be complete.[27]

The Importance Of The Spheres Of Authority[28]

Jose Gonzalez teaches on the significance of the spheres as representing God's limited delegation of authority. God is the only absolute sovereign, the ALL Mighty, whereas all other "sovereignties" are partial, being delegated by him and therefore subject to the terms and purposes of that delegation. For example, he gave Adam and Eve the authority to eat freely from "every tree in the garden", but harnessed his conscience to a test of obedience, the prohibition to eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil.

John Calvin taught that all authority is delegated by God to different kinds of authorities, each possessing its own "sphere of sovereignty," those spheres being that of the family, the church and of the civil government.

- God exercises His own ruling authority through different offices: "The Lord is our judge, the Lord is our lawgiver, the Lord is our king" (Isa. 33:22). Appealing to this scripture, Montesquieu in *Le Sprit des Lois* proposed the "separation of civil powers" into the judicial, legislative and executive branches.
- No authority may trespass into the jurisdiction of another, (hence Saul's sin, offering sacrifices, a religious function).
- They are called to collaborate under God and for His purposes, an institutional example of "two or three gathered in my name," or of "two or three witnesses", thus providing "checks and balances" upon each other, essential when fallen people are in authority.
- Thus the nations have borders and a history (an authority structure and a legal framework) "that they may seek God" (Acts 26:19), a religious motive.
- All spheres operate under the greater, absolute sovereignty of God, who is above all of

them: “give to Caesar what belongs to Caesar” (the power to tax on earth) “and to God what belongs to God” (his image imprinted in man).

In the end, all spheres, all authorities, thrones, powers and principalities will be subject unto Jesus, and the kingdoms of this world shall become the kingdoms of the Lord, and of his Christ (Rev. 15:11).

What Are The Spheres?[28]

Only four spheres of authority, which are explicitly ordained in the Bible, are each subject to a holy covenant, a covenant with God.[28] These are the individual conscience, the family, the Church and the civil government.

Some Christian authors only list three institutions, leaving out the *Individual Conscience*. This lends itself to consider man as only a subject, rather than a government of each institution. Created for and called to dominion, that is to say, “government,” self-government under God is the first and most important government. It was the failure of Adam to govern himself under God’s rule that caused the fall. And it is this government that is restored by the new birth and the adoption as children of God. Thus recognizing the sovereign sphere of the Individual Conscience is too important to be left out of the discussion of Spheres of Sovereignty.

The individual is God’s representative on earth, sovereign under God, his conduct ruled by and judged in accordance to the dictates of his conscience (Rom. 3). It is as an individual that he exercises his covenant-making capacity, entering into compacts with others and thus constituting the other “institutions”, each sovereign in their own sphere, but inferior in level of authority, to that of each man’s conscience. No man may violate their own conscience, nor can any institution lawfully require such violation. For example we find in the Scripture expressions such as: “the heart judges no man”, “and if your heart condemns you, God is greater than your heart, and He knows all things”, and “I will make a covenant with them” and “I will write my law in their heart.”

Summary: Christian Concept Of Sphere

- Dominion belongs to the LORD in the nations.
- God has established certain spheres of sovereignty, also called social institutions.
- Each of these spheres is under God's authority and social-moral law.
- The authority that each sphere has is delegated from God.
- Each social institution has been given power to exercise authority in a particular area of life.
- These spheres also have specific roles and responsibilities.
- In some cases these spheres overlap to a certain degree.
- For example, the spheres of God, man and the Church cover some common ground and the family overlaps education and community.

Applying Biblical World View Foundational Principles To The Main Spheres/Areas/Domains Of Human Life & Society

Responding to
THE CALL TO DISCIPLE THE NATIONS

Knowing
THE POWER OF TRUTH TO TRANSFORM NATIONS

Applying a
BIBLICAL WORLDVIEW BECAUSE IDEAS HAVE CONSEQUENCES

Arts, Entertainment And Sports

RATIONALE/BACKGROUND

"In the beginning God created," and "In the beginning was the Word." God is the author of creation and communication. As the supreme Creator and Communicator, he is the source of art and communication.

God has given all authority in heaven and on earth to his Son, Jesus Christ. Since Jesus Christ is entitled to have lordship over all areas of life. Christians must bring all art and communication under his authority.

Art is part of God's created order. They cannot be labeled Christian or un-Christian. However, they can be used for good or evil.

Art is neither synonymous nor mutually exclusive functions in God's economy. Communication is the act of sharing thoughts, ideas, information, and needs. The arts, whether or not they communicate, are expressions of God's creativity manifested through man.

Man, created in the image of God, has the capacity to create and communicate. Therefore, all artistic endeavors and communications involve more than technical skills. Their intended purpose is to glorify God. To accomplish this, all art and communication must be brought into captivity to the mind of Christ.

Christ is the standard of excellence. "Whatever you do, work at it with all your heart, as working for the Lord, not for men . . ." (Col. 3:23). Within the framework of that excellence, art and communication should reflect the highest quality of creative work possible given the resources available.

Since all abilities are God-given, we can achieve excellence when we submit them to the lordship of Jesus Christ and the guidance of God. This guidance comes from communication with God through prayer, study of his Word and other Biblical disciplines vital to being a Christian.

Art has a great influence on society in shaping man's view of reality. A career in these fields should be considered a worthy vocation. To achieve such a career, Christians should discern and develop their God-given talents.

It is legitimate for Christians to engage in art and communication without the need to include overt Christian symbolism or content. A Christian may participate in any area of

art and communication as long as he submits himself to the lordship of Jesus Christ in accordance with the Word, and acts in the conviction of faith, for "without faith it is impossible to please [God]" (Heb. 11:6).

Biblical Texts

- Ecclesiastes 3:11
- Psalm 27:4
- Colossians 3:23

Insights (OT Template) [30]

- Related themes include music, design, support, dance, culture, dress, poetry, literature, crafts, color, sculpture, and beauty.
- The sphere of the arts and entertainment reveals the Song of Songs and the Potter.
- The primary attribute of God revealed in arts and entertainment is beauty.

Mission Statement [31]

To see those involved in arts, entertainment and sports take on their role in society/culture, both in being transformed and in bringing transformation by expressing the vast heart and character of God. Seeing The Arts as having a contribution to the presence and movement of God on the earth is critical and we want to anchor our practice and vision of diverse human creativity in a truly biblical worldview, framed by a sense of being "sent" into mission so as to avoid the disconnect between being and doing. This contribution will take place with and through all age groups, genders and skill levels. We want to be united to bless the nations.

Principles [29]

1. God is the Creator and Author of all creative abilities.
2. The purpose of art and communication is to glorify God.
3. Communication and art are legitimate spheres of life recognized by the Word of God and available to all Christians for edification and enjoyment.
4. The primacy of the artist over his art and the personal over the impersonal, since the person is always more important than his art.
5. The responsibility and accountability of the artist and communicator in all creative expression and works of art.
6. The role of the artist and place of art as basic to the enhancement of life, the edification of the Church, and the proclamation of the Gospel to all men, however educated, no matter what their culture.
7. Art needs no other justification than that enunciated by the Word of God and confirmed by his Spirit.
8. There is a need for excellence and the development of technique in the media and art.
9. There are a variety of artistic forms referred to in Scripture that are available for serious endeavor in expressing a biblical worldview.
10. Artists have the responsibility to impart their craft to the next generation, nurturing

them in artistic excellence and integrity, in accordance with Scripture (Exod. 35:30-34).

11. The field of art, including education in those fields, is an authentic mission field of the Body of Christ.
12. The integrity and motives of the artist are as important as the work of the artist, whether or not they are clearly displayed therein.

Conclusion/ Summary

Arts, sports and entertainment --The Arts –are a critical element in society. The richness of the contribution of those involved will depend on the reality of the Creator God within them, on their obedience to articulate his light, and on the availability of platform to bring that light to the community. Through networking, training, exchanging ideas and providing venues for people in arts, sports and entertainment, the Body of Christ will gain an influential voice in the transforming of nations.

Business/Market Place/Economics

Rationale/ Background

God is at work transforming people and nations through business. Kingdom business is an effective mission strategy for the 21st Century. Kingdom businesses are for-profit business ventures that reflect God's holiness and righteousness for people, churches, and nations.[33]

Based on the observation that biblical teaching demonstrates that God cares about transforming people's spiritual, social and economic conditions, kingdom business is committed to transforming nations and advancing the kingdom of God through a comprehensive ministry. It addresses spiritual, economic and social ills that plague many people in developing countries. [34]

Biblical principles in business transforming a nation are considered below. Moral standards and mutual accountability can revolutionize a nation's business climate. The role of Christian business people is unique and far-reaching. They interact with major segments of the adult population; they are instrumental in the generation and distribution of wealth; they exert significant influence over public policy; and, they give credibility (or denial) to many of the great themes of Scripture. The principles of a free market system are ordained by God.

Working Vocational Mission Statement (OT Template)

To develop an economy where needed goods and services are provided for the community along with gainful employment at fair market price and wage.

Principles [29]

For understanding and applying the Christian worldview in the field of business and occupations, all Christian business people are called first and foremost to glorify God with the totality of their lives. This means living a holy life of obedience to the Bible, fulfilling one's role in the Body of Christ, which will include a constant seeking of commitments to Jesus Christ as Savior and Lord among their acquaintances and then helping new believ-

ers to get started on the road to spiritual maturity.

For Christian business people the road of life and ministry as a servant of God in the marketplace means understanding and embracing the following principles:

1. BUSINESS AS A CALLING: The calling of God to function as a servant in the role of a Christian businessman is a high calling, it requires great personal commitment, and when a person is called to function in business, God will grant as much of his blessing and grace to his endeavors as he would to any other calling, including to those occupations normally considered "full-time" ministries.
2. POSSESSIONS AND OWNERSHIP: God owns all that we have; any talents, abilities, and power to make wealth come from him. Whatever success we enjoy is a result of God's blessing and favor. Christians in business must avoid the pride and snares that the Scriptures often warn accompany wealth and worldly success.
3. MOTIVES AND ETHICS: Our business dealings need to be motivated by godly wisdom through seeking counsel, searching the Scriptures for revelation, and seeking God's guidance. The nature of the Christian business enterprise is to strive for God's highest scriptural ethics in all its dealings with employees, customers, suppliers, the civil government, and any other entities with which it interacts. We should model the Christian ethic of loving one another in all our business dealings.
4. STEWARDSHIP: The earth is the Lord's and all that is in it. God entrusts the earth's resources to mankind and requires wise stewardship and full use. As Christians we ought to see our vocation and any wealth obtained from it as a stewardship-a trust from God. True success is found in taking the resources entrusted to us by God and multiplying and developing them for his purposes and glory. Godly stewardship includes the development of human, natural, financial, and all other resources in accordance with the Scriptures for the advancement of the dominion of God.
5. CHRISTIAN WITNESS: The way we conduct ourselves as Christians in business will be a model of kingdom living and integrity for our whole community. On the one hand the pursuit of excellence, loyal service, a professional approach, and accountability should be shown in our every task and on the other hand, grace, forgiveness, and humility will characterize our conduct. That part of Christian witness is the timely fulfilment of financial and contractual obligations.
6. FREE MARKET ECONOMY PRODUCES MORE JUSTICE IN PRICING AND WAGES THAN ANY OTHER ECONOMIC SYSTEM: A free market economy still depends on the moral governance of Biblical values. We have the entrepreneurial privilege and responsibility to engage in business for profit. Financial reward for our labor is biblical as part of God's promise for diligence (Prov. 14:23).
7. CREATIVITY: Man, in his reflection of the Divine image, is creative; that all true creativity is a reflection of the divine nature; that creative technological inventions, practical discoveries, and advances that enhance productivity and increase use of resources are part of this creative process. All technological advances not contrary to Scripture should be promoted.
8. COMPETENCE: We should study, develop, and implement scriptural business principles and practices in order to honor and glorify the name of the Lord. In competence, Christian business people should also know their craft along with the scriptural principles.

There are principles of engineering and medicine that are not 'scriptural' but part of professional competence, even though the created world ultimately reflects God's order.[34]

9. EFFICIENCY AND INTEGRITY: We believe in efficiency and integrity in all practices of business, personal productivity, and safe working conditions.
10. LAW OF THE LAND: The Christian business person is subject to the law of the land and is obligated to obey such law, except when it clearly violates God's Law.
11. CIVIC AND POLITICAL RESPONSIBILITIES: A Christian business person has the civic responsibilities of praying for those in authority and participating in the political process through voting, supporting righteous civic leadership, and seeking elected office as the Lord leads.
12. SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITIES: The Christian business person should take an active and uncompromising position on biblical moral issues such as pro-life, freedom of prayer, anti-pornography, anti-homosexuality, and opposition to any other philosophies or practices not built on godly principles. And, God's burden should be our burden for the poor, the hungry, the naked, those in prison, and those being persecuted for righteousness' sake.
13. LOCAL CHURCH: Business people ought to be vitally related to a local fellowship of believers, fully associated with Bible training, evangelism and service.
14. Biblical Priorities: Establish and maintain as his/her highest priority to seek the kingdom of God; that this priority is the basis for biblical service; and that it is followed by family and business endeavors.
15. Business Philosophy: To be effective as a Christian in business, a believer should be focused on the responsibilities entrusted to him by his employer, while also serving the needs of his customers, employees, co-workers or associates, and suppliers. This includes addressing the spiritual, sociological, psychology, and security needs in addition to physical needs. The Christian business-person seeks daily the Lord's guidance by prayer, Bible study, and godly advice, in every phase of his business, so that God may be glorified in all that he does.

Conclusion/ Summary

God, in his sovereignty, calls men into various duties and stewardship within his Kingdom, giving them differing talents and abilities. It is the full use of those talents that determines success in the eyes of God, who alone holds the scales of success. Success is much more than the acquisition of material possessions.

While productive output may vary according to the talents and abilities of each individual, each one-working by this standard-will produce godly excellence, thereby increasing and expanding the dominion of God's kingdom on earth.

Church

Rationale/Background

The Church is God's primary change agent and delivery system to accomplish his redemptive purposes in all of society. God's intention was that the Church would announce and live out his reign and rule to the powers and principalities in the physical, social, spiri-

tual and mental (wisdom) realms of reality. As such, the Church is an embassy of the kingdom of God. The good news of the kingdom of God implies and requires the Church to faithfully and diligently obey both the Great Commission and the Great Commandment. Consequently, the Church ought to be central to the wholistic transformation of communities both locally and globally. Transformation must take place in all aspects and arenas of society, including the family, marketplace, government, education, health, media, arts, entertainment, sports, science, and technology.

The Church Focus Group of Transform World Connections pursues the role and responsibility of the Church to impact society, exploring the truths of scriptures, the lessons of history (both positive and negative) and the models of contemporary churches. The aim is to encourage the Church to bring these truths and lessons to bear more effectively, boldly, creatively, obediently and sacrificially, in all areas of life as the true priests and prophets, and to see the Church contextualize its mandate appropriately in both open and closed countries with lasting effect in the current and emerging generations.

The Church's Purpose And Responsibilities

The church prepares people to govern society (to rule, Ps. 8:6), and to fulfill the redemption and creation commissions.

1. REGULAR INSTRUCTION OF MEMBERS IN BIBLICAL TRUTH FOR EVERY SPHERE OF LIFE through Sunday preaching, regular classes, and other educational means (Matt. 28:18-20; 2 Tim. 3:16-17
2. ADMINISTER SACRAMENTS AND CHURCH DISCIPLINE (1 Cor. 5:8-13, 11:23-25; Matt. 18:15-17)
3. DISCIPLING, EQUIPPING, AND ORGANIZING BELIEVERS (Eph. 4:11-12,16; Titus 3:8,14)

Working Vocational Mission Statement (OT Template)

The ecclesiastical order is called to represent God to the people, and the people to God, providing for the discipleship of all believers in the whole nature and character of God and his Word applied to the work and walk of faith, to facilitate the expression of that faith in the warship and sacraments of the Church, and to be a moral model of God's absolute standards of truth.

Vision Statement

The vision of the TW Church Focus Group is threefold. The first is to see the individual followers of Jesus, gatherings of believers and all their leaders (the Church) **truly experience life** consistent with and characterized by all the blessings, laws and values (the fullness) of the Kingdom of the heavenly Father. The second is to see local churches and the Church as a whole **truly live out the fullness** of the kingdom in ways which reflect the wholistic power implicit in the whole message of the good news of the kingdom in their present communities, and in ways which point to the future hope and reality of the kingdom of God. The third level of vision is to see the fullness of the kingdom of God, lived out through the Church, begin **to truly transform all spheres of life**, including the social, economic, educational, artistic, medical, relational and spiritual, characterized by and consistent with Jesus rightful, intended and inevitable rule in all of life.

Principles[32] For The Primary Responsibility Of Making Disciples

Making disciples is the work of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, a work in which spiritually mature believers cooperate with the Triune God in reproducing other disciples of Christ who are in the process of becoming mature Christians.

This responsibility includes bringing people to repentance and faith in Christ, to baptism, and to obedience to all of the commands of Christ (Matt. 18:19, 20; Col. 1:28, 29).

The emphasis in discipling is authenticity and integrity in becoming more like Jesus Christ by a process of continuing change through a growing, intimate association with him. This concept is primary to a Biblical understanding of discipleship. It is a lifelong commitment of apprenticeship in which philosophy and way of life are completely identified with him (2 Cor. 10:5). It is a process of increasingly aligning one's heart and life with the purposes of God. The process of following and learning often is misunderstood as fanatical when compared with the usual pattern of Christianity (Luke 6:40).

A major obstacle to Bible-obedient living is the accommodation to the value structure of a dangerously secular society. While publicly denouncing the obvious issues of secularism, Christians often subscribe, incrementally and unwittingly, to unbiblical values as a result of media saturation. The corporate effect is passivity and apathy toward the issues of personal purity, Biblical truth, and social justice and ethics (Phil. 3:17-20; 1 John 2:15-17; Eph. 4:17-19; 2 Tim. 4:10).

With the passive acceptance of a worldly mindset, the mandate of our Lord for self-denial generally is not taken seriously. Being a self-denying, Biblical Christian is commonly perceived as an optional feature in Christian living (Luke 9:23-25; 14:25-33).

Pre-occupation with self has enthroned "me" to the practical exclusion of God. Personal feelings have replaced the Word of God as a determinant for Christian living. This lack of adherence to Biblical principles has spiritually incapacitated many believers.

Leaders must take seriously the mandate of the risen Christ to make disciples (Matt. 8:19, 20). Inwardly, this requires that leaders be examples of purity and spiritual maturity. Outwardly, this requires that leaders systematically teach the whole Church the need and cost of becoming a disciple of Christ. In addition, leaders—and the rest of the Body of Christ—must pray for the flock of God that disciples will be drawn to Christ and trained in righteousness (1 Tim. 4:16; 2 Tim. 3:16,17).

With these thoughts in mind, we offer the following affirmations and denials as initial steps in developing a Biblical understanding and practice of the making of disciples.

1. The making of Bible-obeying disciples of all nations and the bringing of all things under the lordship of Christ is the primary purpose and defined objective of the Great Commission (Matt. 28:19, 20; 2 Cor. 10:5).
2. The process of making disciples includes teaching Biblical truth sufficient to compel a decision both to repent and receive Christ for justification and to choose a life-long commitment to become an obedient follower of Jesus Christ.
3. Discipleship is a complete commitment to Jesus Christ in the totality of life, and that such a commitment always results in increasingly Biblical behavior.
4. The local church, through spiritual leadership, has the responsibility to make disciples in

the environment of caring and accountable relationships.

5. The making of disciples is principally the work of the Holy Spirit, in which spiritually mature believers cooperate with him in reproducing disciples who are in the process of becoming mature Christians, and that this takes place as a disciple follows his spiritual leader as that leader follows Christ (1 Cor. 11:1).
6. Renewal by the Holy Spirit, resulting in repentance and an obedient disciple relationship with Jesus Christ, would greatly reduce the Church's compromise with world values and its lack of impact on society.
7. The scriptural aim of discipleship is to manifest the character of Christ and to fulfill his commission by the Holy Spirit.
8. The essential elements of Christian maturity are identifiable, measurable, and attainable, and that they must be taught to and expected of all believers.
9. Obedience to God's Word proceeds out of a faith relationship with Jesus and His Church and that it will mature, liberate, and bring a person into his place in Christ (Jas. 1:25).
10. As a result of discipleship nations will be shaped by the Gospel of and the kingdom of God (Matt. 28:19).

The Christian Worldview Of Christian Unity

Christians possess a unique oneness because we belong to Jesus Christ. Belonging to him, we belong to one another. Just as there is "*one Lord, one faith, one baptism*" (Eph. 4:5), so also there is only one head and only one Body.

The unity of the redeemed is not only doctrinal and organizational but also relational and attitudinal. Our task is not to produce, but to acknowledge and express through relationships, the spiritual unity that already exists in Christ's Body, the Church. We cannot fully understand and practice Christian unity so long as "we know in part, and we prophesy in part" and "we see in a mirror dimly." We will only express our unity perfectly after "the perfect comes" (1 Cor. 13:9, 12, 10). However, we do expect that the unity of the Spirit Christ prayed for in John 17 will include a unified commitment to living under the lordship of Christ as expressed in obedience to his inerrant, written Word, and a commitment to historic, orthodox doctrine. We should speedily tutor into a more healthy and biblical view of Christianity and unity those with whom we unite who question these basic unifying essentials.

Basis Of Unity

1. True Christian unity must have a doctrinal basis.
2. True Christian unity must be based on a doctrinal foundation that includes historic Christian doctrine as revealed in the inerrant Scriptures and expressed in the Apostles' Creed.

Witness Of Unity

1. Believers should strive to present a united and harmonious witness before a skeptical and critical world of unbelievers.

2. Endless divisions among Bible believers should be avoided.
3. Christ's command for the witness of unity requires us to pursue ways to enjoy and employ our union with Christ for his glory.

Fellowship Of Unity

1. It is God's will for pastors to have fellowship with other Christian leaders who are committed to scriptural Christianity by getting acquainted, praying together, discussing current issues of concern, and developing a relationship of love, trust, and accountability.
2. Pastors and Christian leaders in any local city or county ought to seek God's will for what He wants done in their area, and that the normative scriptural pattern is for them to do this in fellowship rather than independently.

The Christian Worldview Of Christian Unity

1. It is wise and appropriate for God-fearing pastors and leaders of good reputation (Gal. 2:2) to form a local fellowship to give a united witness on what is harmful or what is wholesome and edifying in their locality.
2. National or state-wide organizations that exist to promote evangelism or to solve social and political moral evils should seek to get the cooperation of local pastoral fellowships before proceeding with their programs locally.

Major Objectives For Transform World Connections Focus Group

1. CONCEPTS: to define and clarify the biblical foundation and conceptual framework articulating the role and responsibility of the Church in transforming society;
2. CASE STUDIES: to identify and elaborate on historical presidents and contemporary models of the Church transforming society;
3. CROSS FERTILIZATION: to create and facilitate an environment within which practitioners can interact and learn from each other towards seeing the Church and local churches impact and transform society more intentionally;
4. COLLABORATION: to establish and encourage an on-going network among the participants and their respective churches for developing joint projects related to the Church transforming society;
5. COMMUNICATION: to develop a platform and system for communicating the findings and deliberations of the Church Focus Group with the participants and a growing community of like-minded believers and churches.

Conclusion/ Summary

We live in one of the most exciting times to be alive. God has entrusted his Church with the most important mission - communicating the whole Gospel to the whole person and to the whole world. The opportunities that God has prepared for us are enormous. With the blessing of global communication, travel, and new platforms for multi-ethnic, multi-lingual leadership, there is great hope for the Church to be the catalyst and sustainer of transformation. The suffering, pandemics and the world's pain also point us to the only One who can completely heal us of our wounds. Jesus is the hope of the world, and the Church her light to let that be known.

Lasting, meaningful and relevant transformation will take place in society when the

people of God, dispersed throughout every essential and vital aspect of society, align themselves with the righteous and just plan and design of Almighty God, expressed in his laws and precepts, elaborated in the values of his kingdom taught throughout the scriptures, manifest in and through the person, life and work of his Son. When God's people, His Church, lives out, in both word and deed, the plan and purpose for his Church, thus issuing both a compelling invitation and a prophetic witness to all God's goodness for humankind, society will be transformed as much as possible here and now, pointing to the ultimate and full transformation that will take place when his kingdom comes.

Education[29]

Background/Meaning

1. In its most basic meaning, education is the triune God teaching His truth to mankind. (Genesis 1:27-31; Psalms 19:1-9; 94:8, 9; John 1:1-9)

2. Education is the action or process by which a person comes to know and use God's truth and that education is learning to think God's thoughts after Him and to see things as He sees them. (Isaiah 55:8, 9; John 5:19, 20)

3. Education is lifelong and that it incorporates every thought, experience, and activity of man. (Deuteronomy 6:7-12; 11:18-20; Isaiah 29:24; Matthew 9:13; 24:32; Mark 13:28; 1 Corinthians 4:6; 14:31)

Purpose

1. The purpose of education is both to reveal God and to bring students into conformity with His revealed will. (Luke 24:27; John 7:17; 14:21, 23, 24)

2. The ultimate goal of education should be to orient human beings Biblically toward the knowledge of God, humanity, and the rest of God's creation, in order to prepare them to take their places in family, Church, and society to the glory of God and in the service of Christ's Kingdom and their fellowman. (2 Kings 22:8-23:26; Malachi 4:4-6; Matthew 20:26-28; Acts 16:30-34)

Principles [32]

The Christian World View of Education

1. The Christian God is the only God.

2. This existing, personal-infinite God created the universe and revealed Himself by it.

3. The supernatural world in which God exists is just as real as the natural world and is susceptible of being known.

4. This personal, infinite God has chosen to bridge the gap between the two worlds and to reveal Himself to human beings in three ways:

   - Special revelation in the Bible;
   - Personal self-revelation in His Son, Jesus Christ; and

- General self-revelation in material and natural creation.

5. There is no dichotomy between secular and sacred truth. All of created reality has been deliberately and purposefully brought into being by God. Thus, it is dependent on Him for meaning.

Nature and Role of God in Education

1. God is the Creator and Sustainer of all things and is the Source of all truth. (Genesis 1:1-27; Psalm 55:22; 119:151; 121:1-8)

2. God created, sustains, and will consummate all things through His Son, the Lord Jesus Christ. Therefore, education must focus on the Person of Jesus Christ. (Hebrews 1:3; Colossians 1:15-17)

3. The Holy Spirit of God teaches and enlightens every believer in Jesus Christ and leads that person into all truth. (John 14:26; 15:26; 16:13)

4. The existing personal God has communicated truth to all mankind through personal revelation of Himself in Jesus Christ and through propositional, verbalized revelation of Himself in the Old and New Testaments of the Bible. (Genesis 15:1; 17:1; Exodus 3:2-15; Isaiah 6:1-8; Mark 9:7; Luke 3:22; 24:27; John 1:1,2; 12:28; Acts 9:4,5; Hebrews 1:2,3)

The Nature of Truth and Reality in Education

1. Truth is what is known to God about Himself and all of His creation, and that it is absolute, eternal, and objective. (Deuteronomy 32:4; Psalms 25:10; 57:3; 119:142,151)

2. The existing, personal-infinite God has chosen to reveal truth to us both through special revelation, which is communicated to us by means of the Bible and God's Son, Jesus Christ, and through general revelation, which is communicated to us by means of His rational and nonrational creation; and that education should entail the pursuit of learning, which is derived from all of these sources of revelation. (Genesis 1:28; 2:19, 20; Daniel 4:37; John 1:14, 17; 14:6; 2 Timothy 3:16, 17; Hebrews 1:1, 2)

3. In God's design all of the particular elements of the universe are united into a meaningful whole; that it is one purpose of education to help learners to find relationships among these elements and, thus, to find their meaning; and that Biblical revelation is the ultimate criterion for this meaning. (Genesis 1:1-31; Psalm 19:1)

4. True reality originates with God and is spiritual and eternal, as well as material and temporal, and that the content of education is complete only when it includes all true reality.

The Content of Education

1. Freedom of inquiry is central to man's innate desire for truth, and that all truth is God's truth. Therefore, we encourage inquiry into all fields of knowledge not forbidden in the Bible. (John 8:31, 32; 2 Corinthians 3:17)

2. Freedom of inquiry and academic freedom have a legitimate place in the pursuit of truth and in the framework of the learning and teaching process. (John 8:32, 36)

3. All curriculum content must be integrated with and interpreted by God's truth as revealed in the Bible. (John 1:9; Romans 1:20; 2 Timothy 3:15-17)

4. Scientific investigation is a valid and necessary means of studying the universe and of discovering its orderly operation. (Genesis 1:14; Psalms 19:1, 2, 4, 6, 7, 8; 104:19; Daniel 2:21; Matthew 16:2, 3; Luke 21:25, 26)

5. God is the Author of all true ethics; that true ethics is based on absolute truth and unchanging principles of right and wrong, as revealed in the Bible; that there are ethical absolutes that apply equally to all people everywhere; and that one purpose of education should be to help students to discover these unchanging Biblical standards of right and wrong and to reflect on the logical consequences of departing from these standards. (Exodus 20:1-17; Deuteronomy 7:7-11; Matthew 5:17, 18; Romans 1:19, 20)

Conclusion: Responsibility for Education

Role of Parents

1. God entrusts children to their parents for their nurture and education; that parents have both a right and a duty to raise their children in a manner consistent with Biblical standards of responsible moral conduct; and that parents have the right, therefore, to educate their own children at home or to delegate the task to schools. (Deuteronomy 4:9; 6:7; 11:19; Proverbs 6:20, 21; Ephesians 6:4)

2. Parents have both a right and a duty to teach their children about biological reproduction and sexual health and morality. (Genesis 35:22; 49:4; Leviticus 20:10-21; Deuteronomy 6:6, 7; 22:22-30; 23:17; Proverbs 6:20-29)

Role of schools

1. It is a school's responsibility to assist and to cooperate closely with parents in every aspect of a student's education. (Mark 9:17-27)

2. It is the responsibility of the schools to be sensitive to the wishes and values of parents with respect to the content and methodology of their children's education. (Philippians 3:5, 6)

3. A school is an extension of the home, existing to supplement parents' primary responsibility to educate their children. (Ephesians 6:1-4; 1 Timothy 3:4, 5)

Role of the Church

1. Each congregation of the Church has the responsibility to teach all its members the doctrines of God, of creation, of salvation, of God's Law, and of worship, so that the people of God are fitted for a godly walk and for a living testimony of the saving grace of Christ to those outside the faith. (Matthew 28:18-20; Acts 20:28-32)

2. The home, the church, and the school must share cooperatively in the total design of education and yet remain separate in their respective spheres of jurisdiction. (1 Corinthians 7:20-24)

Role of Civil government

1. Education ought to operate in a free market, with each existing form of schooling having equal opportunity to enroll students on the basis of the proven success of that schooling. (Acts 5:35-39)

2. Parents have a right to educate their children at home or in private schools that are free from control by civil government. (Proverbs 4:1-4)
3. All forms of education should receive equal benefit from taxation, whether in money, goods, or services. (Matthew 22:17, 21)
4. Education plays an important role in shaping the ability of people to think and in determining the content of their thoughts, and that education, therefore, ought to be free from control of its methods and content by civil government. (John 9:1-23

Family

Rationale/Background

The family is the basic building block of society. The Lord God established family as the foundation on which human society is built. Healthy relationships built upon the fear of God and love within the family is the bond that holds church, society and nations together. However, post modern individualistic societies guided by secular humanistic thinking increasingly see institutions of marriage and family as redundant. The Church has not given adequate importance to the upholding biblical family values and has failed to demonstrate Christian families as a model and witness to the outside world.

The family is God's chosen institution for bringing children into the world and for nurturing and training them. It is the fiber from which all godly human institutions are woven, and the fabric of both Church and society will disintegrate if it's very fiber is torn.

Today the family is being torn apart by many societal pressures. Many individuals outside the Church, and even some inside it, have come to accept divorce for any and every reason. Careerism and materialism have become respectable idols, replacing living for God and his purposes for family life. The radical feminist movement has damaged the morale of many women and convinced men to relinquish their Biblical authority in the home. Some important parental rights and responsibilities have been eroded by the law, the courts, and some forces in public school education, and by governmental policies that deprive the family of many of its traditional Biblical functions. As a result, many families suffer from aimlessness and disarray.

Purpose and Responsibilities [35]

A family is simply a man, woman, children who are related by marriage, blood, or adoption. The ideal marriage has a man and woman who covenant together to fulfill God's desire for them to be fruitful and bless the world. Both parents are to fulfill the purpose and responsibilities. In this context fathers (in general, but not exclusively) lead in society, while mothers raise the next generations. (Gen. 2:18, 22-24, 3:16)

1. DOMINION AND PROCREATION (Gen. 1:28, 1 Tim. 5:10,14) Be fruitful and multiply, subdue the earth.
2. EDUCATION (Deut. 6:6-7)
3. HEALTH AND WELFARE: Practice hospitality (Rom. 12:13), especially for those of your own household.

Vision

We see a Church consisting of godly families living in harmony and love with one another testifying to the truthfulness and power of God in building godly relationships that bring about transformation within communities.

Working Vocational Mission Statement (Ot Template)

The purpose of family is to provide a safe, nurturing environment for growth, values, and development of the next generation.

Mission

The mission of the family focus group is to identify core areas that need to be addressed in the family and engage the local churches, missions and the society at large to work together to build families based on sound biblical values.

Principles [29]

1. God established the family when he joined Adam and Eve in marriage and instituted their relationship as a life-long covenant and commitment to God and to each other (Gen. 2:22-24; Isa. 49:15). Marriage and other family relationships can fulfill their complete intended potential only as each member is individually reconciled to God and sanctified through the work and Lordship of Jesus Christ; and that God ordained the family as a social institution designed to reflect his image on the earth, to bring the earth into submission to his plan, and to be fruitful and multiply (Eph. 5:22,23; Gen. 1:27,28).
2. The biblical definition of family is the nuclear family of a heterosexual married couple with its natural and adopted children, together with family branches consisting of all nuclear families descended from common ancestors.
3. God intends each Christian family to work wholeheartedly for the advancement of his Kingdom; that this purpose is accomplished by a oneness between husband and wife, through having and raising children as Christians, home-based evangelism, hospitality and other home-based mercy ministries, and training Christian leaders as godly heads of households as a prerequisite to their holding church offices (Gen. 1:27, 28; Matt. 28:18-20; Deut. 6:7, 11:19; 1 Tim. 2:15-3:13; 1 Cor. 7:21; Ps. 127, 128).
4. Each family, being different in circumstances, individuals, and gifts, has unique purpose and meaning in God's plan (Phil. 1:27, 28; 1 Cor. 12:12-27).
5. God designed the beautiful blessing and spiritual union of sexual relations to be reserved exclusively for a man and a woman within marriage (Heb. 13:4; 1 Cor. 7:1-9; Prov. 5:15; Rom. 1:27; Gal. 5:20, 21; 1 Tim. 4:1-3).
6. Celibate singleness may be God's purpose for an adult, providing for effective service or ministry; that such a calling is always marked with God's grace so that sexual purity can be maintained and that such single persons are whole persons in God's creative order (Matt. 19:10,11; 1 Cor. 7:7, 8, 25-27, 32).
7. A Christian man, as head of his family, nurtures its members spiritually and morally; that he should protect his family, pray diligently for their protection, and seek regularly the Lord's blessing for them (1 Tim. 2:8; 1 Thes. 5:17; 1 Peter 3:7). He should educate his children spiritually and lead them in the way of godliness by direct and constant instruction, leading in worship, remaining accessible and lovingly involved with them, and mir-

roring Jesus Christ by his example (Deut. 6:7, 11:19; Eph. 6:4; Ps. 34:11, 78:5, 6; Eph. 5:21-25; Phil. 2:5-11; Matt. 20:28; Col. 3:18,19; 1 Tim. 3:11,12; 1 Cor. 11:3, 14:34, 35; 1 Peter 3:7).

8. We affirm that God calls the wife to submit willingly in loving obedience and respect to her husband as the Church submits herself to Christ (Ephesians 5:22 24; Colossians 3:18); and that wives with non-Christian husbands are called by God to be a testimony to their husbands by their gentle, submissive obedience, and not to weary them with constant criticism (1 Peter 3:1-5).
9. Children are a blessing from God of worth beyond human capacity to measure, and should be welcomed joyously into the family as precious gifts from him. Children belong to God alone, with the parents being are their God-ordained stewards and God gives parents the primary responsibility and authority for the education and physical, social, emotional, and spiritual well-being of children (Gen. 33:5; Ps. 78:1-8, 127:3-5; Prov. 17:6; 1 Tim. 2:15; Eph. 6:1-4; Deut. 4:9, 6:1-9).
10. Parents mirror the righteousness, justice, mercy, and love of God in discipline, training, and nurturing their minor children (Prov. 22:6, 29:15; 1 Sam. 3:13, Ps. 78:1-8, 2 Tim. 1:5, 3:15; 2 Cor. 12:14; Eph. 6:1-4).
11. Children honor their parents and minor children obey them in the Lord. Scripture gives parents the right and responsibility to enforce obedience through discipline, including corporal punishment (Deut. 5:16; 2 Sam. 7:14, cf. Prov. 3:11,12, 13:24, 22:15, 23)

Conclusion/ Summary

The importance of upholding biblical values of marriage and family in a fast changing world is not in question. The country needs a church that gives direction in biblical teaching and models of families that are strong and stable. The church alone has the resource to undertake such a vital task. This is both a great challenge and a wonderful opportunity for witness and leadership.

Governance

Rationale/Background

God is the ultimate and only independent authority. This must be our starting point as we discuss the role God takes in the affairs of men, especially as his sovereignty relates to civil government. “By Me kings reign, and rulers decree justice” (Prov. 8:15).

The First Commandment reminds us, “You shall have no other gods before Me” (Exod. 20:3). It’s been said: “Men must be governed by God or else they will be ruled by tyrants.” We are not to make ourselves gods. Our parents are not to take God’s place and rule in the family independently of him. Our teachers are not to take God’s place and teach as if there were no authority that gives all the facts in the universe meaning.

Biblical Texts

- Isaiah 9:6;
- Romans 13:6;
- Deuteronomy 1:9- 18; Purpose 1:9-12, Authority 1:13, Representative 1:13, Consen-

sus 1:14, Judicial Branch 1:16-18;

Vision Statement

Transformation of the world through the transformation of the Christian leader in government.

Government leaders can either be the greatest agents of transformation in the land, or the greatest obstacle to Godly transformation. The Governance Focus Group operates on the premise that it is the will of the Lord to call and assemble a diverse group of individual government leaders, current and retired, male and female, from all parts of the earth. We anticipate peer relationships will be formed between leaders, as they interact together, and that these relationships will be a blessing to each other, to the nations and to the Body of Christ.

Working Vocational Mission Statement (OT Template)

To provide and ensure justice and equity for all citizens including executive, judicial, military, law enforcement and central community services.

Purpose And Responsibilities [37]

1. Protect the righteous, i.e. law-abiding citizens (Rom. 13:3-4, 1 Pet. 2:13-14)
2. Punish the evil doer, i.e. criminal (Exod. 20:13; 21:12; 22:2)
3. Administer God's justice

Principles [29]

The Foundation Of Governments

1. The Lord God is the universal Governor of all individuals and nations because He is the Creator and Sustainer of all things (Dan. 4:17, 5:21; Isa. 9:6,7; 1 Cor. 15:25; Col. 1:17).
2. "The government" in the singular, used of ultimate government, must refer to the Triune God, who alone has unlimited and independent authority (right to govern), power (ability to govern), and jurisdiction (sphere of government) (Isa. 9:6, 7).
3. The Bible is the authoritative and inerrant standard by which all aspects of civil government are to be conducted and that God holds man accountable to govern himself by that standard.
4. God is the Originator, Sustainer, and Judge of the government of man by man.
5. Jesus Christ is King of Kings and Lord of Lords. He has all authority in heaven and on earth and all governments everywhere function by his permission and are obligated to follow his Laws.

Jurisdictions Of Governments

6. God's government is independent and unlimited and that all human governments are established or allowed within His sovereignty (Deut. 4:17).
7. God has established many governments. He has given each its own jurisdiction, all are accountable to God. Among these are self government (which undergirds all institutional governments), family government, ecclesiastical (church) government, and civil governments (e.g., national, state, and local).
8. The various governments (including self, family, church, and state) have different God-or-

dained jurisdictions that exist at the same time and place, affecting the same people, and that God desires that they respect each other's separate God-ordained jurisdictions.

9. Without self government all other governments are destined to fail.
10. There is a jurisdictional separation between Church and state.
11. Jesus Christ, supporting the jurisdictional separation between Church and state set forth in the Old Testament, acknowledged and supported the legitimate but divinely limited jurisdiction of civil government when he commanded us to "....render to Caesar the things that are Caesar's; and to God the things that are God's" (Matt. 22:22).
12. Ecclesiastical government, the church (as an institution with rulers), has legitimate court powers within its jurisdiction (1 Cor. 6; Matt. 18), and that Christians should settle their disputes within the Body of Christ, following the procedures of reconciliation set forth in Scripture.

The Nature And Duties Of Civil Government

13. There is a vital distinction between state (i.e., civil government) and society, and that society encompasses all governing institutions, of which civil government is one.
14. God holds civil governments everywhere responsible to protect the God-ordained rights to life, liberty, and private property, and to keep the peace by their legitimate powers.
15. Civil government has the God-ordained power of the sword to punish evildoers and to promote the good. This power includes capital punishment.
16. Civil government has the responsibility of administering justice, which includes and is limited to the commendation of those who do right, the punishment of evildoers by restitution and retribution, and the preservation of peace against domestic and foreign oppressors, and that the fulfillment of this responsibility allows for the spreading of the Gospel of Jesus Christ and the application of the Word of God to every area of life.
17. Nations have a right to maintain national sovereignty.
18. Civil governments have the God-given authority and responsibility to build up and maintain a strong military preparedness to protect their citizens from foreign threats, and that it is right and wise for them to do so.
19. Civil governments everywhere ought to follow a biblical moral order so that citizens can work out their callings under God, and that they should treat all citizens as juridically equal, i.e., equal in the eyes of the law.
20. Civil government has the God-ordained authority to collect personal taxes (not property taxes) to support its biblically stated jurisdictional duties.
21. Individuals, families, churches, and voluntary associations should care financially for widows, orphans, aliens, and the truly needy through the tithe and offerings.
22. Civil governments must maintain just weights and measures.

Christians' Relations With Civil Government

24. Christians everywhere ought to pray for their civil leaders and to honor the offices they hold.
25. All citizens have a duty to pay a tax because of the services rendered by civil govern-

ment, and that the Church, the Bride of our Lord Jesus Christ, is tax-immune and not merely tax-exempt (the latter of which might imply authority in the state to grant or withhold the status, making the state sovereign over the Church).

26. It is the responsibility of Christians to seek godly influence on the many civil governments, confronting all of them with the Gospel and Law of Christ, and that for Christians to "stay out of politics" or the political process is to disregard our duty to be salt and light to the world (Matt. 5:13-16) and dooms society to corruption and judgment, at least in the political sphere.
27. It is the duty of Christian citizens to keep informed of issues, candidates, and trends in their civil governments at all levels.
28. Christians in general and church leaders in particular, like the prophets of old, have a mandate from God to declare society's accountability to God through and according to his Word in every sphere of a nation's activities.
29. The people of God, no matter what their national ties, constitute a "holy nation" (1 Peter 2:9).

Limitations On Governments

30. Those who govern, whether in the family, the Church, or the civil realm, are ministers of God and are thus subject to God's Laws.
31. Wherever citizens are capable of self government, the power and bureaucracy of civil government should be kept as small and localized as possible.
32. Civil government is established in part to protect the freedoms granted to people by God.
33. Systematic and deliberate attempts to tyrannize people, such as occur in Communism, ought to be opposed by all Biblical Christians through prayer, speaking out, and taking whatever action God directs one to take.

Conclusion/ Summary

With the spread of secularism and all its associated philosophies, Christian influence on governance is needed as never before to ensure that earthly government reflects the priorities and purposes of God. While globalization has been a major cause of the demise of Christian character in government, it also provides a magnificent opportunity for leaders of character to re-establish Christ's influence in this essential area of ministry.

The global networking, encouraging and empowering of Christian leaders in government is powerful in itself, but when done obediently for the purpose and in the power of God, nothing can stand against it.

Health [38]

Rationale/Background

God created man distinct from the animals as a unity of non-material (non-physical) and material (physical) components that both affect the presence or absence of health (Gen. 1:26-28, 2:7). The worth of an individual person is determined by his creation in the

image of God (Gen. 1:27). The health care worker must have a thorough knowledge of the Bible practically applied to his/her personal and professional life (2 Tim. 3:16, 17; 2 Peter 3:1). The Bible is the final authority for health, medical care, and medical ethics (2 Tim. 3:16; 2 Peter 3:1).

The term "medical missions" should now give way to a new term - **Christian Transformational Health Ministries**. The emphasis must shift from "medical" to "health," with health being the basic goal, although this still includes curative care as a part of the goal. Caring for sick people is at the center of any healthcare ministry, for it is the urgent felt need of all peoples. The overall goal of Christian health ministries is health: promoting the health of people and communities, and restoring health to those who are ill. It likewise includes training competent healthcare workers to make healthcare available to all people. Transformational health includes development in all areas of human life. Christian health professionals should serve people as whole persons and communities as whole communities. The operating mode should be partnerships between Christian people and groups without national or cultural barriers. Ultimate control should be by the Spirit of God as all partners seek together to be obedient to the direction of the Holy Spirit.

Vision Statement

Transformational health promotes a network of persons and organizations who are committed to collaborating together to implement a biblically wholistic healthcare ministry that transforms persons, communities and nations physically, emotionally, spiritually, and socially.

Mission Statement

The goal of wholistic healthcare is to promote the transformation of persons who will transform their communities. Transformed communities in turn will transform their nation through the seamless combination of curative medicine, emotional and spiritual healing, the promotion of health through health and development education, evangelism and discipleship, building relationships of trust, education, and community-based development. By promoting the wholeness of persons and communities and by building into the culture the values of trust, compassion, sacrificial care, and cooperation, this will transform a nation from the inside out, with communities having common ownership of the process and outcome. This will contribute to changing national health policies, making healthcare practice ethical through awareness building and preventing health care from being reduced to purposes of commercialization.

Desired Outcomes

- Changing culture
- Promoting wholeness
- Bringing change to communities
- Providing models for government health services
- Demonstrate effective approaches to the HIV/AIDS pandemic
- Impact on medicine
- Establishing a network of people doing transformational health to learn from each other

Major Objectives

- People's lives must be improved for the better physically, spiritually, emotionally and socially.
- There should be an improvement of at least 50 percent in individual health indices.
- One goal of a transformational healthcare program is to reproduce Spirit-filled people, who are capable of reproducing themselves in others; both in spiritual and physical terms.
- The program must be integrated into the community infrastructure.
- The program should continue on and expand to adjacent areas through local initiative.
- The program should be locally self-funded as much as possible from the beginning.
- All people should see the program as their own and not as belonging to an outside agency.
- People should be taking responsibility for their own health.
- Other organizations will be establishing their own integrated transformational health-care program.

Principles [29]

Health

1. Health: Perfect health is a biblical concept that has been experienced only by Adam and Eve prior to their sin (Gen. 2:17b; Rom. 5:12; 1 Cor. 15:21, 22).
2. Optimal health is achieved through spiritual regeneration, biblical obedience, and current medical knowledge, the latter always under the authority of the Bible (Neh. 8:10b; Ps. 90:10; 2 Cor. 5:17; Exod. 15:26; 1 Kings 3:14; Ps. 38; Prov. 3:7, 8; 2 Tim. 3:16, 17).
3. Healing may occur through the body's natural processes, God's supernatural act, concurrent with or entirely separate from standard medical intervention (Matt. 7:21-23; Luke 10:34; 1 Thess. 2:9, 10; 1 Tim. 5:23; Jas. 5:14-16).
4. The Family's Responsibility: The primary responsibility for health maintenance, disease prevention, and medical care resides with the family, as it is defined biblically (Gen. 2:24; Exod. 20:12, 14; Eph. 5:22-6:4).
5. Mental Health: Spiritual regeneration and biblical obedience are absolutely essential to a biblical concept of mental health (Eph. 4:9-16; 2 Tim. 1:7; James 1:6-8).
6. Longevity: Increased longevity generally results from obedience to specific biblical commands (Ps. 90:10; Prov. 3:7, 8; Eph. 6:2, 3).

Disease And Death

1. Sin and Disease: The ultimate cause of all disease, deformity, disability, and death is the sin of Adam and Eve (Gen. 2:17b; Rom. 5:12; 1 Cor. 15:21, 22).
2. Death: Spiritual death is immeasurably worse than physical death (Matt. 10:28b; Rev. 20:14, 15).
3. Sins and Disease: Medical problems are very frequently caused by personal sins (Prov. 23:19-21, 29-34; 1 Cor. 3:17; 1 Cor. 6:9, 10).

Health Care Workers And The Practice Of Medicine

1. Priestly Calling: The health care worker has a priestly calling because health involves the whole person (Luke 4:18; Heb. 12:13; 1 Peter 2:9).
2. Role Model: The health care worker should maintain a lifestyle that is an example of spiritual and physical health (Phil. 3:17; 1 Tim. 3:1-13).
3. Wholistic Medicine: Health care workers should provide resources for disease prevention and health maintenance, as well as therapeutic and rehabilitative measures, and demonstrate the interrelatedness of these areas (Luke 10:30-37; 1 Cor. 6:19,20; 1 Tim. 4:8).
4. Competence: Christian health care workers should achieve and maintain high levels of professional competence (Matt. 5:48; Rom. 12:1, 2; 2 Thess. 3:11, 12).
5. Spiritual Dimensions of Illness: The treatment of the spiritual dimension of illness by health care workers is ethical (Matt. 5:29, 30, 6:25-34, 10:28; 1 Cor. 13:3).
6. Responsibility for Health Education: The primary responsibility for health education resides in the family, the Church, and the health care community.

Issues At The Beginning Of Life

1. Beginning of Human Life: Individual human life begins with the fertilization of the human egg with the human sperm (Gen. 4:1; Num. 11:12; Ps. 51:5).
2. Fertilization: fertilization of the wife's egg by her husband's sperm is the biblical pattern of reproduction (Gen. 2:24; Matt. 19:4-6).
3. Abortion: Induced abortion is murder except to save the physical life of the mother, and participation at any level is sin (Exod. 20:13, 23:22-25; Ps. 51:5, 139:13-15; Jer. 1:5).
4. Genetic Engineering: Alterations of human genes before or after birth should be strictly limited to the correction of clearly defined disease or deformity when sufficient evidence exists that the potential benefit to the person clearly outweighs any harmful effects or the possibility of death (Gen. 4:1; Ps. 51:5).

Issues At The End Of Life

1. Euthanasia: Euthanasia, either by deliberate action or by inaction, is murder (Exod. 20:13).
2. Treatment of the Terminally Ill: Only the patient's physician, in consultation with other health care workers, the patient, and the patient's family, is able to assess ethical treatment or non-treatment of the terminally ill (Jas. 5:14-16).
3. Sustenance for the Terminally Ill: The image of God in all patients and the love that Jesus Christ calls us to give to all people determine the quality of care and comfort of the terminally ill (Gen. 1:26, 27; Matt. 25:32-46).
4. Suicide: Suicide is a violation of the Sixth Commandment (Exod. 20:13).
5. Organ Transplantation: Transplantation of human organs is ethical when biblical standards govern the treatment of both donor and recipient through deliberate peer review (Matt. 19:12; John 9:1-3; Acts 3:1, 2). The premature pronouncement of a patient's death in order to obtain his donor organs is murder (Exod. 20:13; 1 Cor. 13:3).

Drugs And Drug Abuse

1. Therapeutic Drugs: Drugs may be used under the proper supervision of health care workers in diagnosis and treatment (Luke 10:34; 1 Tim. 5:23; James 5:14b).

2. Psychotropic Drugs: Health care workers should work to prevent drug abuse and dependency with patients who require drugs that affect the mind or senses (Prov. 20:1, 23:29-35; Eph. 5:18; 1 Peter 4:4).
3. Substance Abuse: Abuse of such substances as drugs and alcohol involves physical disease, spiritual bondage, and distorted personal relationships (Prov. 23:29-35; Eph. 5:18; Gen. 9:20-23, 19:30-38).
4. Psychic Modalities: Use of any psychic or supernatural means in diagnosis or healing, other than prayer to God according to biblical instructions, is a dangerous exposure to occult and Satanic powers (Deut. 18:10-12; Isa. 8:19; Matt. 24:24; Rev. 9:21, 21:8).
5. Meditation: Conscious, rational meditation on God's attributes and biblical content is a necessary dimension of health (Josh. 1:8; Ps. 1:2, 19:7, 119:50).

Conclusion/ Summary

God has a plan for the health of the peoples of the world. Yet God works primarily through his people, and we are his people. We can pray, therefore, as did the People of Israel, "God, be gracious to us and bless us and make your face shine upon us, so that yours ways may be known on earth and your saving health among all nations". The Lord calls each of us, who are ministering in his name, to deal with people as whole persons, physically, spiritually, emotionally, and socially. The starting point and center of good health is our Lord Jesus Christ

Media & Technology

Rationale/Background

More people use Christian media than attend Church. The reshaping of Americans' lives is evident in various facets of their life, including the spiritual dimension. A new nationwide survey conducted by The Barna Group indicates that while 56% of adults in the USA attend church services in a typical month, a much larger percentage is exposed to religious information and experiences through various forms of media. Radio and television are the most popular Christian media, but faith-related Internet sites as well as religious magazines, newspapers and books also enjoy significant exposure. Although these religious media are a supplement to a church experience for most people, millions of individuals rely upon one or more of these media as their primary source of spiritual input (http://www.barna.org/).

In response to God's commands to subdue the earth and to exercise dominion over creation (Gen. 1:28), man has developed technology. Technology is the use of the knowledge gained by scientific research for mankind's practical benefit, bringing portions of the universe under his control.

Working Vocational Mission Statement (OT Template)

To provide truthful, objective information of importance to the community-at-large so that citizens can make informed decisions.

Principles [29]

1. Christians must obey a biblically centered world and life view in their understanding, de-

velopment, and application of technology (Col. 2:3).

2. There is a single truth, God's truth, revealed both in his written revelation, the Bible, and in nature, his created universe (Ps. 19:1-11).
3. God has empowered and commanded man to study, to understand, and to exercise dominion over his creation (Gen. 1:28; Tit. 1:7).
4. Man is a steward of all of God's creation and as such is responsible to him for both the preservation and the productive use of all the world's resources to the benefit of man and the glory of God (Gen. 1:28).
5. Jesus Christ alone is the Savior of the world (John 14:6).
6. God is transcendent beyond, immanent in, and sustaining of his creation (Col. 1:15-17; Heb. 1:3).
7. The natural laws and processes now operable in the universe were created by God and are discoverable by man (Jer. 27:5; Neh. 9:6).
8. Many attributes of God are clearly discernible in the things he has created, so that those who deny or doubt his existence, his power, or his creation are without excuse (Rom. 1:18-20).
9. The physical universe of space, time, matter, and energy has not always existed but was brought into existence by a transcendent, personal Creator God through an act of creation using special processes not now in operation (Gen. 2:1-3; Heb. 4:4).
10. Each biological life form was specially and supernaturally created by God as a definite kind, and that all natural variations in life forms have been and are limited to variations within that kind (Genesis 1:11,12,21,24,25; 1 Corinthians 15:38,39).
11. The Biblical record of history in Genesis 1-11 (including the creation of the universe and its inhabitants in the six days of the Creation Week, the Fall of man, the worldwide flood of Noah's time, and the origin of languages and the dispersal of mankind from the Tower of Babel) is an accurate and historical account (John 3:12; Acts 17:26).

Conclusion/Summary

God has commissioned his church to communicate his divine message of love in every language and culture. His deep desire is that we enter into a relationship where we can daily commune with him. Today with God given media and technology we can *proclaim* the whole gospel to the entire world and also provide an avenue for the nations to interact with the church (his Body) thereby entering into a phase of daily communion.

X.

Transforming By Focus Group

The Present Challenge And Our Commitment By Focus Group [39]

The Arts

We affirm that creativity and life come from God. Humankind "is created in the image of God" and therefore we humans are creative (Gen. 1: 27). "Skill, ability and knowledge in all kinds of crafts" come from God (Exod. 31:3). We acknowledge that the full scope of the arts—including art, sport and entertainment—have transformational potential in the life of a society. Within the church there are various understandings of this potential strength of the arts to transform. The keys to further understanding of the arts need to be revealed, discovered, developed, and shared through collaboration. The arts give cultural understanding to the eternal truths of the gospel and make invisible truths visible. The arts translate the insights contemplated by the philosophers into forms that impact the imagination and emotions of any society, bringing transformation. Motivated by the vision of bringing Biblical truth to bear on all areas of life, we must wrestle with the potential of this powerful tool for shaping the values and beliefs of society. *Therefore, we covenant together to pursue the light and character of our life-giving Creator God, seeking to glorify God through artistic expressions and activities that create beauty, build community, and clarify identity*.

Assessment

We affirm that Christian transformation is at the core of the gospel of Jesus Christ. Our identities, contexts, cultures, and societies are truly to reflect Christ and his kingdom. We also affirm that the pursuit of Christian transformation will certainly face challenges and obstacles that are rooted in culture and context. Religions, worldviews, and systems of belief often have their own visions for the transformation of society, and these visions can run counter to the pursuit of Christian transformation. In order for our pursuit of Christian transformation to be effective and relevant, it is essential that we identify the prevailing beliefs that underline the value structures and practices of our society. *Therefore, we covenant to engage with boldness, humility and integrity in a careful analysis of the various components of our societies, identifying the challenges and hindrances to Christian transformation and to develop contextual assessments that assist the church in her pursuit of transformation*.

Catalytic Prayer

We believe that fervent, focused and united prayer releases the sovereign power of God to transform us into Christ's image (2 Cor. 3:18) and to manifest Christ's fullness (Eph. 4:1-6). We believe that extended time in God's presence results in brokenness, confession and authentic reconciliation (Jas. 5:16). We believe this fullness must be released into families, congregations, cities and nations, resulting in increased holiness, harvest among the unreached, and measurable change in society. Efforts toward sustainable societal change must be centered in seeking God together in community and accountability. *We declare*

and agree to call intergenerational kingdom leaders to regularly seek God in community (Rom. 15:5-7), expecting personal transformation (Eph. 4:22-24), congregational renewal, and social reconciliation and transformation. We covenant to take regular, extended times to wait on God (Ps. 130:5-6), seek his favor (Ps. 27:4) and trust his sufficiency (Lam. 3:21-26), anticipating that he will release prophetic revelation of his plans and means to advance his kingdom in cities and nations.

Church

The church unleashed is God's primary agent of transformation. God's mission, reflected in the gospel as a whole and underscored in the Great Commission, is for his people to fully participate in global, wholistic transformation, including the arts, the marketplace, education, health, and other developmental issues that are critical for sustainable change and vitality. This transformational process involves a full embrace of the gospel by each local church with its unique makeup and methodology. *We boldly and uncompromisingly covenant to be the church rooted in the Word and empowered by the Holy Spirit, becoming the servants—the platform—to the new priests and prophets—that is, professionals, managers, entrepreneurs, artists—the catalysts and bridge-builders for global transformation*.

Coaching

The body of Christ has the value base and heart motivation to seize the opportunity of providing coaching for transformation as a viable, timely, appropriate and biblical methodology to accelerate expansion of God's kingdom and influence with and through both believers and unbelievers to bring personal and societal transformation. *We covenant to advance coaching for transformation, which is the intentional investment in a person that helps them discover Godly values and their God-given purpose, design, and destiny, thereby transforming their perspectives and behaviours and making them effective in releasing God's influence in their relationships and responsibilities*.

Discipleship

We affirm our need to obey the command of Jesus Christ to disciple the nations for the transformation of individuals and communities. We affirm that biblical discipleship is the foundation of ministry that brings transformation to all facets of life. *We covenant to mature as disciples and to disciple all others into the fullness of Christ.*

Family

The union between one man and one woman in marriage for life is the first and only institution God established before the fall. Marriage is the most fundamental unit of a family, the church, and a nation (Gen. 1:27-28, 2:21-24). Family is the leading influence in shaping a person, since it will determine an individual's spiritual, emotional, social, and physical life. A healthy family background fosters greater productivity and personal well-being. The transformation of the family will transform communities, cities and nations. *Therefore, we covenant to promote, teach, and demonstrate the wholesome family under God as described in Ephesians 5:22-6:4.*

Governance

In this diverse world there are many different forms of government. In many govern-

ments there are committed Christians who are salt and light in the positions in which they serve. The Christian's use of power, according to Jesus should benefit those who are being served, the poor, the fatherless and the widow receive true justice just like the rich, with the impartiality which the Bible demands of the civil magistrate (Lev. 19:15). *We covenant to benefit the people and the State through our allegiance to the King of Kings, who establishes and brings down human governments, exercising state and political power in such a way as to enable transformation and redemption among those whom we serve*.

Health

We affirm that the abundant life that Jesus brings incorporates all the fullness of physical, spiritual, relational, and mental well-being of God's shalom. *We commit to transformational health ministry in the name of Jesus that heals all forms of brokenness, restoring individuals, families, communities and nations to partnering with God in the celebration and stewardship of life*.

Higher Education: Christian

Christian higher education plays a strategic role in the transformation of individuals, the media, institutions, societies and nations. It effects the inculcation of values and contributes to the organization of key social processes in society through the application of a Christian worldview. As a continuous, lifelong and creative process, education has an almost unbounded transformational capacity. The fundamental purpose of education is the transforming and equipping of individuals to become Christian servant leaders within their church, communities and around the world (Col. 1:28). The ultimate mission of Christian higher education is to equip people to embrace God's mission (apostolically), to critically engage culture (prophetically), to bear witness (evangelistically) and to experience transforming knowledge—formatively and didactically (Eph. 4:11-13). This will enable people to achieve a changed life in Jesus Christ and participate in the wholistic redemptive and transformative task in church, community and nation. Christian higher education includes two tracks: (1) training for life in society and marketplace; and (2) training for ministry within the church: (a) general Christian education, (b) vocational theological education, and (c) missiological education. *We covenant to address this task as participants in the educational process*.

Higher Education In The Secular Sector

A Christ-centered, transformational vision for secular colleges and universities is that they will be impacted to become places of blessing. All members of the academic community will have the opportunity to hear the gospel. In that environment, both faculty and students will be won to Christ, nurtured in their faith, and trained in reproductive ministry. Believing students will be equipped to engage their future professions from a kingdom standpoint, while believing faculty and administrators will be encouraged and equipped to eliminate the gap between their professional lives and their personal discipleship. We want to encourage believers to develop a kingdom voice on campus so that the atmosphere of the university will experience transformation, and believing students will leave ready to influence and bless society. *Therefore, we covenant, by God's enabling and grace, to promote transformation on secular university campuses through ministries of personal redemption, professional excellence, and Spirit-led intellectual engagement within the academy.*

Leadership

A transformational leader is a disciple of Jesus Christ who influences people to participate in God-given purposes so that kingdom values are manifested in all sectors of society. The transformational leader has integrity, a servant spirit and aligns spiritual values and disciplines with leadership principles. A transformation leader inspires people with a compelling God-given vision that involves them in action that they wouldn't have done alone. Therefore, we covenant, by the power of God's indwelling Holy Spirit, to seek to follow our Lord Jesus Christ as his obedient servants and to seek to serve his people by cultivating leaders who will seek to transform themselves, their congregations and their communities for his glory.

Least-Reached

Christ has purchased people from every tribe, language, people, and nation (Rev. 5:9). We look forward with anticipation and joy to a time when the body of Christ from every group stands before the throne worshiping God (Rev. 7:9). We accept God's mandate to fulfill the Great Commission for each people group to finish the unfinished task. In seeking to reach the least-reached, we must be living sacrifices (Rom. 12:1-2, John 12:24) as we allow God to transform our lives and churches at any cost. *We covenant together with the Body of Christ to seek, pray for, and serve the least-reached through our communities as we minister incarnationally in wider wholistic witness and deeper discipleship*.

Marketplace

This is a season for the Marketplace. Business is ministry. Businesspeople are ministers who serve people through what they do, how they do it, and why they do it. Business is a calling and businesspeople are stewards not just of the assets but also the calling of the corporation. The chief end of business is to glorify God and advance his kingdom and we do this through the identification and meeting of needs through goods and services, generally at a profit. The Marketplace can empower people to create new businesses and expand the kingdom through the creation, replication and deployment of businesses to and for the healing of the nations. Business involves reclaiming the essence of work which was lost by Adam and Eve, but redeemed by Jesus. Work is sacred, a pre-fall reality, and doing work God's way equips us for responsibilities in eternity. Business is a practical way in which creation is reclaimed. Businesspeople carry the "ministry of reconciliation" so that "all things" – not just people – are realigned with God's principles. The biblical imperatives for both character and competence must be embraced and lived out in the marketplace. Businesspeople are called to live prophetically in the marketplace. *Our commitment is to carry this renewed thinking to any group in our sphere of influence not aligned with these truths – marketplace people and church leaders alike*.

Micro-Enterprise

God created the earth and all that is in it and mandated humankind to be fruitful and multiply, tilling and tending the land (Gen. 1-3). In doing so, God gave human beings the capacity to generate wealth in order to meet their needs and live in communion with him and with one another. God intended that all people would have opportunity to be productive, fulfilled, and live without want. Contrary to God's intention, today half of the world's six billion people live in abject poverty—subsisting on less than $2 per day, unemployment,

disease, and illiteracy. They lack access to fair credit and related opportunities. Christian micro-economic development (CMED) is committed to providing financial and other services to the poor that will enable them to create employment and generate income in sustainable ways. CMED is rooted in biblical principles and motivated by the compassion of the Lord Jesus to equip people to meet their basic needs (Matt. 25:33-40; Luke 4:18). CMED goes beyond conventional micro-economic development (MED) by following a wholistic approach that promotes development that brings about economic, social, political, and spiritual transformation. *We covenant to equip and strengthen the Church to engage in socio-economic development as a means of extending the kingdom of God*.

Mission

Mission is a movement of transformation that is flowing all over the world, and we need to be part of it. We are seeing new evidences of Holy Spirit vitality and innovation. Mission initiatives from many churches, particularly Latin America, Africa and Asia, are engaging least-reached groups within their own nations, as well as going to other parts of the world. Insider movements are emerging in situations that have been resistant to the Gospel. Other urgent challenges include lack of church unity, affluence and consumerism, religious plurality, fundamentalism, and persecution, children and women at risk, and HIV/AIDS. Churches need to discover the meaning and practice of mission in these new contexts. *We covenant to engage our churches to urgently obey the Great Commission*.

Nation Building

Because…"all the ends of the earth will remember and turn to the Lord, and all the families of the nations will bow down before him, for dominion belongs to the Lord and he rules over the nations (Ps. 22:27-28): (1) We believe that God has a redemption plan and prophetic future for every nation; (2) We believe God desires for every nation to be built up in him, fulfilling its God-given potential, and reflecting his nature of justice, mercy and compassion; (3) We believe that nation-building is the privileged role of the church, the primary responsibility of every born-again believer, as God's salt and light community among the nations. *Therefore we commit to: (1) put God first and honor his ambition and agenda in nation-building; (2) depend on the power of the Holy Spirit to wholistically build up nations in the way of God; (3) model the scriptural injunction in Matthew 5:13-16, being salt and light in a depraved and darkened world in our respective sphere of influence; (4) network and synergize efforts with likeminded servant leaders called by God to live out the vision of nation-building in every domain of society; (5) be a life-long learning community and document nation-building stories and scenarios to inspire generations to come toward this same noble goal of nation-building*.

The Poor

We recognize that the Lord has entrusted the poor to his church and understands that every believer has been commanded to love and remember them, and provide for their needs both spiritually and physically. Therefore, *we covenant to transform mindsets, integrate assets and synchronize initiatives to stabilize urban poor and develop rural communities.*

Scriptural Impact

We affirm that the Bible is God's authoritative revelation given for our salvation that

includes individual transformation into the image of God and our collective transformation into the kingdom of God. Therefore we care deeply for those who have little or no access to God's Word. We affirm the need to equip and mobilize the whole church to revere God's Word and to love, study, teach and submit to it and to ensure that it is readily accessible to every people group on earth. *We covenant to be people of the Word ourselves and do whatever it takes to enable others to encounter the transforming power of God's Word*.

Stewardship

We declare that God is creator and Lord and so everything in heaven and on earth belongs to him; that wealth and honor come from him (1 Chron. 29:11-12, Deut. 8:18) and that we are mere stewards. We acknowledge that we are sojourners on earth and believe we have a glorious inheritance in eternity (1 Pet. 1:3-5). As disciples of Christ we are called to live faithfully by God's stewardship principles in every area of our lives (Luke 16:12). *Recognizing that God has entrusted to us time, talent and treasures, we will seek to equip every believer to learn, apply and teach God's stewardship principles so that they may know Christ more intimately, be free to serve him, bring his presence and glory to our world, and to fulfill the Great Commission*.

Witness In Society

Christian witness will have power as it is rooted in practical ministry in Church and society. *All* believers are called to participate in this task, not just "religious professionals." This will require believers in every single domain and infrastructure of society to be salt and light. The new frontier is across vocations, not just geographic boundaries and organizations. This is where believers and non-believers interact on a daily basis. There is opportunity, for example, for believers to work with non-governmental organizations in promoting liberty in education, and developing local institutions to meet the basic needs of the community. This calls for a new kind of disciple characterized by personal radical inner transformation. *We covenant to be salt and light in every aspect of life, through every avenue of vocation and service available to us individually and corporately, in our communities and on the frontiers where the gospel is yet to be proclaimed*.

Women In Transformation Leadership

The Biblical account of the creation of woman makes it clear that man and woman were created in the image of God. According to Genesis 2:18 (Amplified Bible) "woman was created to be 'a help meet' (suitable, adapted, complementary)" for the man. We seek to provide an overarching call towards intimacy with God and spiritual growth, realizing and utilizing spiritual gifts, service, nurturing relationships, and developing into women of excellence (Prov. 31) in the Body of Christ. This calls for a paradigm shift to transform the hearts and minds of both men and women if we are to see women fulfill their God-given call. According to 1 Corinthians 12, the nine spiritual gifts are given for all believers and are not gender specific. This is a day for the WHOLE BODY of Christ to arise together—every laborer is needed. *Therefore, we covenant by God's enabling power, grace and love to promote transformation of the hearts and minds of both the man and the woman to understand this powerful truth and to equip and empower women to their full potential in God*.

Worship

Worship is the ultimate expression of our devotion to God. Because worship is rooted in relationship, we are to be rightly related to God as those who worship him in Spirit and truth (John 4). We can observe that the Lord is raising up a generation of worshipers who have the great opportunity to network with each other for encouragement and equipping with a view toward modeling for the emerging generations what it means to be in a vibrant worshiping relationship with God. The transformational impact of this worship relationship will bring worshipers into their God-oriented purpose and destiny (Isa. 6), enabling them to participate in the transformation process of their home, church, community, nation and world. *By the grace of God we covenant to be true worshipers to model for the next generation, and to network globally to learn from one another, to serve and encourage each other, and to work together for global events that will usher in the glory of God among the nations.*

Youth

We crave communities of youth living in an uncompromising relationship with Jesus Christ and igniting a Spiritual Revolution that pierces the darkness. Mentored in relationships, grounded in God's Word, and empowered by the Holy Spirit we do ordinary things in extraordinary ways to see the Great Commission fulfilled, even in the face of persecution or death. We believe that: (1) every age-group should be trusted and empowered to evangelize, disciple, lead and fulfill the Great Commission; (2) authentic faith is lived out in genuine community, mobile in structure, networked together, socially relevant and connected intergenerationally; and (3) Christ-like character is expressed in bringing real transformation and raising up leaders, not by size or notoriety.

Conclusion

We believe God is doing something new through the Body of Christ as we go forward into the twenty-first century. The Holy Spirit is leading us into fresh forms and fields of ministry. The rising generation is seeing the vision of God's mission to the world and its place in that mission with new eyes. The People of God are permanently in the *missionary* situation wherever they are. The call to mission has never been more compelling and urgent. Our challenge is to claim all the resources of the Gospel for the task at hand and then to go forth in faith, hope and joy, witnessing to God's love and compassion for all people.

APPENDICES

APPENDIX A1:
Transform World: Indonesia 2005 event & Two Years Later

Introduction

The Transform World: Indonesia 2005 event was held from May 9-13, 2005 in the capital city of Jakarta, Indonesia. This event was facilitated by several key leaders, drawn from all continents of the world and desirous of seeing transformation occur in their respective churches, communities and nations.

This by-invitation only event called for servant leaders committed to the vision of transformation, those desirous of seeing nations transformed, and who were willing to lay down personal agendas to multiply connections to bring God's purposes of transformation to pass! The five hundred participants who attended represented over fifty five nations of the world.

The Event

What happens when in the face of persecution, hardship and adversity, people of God are willing to pray and seek God's face to bring healing and blessing in their land? (2 Chr. 7:14). That is exactly the history of the Church in Indonesia. Political upheaval, economic impulsion, and religious fundamentalism are the backdrop against which God is fulfilling His purposes in this nation. This uprooting has led brothers and sisters to sacrificial living and bold witnessing. Churches and denominations are putting aside disagreements to seek unity under God and with fellow Christian brothers and sisters.

The Indonesian church is experiencing transformation of the heart as God gives the people new love and forgiveness for their persecutors. He is giving them new hearts towards those they have feared and even hated – hearts full of sympathy and hands eager to serve their neighbors, who are like sheep without a shepherd. Christians in this nation believe that they have the keys to unlock the 10/40 window, especially in relation to the Islamic world. Today they are experiencing renewal in worship, prayer, and a zealous commitment for missions. The church in Indonesia is positioned for a greater contribution to God's purposes due to the positive responses to the challenges they are facing today.

The event called the Transform World: Indonesia 2005 brought together servant catalysts from around the world to discuss and celebrate God's transformational streams occurring globally. The consensus was that along with the Church in Indonesia, God is calling His Church world-wide to facilitate the missio-Dei (the Mission of God) through multiple methods/tracks to see the fulfillment of the Great Commission. Attention was given to evangelistic witness in twenty five identified tracks ranging from Arts to Leadership, from Church to the Marketplace, from Youth to Education and so on. Participants deliberated the implications and the necessity of engaging actively in every conceivable facet of human society. Mission as transformation therefore emerged clearly as the new paradigm for global missions in the twenty-first century.

On the closing day of the conference, all delegates joined 112,000 Christians who gathered in Jakarta's National stadium for a Three Day Prayer Conference organized by the National Prayer Network. The event linked simultaneously to 55 satellite locations across the nation who also arranged similar simultaneous prayer initiatives was a visible demonstration of vibrant faith and determined action to seek God's face for His blessing to heal the nation! So great has been the impact of the Church in Indonesia that the President asked that he be invited to the event!

The Outcomes

The event served several purposes as stated below.

Firstly, it served to build community and understanding of each other and the core content of each Focus group. Secondly, the discussions served to bring additions to the "Transformational Covenant" which was drafted and finalized during the event. Thirdly, it provided participants an opportunity to recognize what their focus groups are contributing towards the global picture of transformation. Fourthly, it encouraged participants to learn new streams of God's transformational power currently in operation. Fifthly, it provided a forum for regional/national leaders to discuss regional/national challenges and possible solutions to these. It served to identify collective steps in our pursuit to bring Christian transformation to a region or nation!

The Implications

What does these mean to us here in India? The spiritual impact of any historic event carries waves of influence around the world. I believe Christians in India could learn from Indonesian brethren several lessons which have brought them to the place where they are today.

Firstly, we must understand that the event in Indonesia came after nearly 15 years of reconciliation, peace and unity among Christian brothers and sisters. Denominations and Churches put aside difference to embrace the unity of the faith and to echo God's clear and united voice across their nation. The reality of John 17, where Jesus prayed that his disciples "may be one just as we are one…" is compelling and deeply motivating in Indonesia. How do we see our brethren in other denominations? How does our understanding of John 17 and Jesus' prayer for His Church apply in our situation?

Secondly, there has been purposeful reconciliation and forgiveness both within and beyond the House of God. As a leader of the movement remarked, "Transformation begins in the heart!" Christians have been taught to embrace God's Kingdom agenda rather than denominational ones or separatist ones. This has brought Kingdom values and purposes as pre-eminent. However, along with these has been the forgiveness which has also been demonstrated towards violent persecutors and perpetrators of hatred. In the face of an overwhelming Islamic majority, the Christians have demonstrated that they are in deed the salt and the light.

Thirdly, transformation as the paradigm for mission in the twenty-first century is clearly emerging. It is no longer the clergy doing weekend ministry that is going to win the world! Yes, the laity is called; to take the Gospel to all nations in every possible way! A transformation in education, in health care, in arts, in leadership, in nation building, in micro-enterprise, in family, in governance and so on. God is Lord of all, and therefore, His

redemptive concern is comprehensive—seeking to bring healing and restoration to "all things" by means of Christ's blood shed on the cross (Gen. 1:31a; Rom. 8:18-23; Col. 1:19-20). The Kingdom of God advances to the extent that local Churches reflect God's comprehensive, redemptive concern for the whole of creation (Matt. 4:23; Luke 4:18-21). Therefore, the ministry of the Church must be wholistic—encompassing the whole person (spiritual, physical, and social), and all of their relationships (with God, with others, and with the environment. Gen. 1:26-28). The answers to these questions should set the agenda for the local Church: What would our town look like if Christ were mayor? What would our nation look like if Christ were president?

Future Steps:

Through this article believers are called to consider three responses. Initially to consider for a moment the reality of God's transformational move across the nations! In fulfillment of Luke 4:18-20 God's Spirit is restoring and bringing healing to the nations in an unprecedented manner. May God help us to comprehend and embrace the kairos moment that we are all living in.

Secondly, to engage from a Kingdom perspective in the particular vocation that God has called you to. Innovative ways and methods could be developed to catalyze the redemptive message of the cross in your particular sphere of influence. For example, a teacher who attended the conference has links via an evangelical network to teachers across the nation. Consider encouraging and facilitating other teachers to be vibrant in their witness for the Lord!

Thirdly, get involved! For long we have considered our service as within the four walls of the white-washed chapel. God is calling His Church to be actively engaged in taking the Gospel across all sections of society. By virtue of being the salt, our influence must permeate all the dough. By being the light, we must snuff out the darkness!

Transformation Connection Indonesia: Two Years Later (May 2007):

Two years later in May 2007 Iman Santoso writes: In 2007, after years of prayers, asking for His forgiveness & mercies, unity movements among various sections in the Indonesian churches (ecumenical, evangelical, pentecostal/charismatic leaders), an emerging cloud of supernatural intervention & holistic transformation seem to be developing above the Indonesian islands.

One case reported is reported: Transformation of a village, city and nation is a process that would involve many aspects of life and years of faithful obedience to the Lord. Beside reports of healings that are coming from a number of places in these islands, we are witnessing a village in Bali that are transforming holistically. Blimbing Sari is an extraordinary village in the Bali Island. The population of this village which is about 700+ people are practically all Christians.

What is extraordinary in Blimbing Sari? A tested faith through persecution and suffering many years ago has been blooming in holistic transformation. The power of the Gospel has been further expressed in Balinese culture. Dr. I Wayan Mastra, their bishop &

senior leader has been much used by the Lord in this area.

This village is better known as a model ('award winning') village in Bali. The fruits of their faith in social life have reached the highest record in many areas. They are recognized as the cleanest village almost monthly from the government. They have also been a model in education in their regency, a model of village economic development in Bali. The village is known as free from narcotics, no HIV/Aids and practically no crime heard there. The villagers of this formerly persecuted Christians regarded their freedom land as a Promise Land from the Lord.

Appendix A2:
Transform World: Bihar Challenge 2006
January 6-9, 2006 in Patna, Bihar, India

Introduction:

The second Transform World conference was held in Patna city of Bihar from January 6th-9th, 2006. This by-invitation only event saw over 170 transformational leaders from across the globe converge in India's most challenged state, Bihar. As servant leaders prayed, were challenged and discussed ways forward, God in His sovereignty blessed the event in awesome and manifold ways. This report serves to provide an overview of the event in order to capture the essence of all that transpired, heralding a new day in Bihar's history.

Background:

Bihar state has been considered for long as most backward among all states of India. Decades of corruption, political instability, lethargic governance and economic recession has left Bihar as symbolic of India's "heartland of backwardness." Many have simply written off Bihar as a hopeless case. However since the eighties and early nineties, the Lord has been demonstrating His love for the redemption of the Bihari people by bringing more cross cultural ministries to serve amongst this area of 87 million. Revival amongst indigenous groups has also lit flames of hope and redemptive love in recent years.

The challenge however, to reach this second largest state of India has left the Church in Bihar with several daunting tasks ahead. Recognizing the need for greater involvement and partnership to see God's missio-Dei accomplished in this state, an invitation was given for transformational leaders to come and consider Bihar and the challenge she poised. The event which was the first ever of its kind in Bihar's history saw a tremendous reservoir of spiritual and experiential expertise interface with leaders of the state as global and national leaders responded to the challenge of transforming Bihar state!

Program:

Seventeen Focus groups were represented at this event. They included Arts, Church Planting Movements, City Reaching, Education, Family, Governance, Health, Lead-

ership, Literature, Market Place, Media, Poor, Prayer, Research, Women, Worship and Youth. Along with a Chairperson and National Facilitator, each group typically consisted of about ten persons.

The initial moments of the event consisted of a cultural welcome ceremony followed by a time of prayer seeking God's face. The next morning, participants were encouraged to consider the Transformation paradigm and its implications for the state of Bihar. The Transformation Covenant which was finalized in Jakarta (May 2-5, 2005) was made available to all participants. Data on specific areas of challenge from within the context of Bihar for focus groups were also made available. For three days, participants discussed and prayed in earnest to see God's hand move upon this needy part of the Indian sub-continent.

Several new paradigms of ministry and prophetic utterances were given during the sessions adding spiritual capacity and vitality to the gathering! For servant leaders from Bihar state this was truly a once in a life-time experience to be encouraged, challenged and motivated further in God's transformational mission agenda for the state.

Specific Outcomes:

Ephesians 3:20 is perhaps the best expression of how participants felt at the end of the Conference. "..to Him who is able to do exceedingly abundantly above all that we ask or think…" Some said that they felt history was being created in Bihar! The sense of excitement, involvement, engagement with heavenly vision and submission to God's will was exemplary. A few of the immediate outcomes perceivable are highlighted below:

1. Unity and Humility to be the Foundation of God's new move: As leaders came from several corners of Bihar, there was a sense of purpose and identity for each one. As they discussed and sought ways forward, they were reminded of the beauty of Ps 133 and John 17. Moving ahead in unity and with a commitment to maintain functional unity across the state was identified as a prayer request for ongoing commitment and wholehearted dedication.

2. Gathering of multi-talented servant leaders as never before! Never before as during the conference, were leaders and mission practitioners called for such a unique gathering. The conference saw a mixing of giftings, a renewal of vision, development of several new strategies and recognition of God's sovereignty and help in the days ahead! Men and women were encouraged and exhorted to be His transformational agents in the state of Bihar. Almost automatically, each group seemed to have an agenda for ongoing connections and capacity building for the future.

3. Release of spiritual blessings and vision: Participants were enthralled to hear of spiritual forces clearly identified which had kept back Bihar over the decades. The cursed "womb" which had given birth to India's new religions such as Hinduism, Jainism and Buddhism were replaced through strong prayers beseeching God to now yield true life in the place of dead ideologies. Prophetic utterances over the land of Bihar calling forth for "life in the place of death" were clearly right on spot. The restoration of the place of the woman in the family and also the priestly function of children in this current move of God globally were witnessed in the beauty of God's awesome presence and His holiness.

4. Exponential growth of vision, connections and resources towards the fulfillment of the Great Commission: From initial reports received at the Conference site, each of the seventeen Focus Groups had specific plans and strategies outlined for the days ahead. One wanted to see a renaissance of literature in the Hindi language, spoken by about 400 million of India's billion! Others had plans already towards city reaching stadium events by June of 2006. Another group had ambitious plans of raising up 1000 health workers for the state. These and many others were ample evidence to the work of the God in the hearts of His people as they prayerfully dedicated themselves to His purposes.
5. Highways between the nations and cities of the world to Bihar were forged: One leader from Fiji committed to take Bihar's needs to the President of his country. Bihar would now be regularly prayed over by the country's believer President! Mexico was linked to Bihar in a vision to raise up a million women leaders across the country. Indonesia's prayer link to Bihar continues, starting from before the event, during and now in terms of effective follow up.

Transform World: Bihar Connections (TCB), April 3 (15 Months Later -- April 2007)

In Patna, Bihar site of first transform India state event in January 2006, an important follow up meeting took place as reported by Dr. Alex Phillip, facilitator for the Transformational India Connection. Inaugurated by the speaker of the Legislative Assembly (House of Representatives of the state of Bihar) – Mr. Uday Rana Choudhary – this event brought together 35 servant catalysts from various corners of Bihar to consider transformational streams within the state.

Conclusion:

"Oh come Lord & bless Bihar!" read the little prayer card circulated prior to the Conference. In a sentence, that is what has happened. God's Kingdom agenda was established and human agendas were brought down. God worked amongst the participants to provide them with a glimpse of his awesome love and power for the people of Bihar state. His presence and anointing were real and tangible – truly His presence blessed the participants towards great hope and vision towards Bihar's transformation. In days ahead, effective follow –up strategies will be outlined forging unity amongst multi-talented leaders towards the transformation of what was once called "a graveyard of missions" into a "vineyard for the Lord" – a land of His delight! Amen, Lord!

Appendix A3:
Transform World: India 2006 follow-up

The TW: Fellowship of the Committed, New Delhi Mar 30 – Apr 1, 2007 saw the gathering of more than 35 national leaders representing key transformational streams effecting change and impacting the nation of India. Korean missionary presence in India (500+) was represented along with effective Health care, Theological training, Prayer net-

works all presenting various models for transformation occurring in the country today.

The key outcome was the formation of the Transform World India Connections (TWIC) which will be facilitate this movement in India. 9 states have decided on state-wide events for 2007 and 2008, while others are forthcoming.

The Prime Minister of India has interestingly called for a "Caring India" per today's paper. Last year in January it was a "New India" but today it is worded differently. The Hindustan Times says, "The Prime Minister Manmohan Singh set a new goal for the United Progressive Alliance as it completed three years on Tuesday: building a new India, a caring India." (23/5/2007 Patna Edition). Alexander Phillip, facilitator for Transformation Connection India said, "It is hard not to believe that we are living in therefore momentous times for the Church. "

India Today – New India Tomorrow: The April 9, 2007 issue of the Outlook which has just hit the stands has on its cover page, "Forget the 9.2% Growth – Just look at How the Other India Survives." It featured a young lad sweating after perhaps a hard day's work and with a bouquet of roses in this grasp. Growth Story, yes! But there are 300 million yet to see it. Welcome to India Today.

It is in the context of such a nation, that the Church has been called to be the "salt" and the "light". The lost focus of the Church towards meaningful engagement with society at large, in all her facets is the need of the hour. Mission as Transformation needs better and many more practitioners from among the Indian Church's estimated sixty eight million. The Transform World movement seeks to be that catalyst which will serve to inform, educate, connect and motivate the Church in India to put the stamp of Jesus on the very fabric of society, bringing reconciliation, restoration and reformation in the nation.

A – Arts/Culture – Culture

B – Business/Market Place – Business/Economy

C – Church

D – Delivery of Information/Media

E – Education -- Infrastructure

F – Family – Social Sector

G –Governance – Public Governance

H – Health -- Health and environment

TW State Wide Resource Center

Praying Together

Learning Together

Action Together

The next steps for Transform India initiative:

- States will go ahead with preliminary preparations for their respective TW state events. Karnataka (Oct 31-Nov 2); Kerala (Nov 5-8); Tamil Nadu (Nov 8-10); TW: Rajasthan (Jan 22-25, 2008). Pune/Maharashtra are committed to vision casting seminars this year in at least 3 regions. New Delhi will decide firm dates for a TW: New Delhi event. Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh will continue facilitating regional meetings in Ja-

balpur and Raipur. Dates are yet to be fixed for a sub-state UP event. Requests for TW events in Andhra Pradesh, Orissa, and Jharkhand have been received and are under process.

- A 15 – 20 member Indian delegation will prayerfully consider traveling to the TW: Korea 2007 from October 21-23 in Jehu Island, S. Korea. Catalytic servant facilitators are encouraged to attend the said meetings.
- Finally with regards to nomenclature, the Fellowship of the Committed will be modified to Transform World India Connections – TWIC. Chairman, Richard Howell; Vice Chairmen, Siga Arles & Pau; and Facilitator, Alex Philip were nominated by the group present.

APPENDIX B1
Transformation Indicators Overview

Background

Transform World is committed to the transformational mission of God that results in the healing and blessing of the nations so that all may experience the presence, power, and peace of God. This is a draft / first pass at identifying available global data that might be used as transformation indicators.

Assumptions

- To be considered as a Transformation Indicator, a data set must be available for at least 100 countries. This allows global comparison and reduces localized indicators.
- Data must be already being gathered, maintained and available from a trusted source other than Transform World as Transform World does not have the resources to do primary research.

Methodology

- This model seeks to integrate Spiritual, Humanitarian and Behavioral Indicators into a composite Transformational Indicator that can be used to measure the overall transformation of a nation relative to other nations.
- Each indicator will be standardized to have a value / score between 0 (worst) and 1 (best).
- Each indicator will be ranked from 1 (best) to 185 (worst) or how many ever countries have data. Ranking values will be skipped for similar values. For example, if three countries all score .95 and that is the highest value for that indicator, all countries receive a ranking of 1 and the next highest value receives a ranking of 4.
- Single Spiritual, Humanitarian and Behavioral value and ranking indicators will be generated by combining all indicators for a given area. These three indicators will be combined into a single overall Transformational Indicator for each country using the

suggested or other weightings.

Spiritual Indicators (Overall weight 30%)

WEIGHT	INDICATOR	SOURCE
30%	% Evangelical	Operation World
15%	% Evangelical Growth Rate	Operation World
15%	% Christian Adherents	Operation World
20%	% Population living in Unreached / Least-Reached people group	Joshua Project
10%	Indicator	SIL / Joshua Project
10%	Indicator	Jesus Film Project

Behavioral Indicators (Overall weight 35%)

WEIGHT	INDICATOR	SOURCE
33.3%	Corruption Index	Transparency Intl
33.3%	Economic Freedom Index	Heritage Foundation
33.3%	Religious Persecution Index	Open Doors, CSI, ICC

APPENDIX B2
National Transformation Indicators
Case Study: North Vs. South Korea

Introduction:

A Transformational Indicator comparison of the countries of the world provides a composite view of the spiritual, humanitarian and behavioral indicators into one composite picture of spiritual, social transformation (see Appendix B1).

Transformational Indicators affirm south korea as a model of spiritual-social transformation for the twenty-first century in contrast to North Korea. Using the methodology and sources as described in Appendix A the contrast can be observed graphically in Figure 1 below.

Figure 1: South Korea to North Korea Comparative Analysis

	SPIRITUAL	BEHAVIORAL	HUMANITARIAN
North Korea 190	149	193	177
South Korea 30	68	51	27

Ranking by Transformational Indicators

Times have changed since the great Revival of Korea in Pyang Yang in 1907. Two major events dramatically changed Korea. Thirty-five years of severe Japanese occupation ended at the conclusion of World War II. However, despite promises of an independent and unified Korea in the 1943 Cairo Declaration, two separate governments were established in 1948; the communist north and the democratic south. Within two years, on June 25, 1950, the North invaded the South, resulting in the Korean War which finally came to a stalemate with an armistice in 1953. The prime motive for the Korean War was ideological with North Korea claiming an atheistic ideology of communism and South Korea an ideology which embraced religious freedom.

This background sets the national stage for the spiritual, social and cultural transformation of South Korea which can be compared and contrasted to North Korea which embraced a cultural system based on the presupposition that God does not exist. The dramatic contrast of the values and policies of both nations reflects their position on the fundamental assumption of the existence of God.

The human development index kept by the United Nations strikingly makes the comparison. In UN documentation, “Human Development takes into consideration per capita income, human resource development, and basic needs as a measure of human progress. It also assesses such factors as human freedom, dignity and human agency, that is, the role of people in development.”[1]

South Koran ranks 27th out of a total of 193 countries with over 100,000 population. North Korea ranks 177th.

In the early 1950s, South Korea was one of the poorest countries in Asia with a GNP per person of about $50 per person per year. Today South Korea has the third largest economy in Asia behind only Japan and China and has tenth largest economy in the world.

This is in sharp contrast to the stagnation of North Korea's economy from its birth as a nation in 1953. South Korea's per capita GDP is now roughly 12 times that of North Korea.

Even more dramatic is the contrast between the religious freedom in North and South Korea. North Korea today ranks as the country with one of the least religious freedom. South Korea ranks as the country with the most amount of religious freedom along with others.

The results show North Korea ranked 190 out of 193 countries of the world with more than 100,000 total population and South Korea ranked at 30. This is evidence that spiritual, social and cultural transformation have overwhelmingly come to South Korea compared to North Korea over the short fifty-four years of life of both nations. South

Korea has become one of the world's most technologically advanced and digitally-connected countries. It has the highest number of broadband Internet connections per capita in the world and is a global leader in computer games, digital displays, and mobile phones. Today, its standard of living is equal to that of many countries in Western Europe.

This remarkable economic and social development can be traced directly to the spiritual and cultural transformation of the nation. From the revival in 1907 the percent of Christians today in the country is the highest of any religious group with 27%.

Biblical values permeate government policy and have produced the engine that has driven transformational development of Korea particularly in regards to its economic development.

1 Human Development Report … by United Nations Development Programme. Accessed by author on May 28, 2006.

APPENDIX B3:
Case Study: Phases/Stages Of Transformation Of A Nation
Norway as a Model of Spiritual-Social Transformation

The story of the spiritual-social transformation of Norway is the story of how a farmer's son was used of God to mould a whole nation.[1] In an article written by Arild Stubhaug, a contemporary author, on the formation of Norway as a nation for the secular newspaper, Dagbladet on June 11, 1998, he summarized the third volume of the five-volume history. His starting point in the article (as in the book) is the story of a twenty-five year-old son of a farmer in a field. The nation building of Norway is based on this humble beginning. He writes the account of Hans Nielsen Hauges' encounter with God on April 5, 1796. In commenting on the author of the five-volume history, he makes the observation that by taking as the starting point Hans Nielsen Hauge's life and faith, this author is able to make the first decades of the 1800's come alive to us, and so to clearly show the influence of Hauge's life on the society of Norway in the XIX Century.

Fast forward two hundred and ten years. In 2005, according to United Nations records, Norway ranks as the number one nation in the world in terms of human development. The concept of Human Development is based on wealth, life expectancy and education and such factors as human freedom, dignity and human agency, that is, the role of people in development. It is notable that Norway is ranked as the second country in the world in giving per capita. For all these reasons Norway has emerged in each of the first five years of the twenty-first century as a model of a developed human community of people. How can this be? What is the explanation of this?

When the definitive historical record of Norway was concluded less than ten years ago, documented in a five-volume set by a respected Norwegian historian (Alnæs, Karsten: History of Norway , volume 3, Modern times), Haugianism was determined to be the most influential factor in the formation of Norway as a nation in 1814 and in its continued development to the present day.

Hauge came from very poor conditions but received power and boldness in his faith from God and from his fellowship with an increasing number of friends. His religious earnestness and his ability to create jobs provided great initiative for all kinds of new businesses. His enthusiasm among the people led to a mass movement in the country. The life and work of Hauge led to the new democratic movements among the farmers and among the people in the cities and towns. Also, this grass roots movement meant so much for a new view of women as equals.

Hauge's life led to the spiritual, social and cultural transformation of the democratic nation of Norway. The influence of Kingdom values has endured for almost 200 years in the life of the nation. This is a case study of the transformation of a nation. For the term "transformation" to be properly applied to a nation, change must be evident not only in the lives of its inhabitants, but also in the fabric of its institutions.

The evidence of Kingdom values in the institutions of society can still be found in Norway in the year 2005. It is a country where Kingdom values are celebrated publicly and passed on to future generations. Norway provides an important example and case study for spiritual-social transformation and nation building in the twenty-first century. The country of Norway serves as an example of a community that has gone through and shows the typical stages of spiritual-social transformation, which can also be viewed as steps to nation building.

Stage One: The Realization of a Crisis in Norway

When Hans Nielsen Hauge was born, it was the year 1771, Norway was united to Denmark. Most of the inhabitants of the country were of Norwegian origin. Two years before his birth, there were 728,000 people in Norway. Children and youth were a much greater part of the population than they are today, and the expected life span was 35-40 years. Nine out of ten people lived in the rural districts, but more and more were moving to the towns.

In the rural districts it was the farmers who were the most favoured social group, most of whom had labourers. By the turn of the century these labourers and servants were the largest labour group in the country! Over the course of time, the farms became smaller and smaller, and eventually the farms became so small that it was impossible to live off the land as the sole income source. There was widespread poverty. To make matters worse, a conflict developed between the middle classes and the farmers. The middle classes lent money to the farmers so they could meet their obligations. If the harvest was bad or the farmers had less income than was necessary, they went bankrupt and then they lost their farms to the middle class citizens. Many farmers lost their property in this manner, which contributed to the crisis in the land.

After his encounter with God, Hauge soon realized the gravity of the social conditions and immediately set out to do something about it by preaching the Word of God and using his natural skill as an entrepreneur to begin many small businesses throughout Norway. But before this could happen, he himself needed to have a vision from God.

Stage Two: Revelation from God to His Servant

On the morning of 5 April 1796, Hans Nielsen Hauge went out to plough the lower field beyond his father's farm. At the time he was 25 years old. As he walked behind the plough, singing a hymn, he suddenly felt his mind was lifted up to God. It happened as he was mouthing the words:

Strengthen my soul with power from within
So I can feel the promptings of the Spirit
Catch my soul in speech and mind
Lead me; guide me as I walk in my weakness.
I would lose myself and all that I own

If only you could dwell in my soul,
Then through the door my troubles will flee
And all that confounds my inner peace.

He was beyond emotions, outside his body, and he could neither say what was happening to him nor within him. It was such an overwhelming, ecstatic experience that words could not describe what he had seen, nor the joy he had felt. Later he spoke of it as though he, by the grace of God, without any merit of his own, had been allowed a foretaste of the Kingdom of God. The experience nonetheless was clearly attached to the word of God. The spiritual experience had liberated him and given him a mission. This was a "kairos moment" not only for Hans but also for the transformation Norway.

The individual transformation of Jesus' disciples is the essential first Stage in that it establishes the only realistic hope of transformation of the cities, nations and the world. Hauge biographer Sigbjørn Ravnåsen summarizes his contribution as spiritual liberation, social liberation and national liberation.

Spiritual liberation:

Hauge's preaching released a spiritual liberation among the people. Most priests at that time were rationalistic. They spoke mostly to peoples' intellect, whereas Hauge spoke to their hearts. As a result of his preaching, several spiritual societies were founded, and these centers were organized into a network with Hans Nielsen Hauge as a leader. This network was a first Stage towards different organisations (for example The Workers' Movement), which developed in Norway in the middle of the 19th century.

Despite the resistance Hauge met from the leading men of the church, he still asked his friends to stay in the church. In his testament, which he sent to friends all over the country, he underlined that they had to protect the state church because it was an important foundation for the whole nation. Haugian centers were meant to be living cells within the state church.

Social liberation:

Hauge was born into a particular tradition: Farmers at that time were bound to the farm and the area where they had grown up, a tradition, which had dominated for centuries. Sons took over their fathers' farms, and people remained where they had always been. There was no tradition of leaving one's place of birth, and neither was there any tradition of getting established elsewhere, nor of doing anything else. Hauge's ideas stimulated individuals to make independent choices in spiritual and eventually in practical matters. As a result, farmers' sons moved away from their farms to establish themselves as tradesmen in towns, or moved to other parts of the country to live and work in various fields. Over a period of time, there were businesses run by the Haugians all over the country and many of them, encouraged by Hauge or other brothers, moved to other areas to start or run businesses. Some established shops, others started with handicraft, while yet others founded factories and other industrial projects. A mental and spiritual liberation occurred which was without comparison in Norway at that time.

National liberation:

It is difficult to document to what extent Hauge and the Haugians influenced the his-

toric events, which unfolded in Norway at that time. There is no doubt that certain basic traits of the Haugian movement represented something completely new. One example is the fact that the Haugian movement was countrywide, which contributed to broadening the individuals' perspective from the local to the national level.

During Hauge's lifetime, people went from considering themselves as part of a class in the districts somewhere in the country, to considering themselves as mobile individuals, citizens of Norway with the responsibility and the possibility of influencing Norway's future

The fact that people to an increasing degree learned to see themselves as individuals in a national context, contributed to the development of a national consciousness, and this in turn contributed to a growing national spirit of community. Eventually, this led to an increasing desire for national independence. In 1814 Norway received its own constitution. Hauge himself was not involved in the writing, but among the 112 men at Eidsvoll there were three Haugians. The former president of the Nobel Peace Prize Committee, Professor Francis Sejersted, put it this way: "The Hauge movement was a contributing factor for developing an acting democracy in Norway" (Sejersted 1996

Stage Three: Repentance

When Hauge came to himself, following his encounter with God on April 5, 1796, he felt remorse for his sins and for not having served God in all things. He repented. After that, he felt that nothing in the world mattered, and the worldliness with which he had struggled so hard just vanished. His mind had been transformed, converted and renewed through this powerful experience, and it was as though he saw everything with new eyes. He felt an intense need to read the Bible more and had received new knowledge about how it should be understood, and he felt a deep love for God. The desire that others should be partakers of the same grace as he had received, was also very clear after his spiritual experience out in the fields.

The call he had heard in his mind was what drove Hauge for the rest of his life. But as time passed, Hauge became certain that it was the Spirit of God who had extended the call to him. Besides, as he studied the Bible more closely, he received a confirmation that God had called shepherds, fishermen and others of lowly station in the same manner, to do His work. This gave him courage.

Stage Four: Revival or refreshing of spirit leads to anointed vision and vocation.

The driving force, the inspiration and guidance were, for Hauge, to be found in a single book: the Bible. He always had the Bible with him in a bag or in his pocket, and during free moments he would bring it out to read and study, and he could feel renewed. He lived with it in all phases of his life. The Word of God inspired and guided him, but he was sometimes challenged about that which he taught when he came upon questions and complications which could not be answered by his simple catechism. In these instances, he had to struggle alone, and had no one but God and the Bible to lean on. He spoke of his doubts and scruples in this manner:

"I conversed with the Lord concerning the matters I was struggling with, both about the fundament of God's word and how I was to make His name known for the purpose of bringing the people to repentance. Then it was that He clearly spoke to me in the Spirit

providing me with the right answer."

The personal work of the Holy Spirit in Hauge became the catalytic means first to corporate revival in Norway at that time and second to national transformation. The social transformation of Norway can be traced in its roots to a spiritual awakening.

The first to be influenced by "the new Hans" were two of his own sisters, and that was on the same day it happened. Hauge noticed that he had received the awakening's gift of grace, and when he spoke of God and was glad, those who heard him wept. The awakening spread fast to neighbours in Tune and after that, to the neighbouring village, and finally to most of the country as he travelled. Hauge travelled all the way North to Troms, and the revival went that far! Hauge talked of God everywhere he went, and on his many travels, there were people who followed him part of the way and came to speak to him of religious matters. There are many stories of people whose lives changed on hearing Hans Nielsen Hauge speak.

The call he had heard in his mind was going to be an inspiration for the rest of Hauge's life. He experienced God Himself asking him to proclaim His name to men and to exhort them to repentance. First, he had to repent.

Stage Five: Renewal of the Mind

As Hauge developed an intense inner, prayerful life, he began to experience a renewal of his mind. He became preoccupied with truth and honesty. As a natural part of this, it was important to him that life and doctrine matched both in himself and others. This would in later years distinguish his behaviour and his preaching all over the country. People listened to and followed his advice, whether it concerned the establishment of a business or spiritual matters.

The responsibility of ministry was a heavy burden, even after such a strong experience, and he prayed that the Lord might take it from him. But as time passed, Hauge became certain that it was the Spirit of God who had extended the call to him. Besides, as he studied the Bible more closely, he received a confirmation that God had called shepherds, fishermen and others of lowly station in the same manner, to do His work. This gave him courage.

Hauge began to discover the meaning of Christ's prayer "Your Kingdom come…" Jesus taught us to pray, ". . . Your Kingdom come, Your will be done on earth as it is in heaven" (Matthew 6:10). The Kingdom of God exists—or is present—wherever the King is obeyed, whenever His will is done. What is the difference between heaven and earth? In heaven, God's will is fully done. If God's will were fully done—His intentions fully realized—on earth, His Kingdom would come to earth.

The emerging vision behind Hans Nielsen Hauge's versatile activities was based on the calling God had given him and the renewing of his mind. In a newspaper article in 1802, Hauge formulated it this way: "My calling is to love God and my fellowmen." This was the vision for all his work in a nutshell. Preaching, working and production were all parts of serving man, the community and God's Kingdom on earth. It was a vision of wholeness that includes a Christian life as well as existence in general.

His mind began to think new kinds of thoughts. Riches and other excess funds

were simply gifts from God, which one should use in order to serve one's fellowmen and the community. One was not supposed to use profit for personal aims such as luxury and excesses, but to reinvest in promising projects to create work, and so contribute to remunerative work and a possibility for others to improve their lives and those of their nearest and dearest.

A Christian should not consider himself above business transactions; quite the opposite, he should engage in it with enthusiasm when the opportunity presented itself because in this manner, he could set a good example for his fellowmen. Everything one owned, both capital and other material goods, should be kept in stewardship for the good of one's fellowmen and the community.

Stage Six: Reproduction and transformational leadership

Immediately following the greatest kairos moment of all time, Mk 1:15, the narrative of Jesus by Mark records the call of the first four disciples. All the Gospels begin with Jesus gathering disciples (lit. "learners"), which inaugurates the new Kingdom-minded community of those who will hear Jesus' word and follow in his footsteps. These calls underscore the social dimension of God's activity in Jesus. Jesus is no solitary mystic, but one who forms a community to "believe in the Gospel." This involved reproducing himself in others. It illustrated his approach of transformational leadership. In just three years with his disciples, they were constantly learning from him. Then it was their turn. Jesus' transformational leadership strategy was to do, do it with them and have them do it.

Hauge followed Jesus' example of reproducing himself in the life of others. Upon receiving the call on his life and the renewing of his mind, he began to reproduce himself in the lives of others. He used the same strategy as Jesus. He did it. Then he would go out walking and find someone else to do it and do it with them. Then he would have them do it and move on to the next place.

In just seven years of active ministry, Hauge left a grass roots movement that influenced the formation of the nation of Norway and continued to the present day. Hauge became a spiritual leader of the Societies of Friends which grew around him, and he became the self-appointed leader for the business ventures which he initiated.

Hauge's preaching released a spiritual liberation among the people in the provinces. It stimulated individuals to make independent choices in spiritual and eventually in practical matters as well. As a result farmers' sons moved away from their farms to establish themselves as traders in the towns, or moved to other parts of the country to live and work in various fields. Over a period of time, there were businesses run by the Haugians all over the country and many of them, encouraged by Hauge or other brothers, moved to other areas to start or run businesses. Some established shops, others started with handicraft, while yet others started up factories and other industrial projects. A mental and spiritual liberation occurred which was without comparison in Norway at that time.

These Societies of Friends were distinguished by the fact that people lived in a brotherhood, helping one another both practically and spiritually. There was a clear connection between their life and doctrine. The Haugians behaved carefully, properly and nobly; they were hard working and never refused anybody if they could be of assistance. They showed initiative, charity and sacrifice, and many of the cottage industries the Hau-

gians started up were financed with the help of gifts from Friends all over the country. Another characteristic was that there was room for all kinds of people in the Societies of Friends. The old class distinctions from the farmers' society were gradually wiped out by the fact that men and women, farmers and servants, the crippled and the elderly were all on the same footing. Unselfish love and co-operation distinguished them all. Haugians spent much time together: they spoke to each other of spiritual matters, taught and advised one another and were edified by reading spiritual books. Hauge's letters and writings were also read diligently for all to see and hear.

Stage Seven: Reconciliation of all things in a nation

Hauge's transformational ministry became one of reconciling all things to God. Hauge travelled all over the country preaching, simultaneously establishing small industries in several places. He usually travelled on foot and often knitted as he walked. The gloves and socks were then given away to the poor who needed them. It was his incredible working capacity combined with his pioneering spirit that made him such a successful businessman. He was at the height of his activity during the years 1800-1804. During this period, he established many industries all over the country, from Lista in the South to Troms in the North. Fishing industries, brickyards, spinning mills, shipping yards, salt and mineral mines, the harnessing of waterfalls, paper mills and printing plants were some of the industries he established. The profits were always used to invest in new activities; neither did he hesitate to ask his friends for loans and investments if he thought they were in a position to assist.

Once he had established these ventures, he delegated the daily management to those he thought were the most capable, but he was the strategist who planned and motivated them to function. Later when he was in the area, he would visit the works, and he would contribute and help where necessary. Because he established so many industries, saw the possibilities and was successful in most cases, he became an inspiration and an example to those who knew him. Many found the courage to break away from the traditional pattern - especially in the outlying districts - and to establish their own enterprises, once they had seen Hauge do it and understood that it was possible. Even the civic authorities recognised his business acumen. He was released from prison for a period of six months, having been there for five years for defying the "Konventikkel Ordinance" (Law forbidding gathering and preaching independent of the State Church at that time), to establish a salt mine for the government at a time when the country was threatened by famine.

Hauge guided the Societies of Friends through his letters. He was a very diligent letter writer, and through his letters he came with admonishings, personal greetings and spiritual guidance. As the cottage industries developed, the business content of his letters also grew, and as far as Hauge was concerned, he found no discrepancy in including spiritual and business matters in the same letter. In a typical letter from Hauge written in December of 1802, he urges his Friends to be humble, helpful, and diligent in all things, to doing good in order to prevent evil, to showing charity and love. At the same time, he mentions the possibilities of various trading and business ventures, and he finally asks the recipient of the letter to send him some corn to be used in the establishment of a new venture.

Interest in Hauge's letters and writings stimulated the majority of the people to learn

to read and write. This contributed to a general increase of knowledge in the population. It was well known that Haugians read a great deal and that they were knowledgeable people, which contributed to the fact that many Haugians received positions of trust and influence in the community. He developed a set of ethics based on Kingdom values

Stage Eight: Restoration/Transformation

The fact that the Haugian movement was countrywide was one of several factors which contributed to broadening individuals' perspective from the local to the national view. During Hauge's lifetime, people went from considering themselves as part of a class in the districts somewhere in the country, to considering themselves as mobile individuals, citizens of Norway with the responsibility and the possibility of influencing Norway's future.

Norway became an independent nation in 1814 whose values from the very beginning reflected the ethics and values of Hauge, which were based on the Word of God. Kingdom values are integrated into the rhythm of daily life. Laws, curricula and business practices were put into effect in Norway that have endured the test of time. Economic conditions improved and lead to a discernable lessening of poverty in Norway. Today it ranks as the number one country in humanitarian development for the fifth year in a row. Volunteerism reflects the Kingdom values in Norway. The humanitarian development index includes the role of people in development. Christians recognize their responsibility to heal and undergird the community. In addition Norway still has one of the highest ratios of missionaries per capita.

Conclusion

Norway's example helps understand that a transformed community is a culture that has been impacted comprehensively and undeniably by the Kingdom of God. The values of the Kingdom overrun a nation in all spheres of society. It shows that cultural transformation sustains trans-generational transformation.

One of the main abiding lessons from the Norwegian model of spiritual-social transformation for servants of God is this. To the degree that this missional principle—authentic mission of transformation from genuine renewal—is discerned, there is realization of the need to surrender completely to the Holy Spirit in order to be renewed, whether individually or corporately.

Endnotes:

[1] This brief was reviewed for accuracy by Hans Thore Lovaas who provided the sources of the information about Hans Nielsen Hauge and translated portions of the article by Arild Stubhaug. Most of the material on Hauge came from Sigbjørn Ravnåsen.

[2] Vine, W., & Bruce, F. (1981; Published in electronic form by Logos Research Systems, 1996). Vine's Expository dictionary of Old and New Testament words. Old Tappan NJ: Revell.

[3] From a paper by Sigbjørn Ravnåsen presented in Örebro/Sweden on 24th January 2004.

FOOTNOTES

1. World Inquiry report in six books as follows: From the Periphery: Emerging Streams of Church and Mission, Paul Pierson; **Evangelizing our World: Insights from Global Inquiry**, Viggo Sogaard; **Vision of the Voices of God's Servants: An Inquiry into the Burdens and Visions of God's servants at the beginning of the twenty-first century**, David Sang-Bok Kim; **Transformation in Action**, Richard Howell; **Transformation: A Unifying Vision of the Church's Mission**, Luis K. Bush; **Transforming Church and Mission**, C. René Padilla.

2. The key covenantal assumptions were developed by a group of leaders who gathered from the various continents in London prior to the first global Transform World event. They were reviewed by Transformation Covenant drafting committee chaired by Wilbert Shenk and endorsed by the participants at Transform World: Indonesia 2005.

3. George Otis, Jr., The Sentinel Group.

4. Bryant Myers, Fuller Theological Seminary, School of Intercultural Studies.

5. Wheaton '83 provided a platform for further clarification of the response to human need among evangelicals. In the book containing the presentations made at the "Consultation on the Church in Response to Human Need," edited by the co-presenters of the topic "Evangelism and Social Responsibility" a year earlier, Vinay Samuel and Chris Sugden, the final document titled "Transformation" reflects, by its very name, the call for societal transformation (Samuel and Sugden 1987:254-265).

6. Bryant Myers, Fuller Theological Seminary, School of Intercultural Studies.

7. Tom White, **Prayer Summits.**

8. Jack Dennison, **CitiReach**.

9. Vinay Samuel and Chris Sugden, eds., "Introduction," **Mission as Transformation**, (Regnum, 1999).

10. From two focus Groups, facilitated by George Otis, Jr. at Transform World Indonesia 2005.

11. Many people have contributed to this Transformational Covenant: the planning and coordinating committees, focus groups, and advisors. The drafting was begun in 2004 and completed during Transform World, May 1-5, 2005, Jakarta, Indonesia. The drafting process was facilitated by the Covenant Committee: Wilbert R. Shenk, chair; Remi Lawanson, vice-chair; and chairs of the twenty-six focus groups.

12. Stephen McDowell, the Providence Foundation

13. Jack Dennison, **City Reaching: On the Road to Community Transformation** (Pasadena, CA: William Carey Library, 1999). 2001 "Status of Global Mission, A.D. 2001." Accessed September 15. <http://www.gem.werc.org/ibmr2001.pdf>

14. "Faith and Restoration," by Roy Hicks, JR. with Jack W. Hayford. Accessed May 31, 2007. <http://www.godsamazinggrace.org/faithrestor.shtml>

15. Bob Moffitt, “If Jesus were Mayor.”

16. Prem James, Interdev, 15, 7th Main, II Stage, Indiranagar, Bangalore-560038.

17. Stephen McDowell, **Liberating the Nations**.

18. Jose L. Gonzalez, Semilla.

19. Rene Padilla, “The church, the world and the mission at the beginning of the twenty-first Century,” a World Inquiry publication presented to the Lausanne-sponsored 2004 Issues Forum, September/October 2004 in Pattaya, Thailand.

20. Rene Padilla, Ibid.

21. Stephen McDowell, **The American Dream**.

22. Adapted from **Evangelism and Social Responsibility**, written during the international Consultation on the Relationship between Evangelism and Social Responsibility, held at Grand Rapids, Michigan, June 19-25, 1982 in which the term transformation replaces kingdom.

23. Tom White, Prayer Summits.

24. Bob Moffitt, **If Jesus were Mayor**.

25. George Otis Jr., The Sentinel Group

26. George Otis Jr., The Sentinel Group

27. James W. Skillen, http://www.cpjustice.org/stories/storyReader$1018, **Political Order and the Plural structure of Society**, (Atlanta: Scholar’s Press), 1991, pp 257-63. Part III is "Sphere Sovereignty, Creation Order, and Public Justice." John Calvin addressed “Sphere Sovereignty” in his Institutes of the Christian Religion, arguing that the three divinely established institutions, the family, the church and the civil government, all govern under God, being each sovereign in from the others in their own sphere of jurisdiction, yet called to cooperate with one another in the accomplishment of God’s purposes.

28. Jose Gonzalez, Semilla.

29. For the purpose of this handbook we have received approval from Jay Grimstead, national director of the Coalition on Revival (COR). COR is a network of evangelical leaders from every major denominational and theological perspective who share a vision for and a commitment to worldwide revival, renewal, and reformation in Church and society.

30. The sections titled “Working Vocational Mission statement” were reproduced from her book titled: **An Introduction to the Old Testament Template: Rediscovering God’s Principles for Discipling all Nations**, by Landa Cope.

31. Julie Spence, Transform World India 2006.

32. The Coalition on Revival International Church Council Project has written a more detailed and up-to-date document titled Concerning the Education of Christian Children; it may be obtained at www.ChurchCouncil.org. The document was initially authored by Eugene Clingman, and received contributions from Samuel Blumenfeld, Robert Fugate,

Gerald Nordskog, Dr. Thomas Schirrmacher, Bruce Short, Esq., Robert Simonds, Daniel Smithwick, and Dr. Jay Grimstead who was the General Editor. The document was then sent to the approximately fifty steering committee members of the International Church Council Project for review and input and is offered to the Church with the belief that it is a biblically sound statement of parental and jurisdictional authority and responsibility.

33. Ken Eldred, **God is at Work: Transforming People and Nations Through Business**.

34. Ibid.

35. John H. Warton, Jr., President of Business and Professional Network.

36. Bruce Anderson, Mark Beliles, and Stephen McDowell, **Watchman on the Walls**, pages 29-30.

37. Ibid, page 31.

38. Vinod Shah, Stan Rowland and Dan Fountain and participants at Transform World events related to Indonesia May 2005), Bihar (Jan 2006) and India (October 2006).

39. This forms part of the Transformational Covenant. The drafting was begun in 2004 and completed during Transform World, May 1-5, 2005, Jakarta, Indonesia for each of the twenty-six focus groups.

Handbook Conclusion:

Building Transformational Momentum

At the beginning of the twenty-first century, *Mission as Transformation* has emerged as a new paradigm for much of the Church. This handbook is meant to inspire, inform, instruct, and to motivate a worldwide community of servant catalysts who are responding to God's transformational mission for the healing of the nations.

Transformation is a direction, not a goal; it matters not how far we have traveled but in what direction we are moving. Transformation is a movement, a response by much of the Bride to an ongoing move of the Spirit. Moving together, in love and after Him, is more important than making progress, even if it means to slow down to keep pace with some who lag behind. God not in a hurry; He is the Lord of time.

This manual seeks to build transformational momentum as many nations are experiencing a kairos/God-appointed moment to respond in obedience to the call of God. We have no illusions. We know that darkness will continue to increase, but so will the light. God is calling us and challenging the churches to renewal, reformation and readiness to lead – through service – the cities and nations He is about to transform.

God works, transforming the divinely ordained institutions of the family, the church and the civil government. We have considered how God is now moving through multiple transformational streams and using every other sphere of activity, as we His servants understand and apply a Biblical worldview to our own life-vocational fields. God will use our joint obedience to spark transformational synergy resulting in an explosion of global initiatives of transformational ministry throughout the world.

Through the Gospel of the Kingdom, the Lord is inviting us to become part of the pan-historical flow of His consummational mission (Rev 22:1-3): healing lives, homes, churches, communities, spheres, nations and the world. It is His will that the power, the presence and the peace of God might be experienced by all, that there may come peace with God, justice for all and shalom-salaam and that the glory of God fill the earth as the waters cover the sea.

God, who works in you to will and to act according to His good purpose (Philippians 2:13) will "*… do immeasurably more than all we ask or imagine, according to his power that is at work within us, to him be glory in the church and in Christ Jesus throughout all generations, for ever and ever! Amen*." Ephesians 3:20-21.

Transformational Momentum



Building a Community of Servant-Catalysts

Spiritual
- Christ-centered
- Spirit-led
- Word-responsive
- Love-motivated

Personal
- Prayerful—listening mode
- Openhearted—wholehearted
- Faithful in small things
- Learning posture
- Peace-maker

Organizational
- Contact — networking
- Communication
- Mobility of resources
- Persevering leadership

Social
- Decentralization
- Knowledge management
- Storytelling

Transform WORLD CONNECTIONS



www.transform-world.net